



Social Studies

Study Guide

2025 • 2026

This guide is published by the University Interscholastic League.
Any or all sections may be duplicated.

UIL SOCIAL STUDIES STUDY GUIDE

The Global Cold War and its Fallout: From Yalta to Malta 2025-2026

Table of Contents	
Introduction	Page 4
Section I	
Timeline	Page 5
People	Page 16
Terms	Page 28
Section II	
Primary Reading	Page 53
Section III	
Supplemental Readings	Page 90
Confrontations	Page 120

UIL SOCIAL STUDIES STUDY GUIDE

The Global Cold War and its Fallout: From Yalta to Malta

2025-2026

This document is meant to provide an introduction to materials and resources used for the UIL Social Studies contest. It is not exhaustive, but it does discuss the vast majority of the topics covered on a UIL Social Studies test during the year. The purpose of this guide is to provide a strong foundation for teams and individuals who are exploring this year's topic. Having a firm grasp of the content included in this review is not a guarantee of success, but will certainly be a major aid in creating the understanding of the breadth and depth of the topic necessary to be successful.

CONTEST DETAILS

The Social Studies contest consists of 45 multiple choice questions divided into three sections with 1 essay. Generally, Section I has 20 1-point general knowledge based questions that come from the terms list. Section II has 15 2-point questions based on the primary reading selection. Section III has 10 supplemental source-based 3-point questions. The total possible points for the objective section of the exam is 80 (20+30+30). The essay portion deals with one specific portion of the overall topic and can come from one or all three sections of resources. It is worth a maximum of 20 points for a possible overall total of 100.

STUDY STRATEGIES

The most effective approach to understanding the Social Studies topic is studying the content from a variety of sources and through various mediums, but there are certain approaches to that effort that tend to be more efficient. One strategy that can increase retention and promote fuller understanding is known as the 3-2-1 approach.

Section III of each year's topic is generally the most limited in total content. It can consist of films, legislation, speeches, court cases, fact sheets, primary sources, and other related documents or material. The type of sources can be diverse, but the total content is generally less than what is covered by the book that Section II covers and certainly less than the list of people and terms in the general knowledge component covered by Section I. Gaining a basic understanding of the material in Section III can lay a fairly broad foundation of the entire topic. It will not be complete, but it provides a great starting point to continue building from.

The approach to Section II is rather straight forward: Read the book! Note taking and highlighting is certainly recommended, but it is important to remember that there will be no questions in Section II of the test that do not come directly from the book. That is a rather limited target area relative to Section I. Understanding the primary reading source will be greatly aided by the knowledge gained from Section III. Retention is also likely to be much higher due to the increased awareness of the context and some of the individuals or events that the book discusses.

The final section is the most extensive. Section I covers approximately 250-300 terms. Studying it can be a frightful proposition if approached head on. However, when tackled with the tools gained from learning about the other sections first, a lot of that fear dissipates. Many of the people, terms, and events will have already been at least introduced by the other sections allowing for the same context that allowed for increased retention of the primary reading source. Coaches, competitors, and teams can study section

one with much more confidence, retain the information at a higher rate, and explore the terms on a deeper level if they make those explorations from the expansive base provided by familiarity with Sections II and III.

Studying Section I terms can also benefit from a similar strategy. Making flashcards for each person or term is a proven approach, but it can be more efficient and effective if those cards start with basic information and as one's understanding of the overall topic grows the depth of information on the cards grows as well. The idea with all of these approaches is that too much information with too little understanding can lead to more frustration than results.

SAMPLE QUESTIONS

1. The Brezhnev Doctrine was a foreign policy put forth by Leonid Brezhnev calling on the USSR to intervene in countries where socialist rule was under threat. It was largely a response to the _____.

- | | |
|-------------------------|----------------|
| A. Hungarian Revolution | C. Afghan coup |
| B. Prague Spring | D. Korean War |

This question represents the basic format of what will appear on a test over this year's topic. This particular question could appear in Section I or III because it covers content from both. People, events, and concepts that appear in multiple sections have a higher likelihood of being featured in a question or included as part of an essay prompt.

2. Operation _____ involved several _____ military governments including the _____ regime that coordinated efforts to systematically eliminate leftists opponents in the 1970s and '80s.

- | | | | |
|-----------------|-------------------|---------------|-------------------|
| 1. A. PBSuccess | B. Condor | C. Eagle Claw | D. Mongoose |
| 2. A. Asian | B. South American | C. African | D. Middle Eastern |
| 3. A. Ulbricht | B. Pinochet | C. Allende | D. Árbenz |

This is **NOT** a question style that will be seen on a UIL Social Studies test, but is included to exemplify the type of information that will be asked. Any of the blanks shown could be used in an actual question. This shows what specifics are generally asked. It could be the name of an operation, what region or country it was associated with, or the person responsible for the event. It could also include other similar specific details about events or people from the topic.

(Answer)

2. Operation *Condor* involved several *South American* military governments including the *Pinochet* regime that coordinated efforts to systemically eliminate leftist opponents in the 1970s and 80s.
3. When U Thant tried to counter Castro's national sovereignty argument against inspections by citing the example of the Congo, which had invited UN personnel into its territory, the infuriated Castro shot back: "...the government that made that request is now dead and buried!" The reference was to the former prime minister, _____, who was killed in 1961 by his Western-backed opponents despite the presence of UN troops.

- | | |
|--------------------|--------------------|
| A. Patrice Lumumba | C. Ahmed Ben Bella |
| B. Kwame Nkrumah | D. Agostino Neto |

This is an example of a section two question that uses a direct quote from the book. Normally, this would be overly specific and not be asked, however, since the answer (Lumumba) is a Section I term, the overlap allows for more specificity that could be seen in a question.

4. Khrushchev was focused on the PGM-19 Jupiter medium-range ballistic missiles with 1.44-megaton nuclear warheads that had been deployed by the US in Italy and Turkey. In June 1961, the Air Force deployed _____ Jupiters in Turkey.
- | | | | |
|----|----|----|----|
| A. | 15 | C. | 50 |
| B. | 25 | D. | 70 |

This is also taken directly from the primary reading source, but is **NOT** an example of a question that would normally appear on a UIL Social Studies test. Number-based details will generally not be asked as such details are not considered key to understanding the overall concept asked by questions. **Some numbers may be used, but are usually included in the question rather than in the answer. Only exceptionally significant numbers will be asked.*

2025-2026 TOPIC INTRODUCTION

What was the Cold War? When was the Cold War? As with most richly complex topics in Social Studies there are no clear cut definitions that easily provide answers to these questions. Hence, the Global Cold War makes for the perfect focus for this year's UIL Social Studies contest. Its impacts are far-reaching and continuous. Understanding today's world with any depth requires an understanding of the era of World History generally referred to as the Cold War.

The Cold War was truly a global phenomenon that dominated social, political, economic, and cultural events across the globe during the mid-20th century. The roots go as far back as the age of exploration and in many ways it is the final act of the drama sparked by European colonization. More specifically, the Cold War can be said to begin as World War II ended, though even that definition is debatable. It was certainly in full swing by the Berlin Blockade of 1948-49 and that event encapsulates the main thrust of what the Cold War was; a struggle between the capitalist and communist systems for global dominance largely led by the "superpowers" of the United States and the Union of Soviet Socialist Republics. This focus of this year's topic seeks to show the far-reaching extent of that struggle by focusing on the allies, satellites, and client states of the superpowers and their conflicts, proxy wars, and evolution. It will also look at confrontations and developments across the map that the US or the USSR involved themselves in in order to foment or stifle movements that were seen as possibly putting a country or region on a path towards one camp or another. Suffice to say, the US and USSR are major players, but the study area and terms were crafted to center attention on the other players.

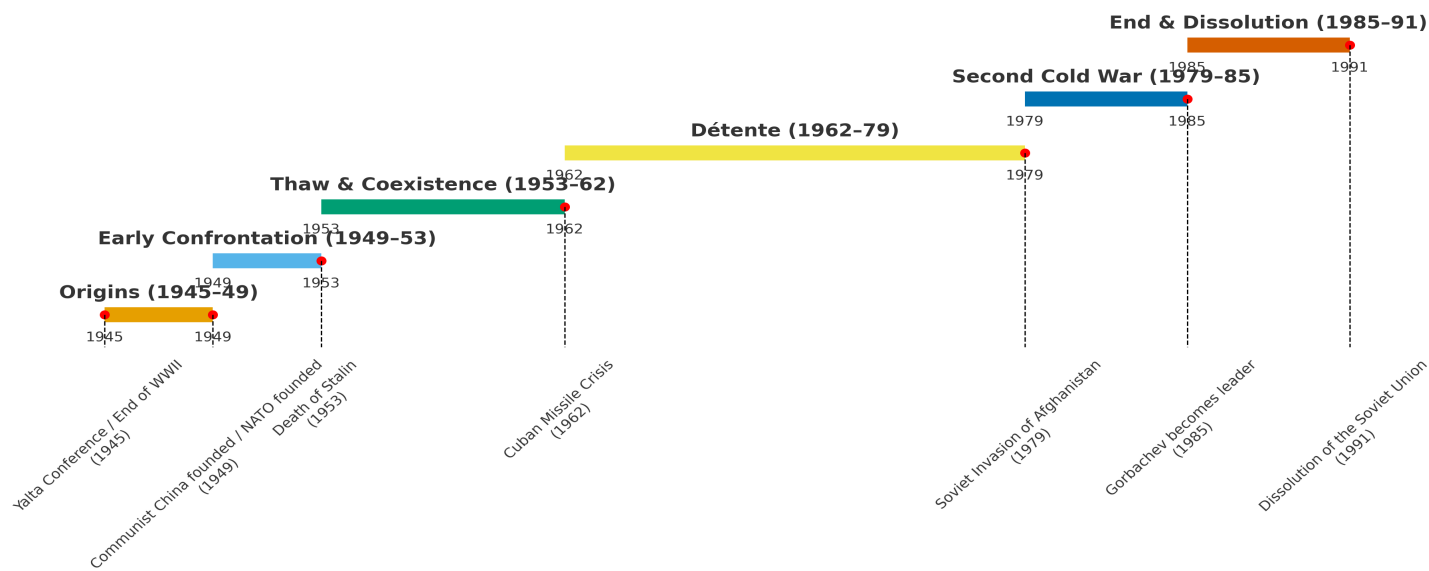
That covers some of the "what" and the "who" which leaves the "when." A general guideline is "from Yalta to Malta," the two conferences that bookended the era. Every year, some terms that set the stage for the topic or deal with its far-reaching impacts will fall outside of the main boundaries, but that general guideline encompasses the majority of what will be discussed.

Overall, the goal of this year's contest is to foster a better understanding of our modern world by studying how it arrived at this moment. The Global Cold War was not a monolithic struggle. East versus West fails to respect the diverse nations and peoples that populated and experienced the era. Each "side" was a patchwork of interests and goals at the best of times and understanding the individual components of those patches will increase one's ability to understand current conflicts in places from Iran to Somalia and political and economic developments from China to the European Union.

SECTION I - GENERAL KNOWLEDGE

TIMELINE OF EVENTS

Cold War Periods Timeline & Key Events (1945–1991)



Origins of the Cold War (1945–1949)

- Truman Doctrine (1947)
- Marshall Plan (1947)
- Berlin Blockade and Airlift (1948–49)
- Soviet atomic bomb test (1949)

Early Confrontation (1949–1953)

- Korean War begins (1950)
- U.S. hydrogen bomb test (1952)
- Korean War armistice (1953)

Thaw & Coexistence (1953–1962)

- Geneva Summit (1955)
- Hungarian Uprising (1956)
- Sputnik launched (1957)
- U-2 Incident (1960)
- Berlin Wall built (1961)
- Dien Bien Phu (1954)
- Suez Crisis (1956)

Détente (1962–1979)

- Nuclear Test Ban Treaty (1963)
- SALT I signed (1972)
- Helsinki Accords (1975)
- U.S. withdrawal from Vietnam (1973)
- Prague Spring (1968)
- Angolan independence (1975)

Second Cold War (1979–1985)

- U.S. boycott of Moscow Olympics (1980)
- Reagan's Strategic Defense Initiative (1983)
- Deployment of Pershing II missiles in Europe (1983)
- KAL Flight 007 (1983)
- Able Archer 83 (1983)

End of the Cold War (1985–1991)

- INF Treaty (1987)
- Fall of the Berlin Wall (1989)
- Collapse of Eastern European communism (1989)
- German reunification (1990)

TIMELINE OF EVENTS, Continued

DATE	EVENT
February 4-11, 1945	The Yalta Conference hosted by Josef Stalin with Franklin Roosevelt and Winston Churchill
March 7, 1945	Marshal Josip Broz Tito became the leader of Democratic Federal Yugoslavia
May 8, 1945	VE Day was celebrated after Germany surrendered to the Allied forces
April 12, 1945	Roosevelt died and was replaced as US President by Harry Truman
July 24, 1945	The Potsdam Conference was held near Berlin with Stalin, Truman, and Churchill then Clement Atlee
August 6, 1945	First use of an atomic weapon occurred when US forces dropped a bomb on Hiroshima, Japan
August 14, 1945	VJ was celebrated after Japan agreed to an unconditional surrender
November 1945- December 1946	USSR refused to remove troops from Iran and supported breakaway countries
February 9, 1946	Stalin made his Election Speech to the Supreme Soviet
February 22, 1946	George Kennan wrote the "Long Telegram"
March 5, 1946	Winston Churchill delivered his "Iron Curtain Speech"
September 6, 1946	James Byrnes delivered his "Speech of Hope"
January 1, 1947	The US and U.K. combined occupation zones in Germany
March 12, 1947	President Truman announced the Truman Doctrine
April 16, 1947	Bernard Baruch delivered his "Cold War Speech"
June 5, 1947	Secretary of State George Marshall announced his idea for what became known as the Marshall Plan

October 5, 1947	COMINFORM was founded
November 29, 1947	United Nations passed Resolution 181 to partition Palestine
December 30, 1947	Communist rule began in Romania after the removal of the monarchy
February 25, 1948	Communist coup occurred in Czechoslovakia
March 10, 1948	Czech Foreign Minister Jan Masaryk was found dead, it was reported a suicide but some believed he was pushed out a window
March 17, 1948	Treaty of Brussels was signed
April 18, 1948	US funded Italian Christian Democratic Party won a victory over communist-backed parties in Italy
June 21, 1948	The Deutsche Mark was created as the common currency for use in the French, UK, and US sectors of Germany
June 24, 1948	West Berlin was blockaded by Soviet forces and an airlift was started by Western powers to supply the city
June 28, 1948	Yugoslavia is expelled from COMINFORM
August 15, 1948	The Republic of Korea was established with Syngman Rhee as leader
September 9, 1948	The Democratic People's Republic of Korea was established with Kim Il Sung as leader
January 1, 1949	Council for Economic Mutual Assistance (COMECON) founded
April 4, 1949	North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO) was founded
May 11, 1949	Blockade of West Berlin was lifted
May 23, 1949	Federal Republic of Germany (West Germany) was founded ending Western occupation
August 29, 1949	USSR successfully tested their first atomic bomb
September 15, 1949	Konrad Adenauer was elected Chancellor of West Germany

October 1, 1949	The People's Republic of China (PRC) was founded by Mao Zedong
October 7, 1949	German Democratic Republic (East Germany) was founded
October 16, 1949	End of Greek Civil War and defeat of communist forces
February 12, 1950	Sino-Soviet Treaty of Friendship was signed
April 7, 1950	NSC-68 was released advocating containment of communism worldwide
June 25, 1950	North Korean forces invaded the South
September 30, 1950	UN forces landed at Inchon beginning a counteroffensive into North Korea
October-November 1950	PRC forces intervened in Korean conflict as UN troops approached the Yalu River
March 29, 1951	Julius and Ethel Rosenberg were convicted of passing atomic secrets to the USSR
February 18, 1952	NATO expanded to include Turkey and Greece
June 19, 1953	Rosenbergs executed for espionage
July 23, 1952	Egypt was taken over in a military coup led by Gamal Abdel Nasser's Free Officers Movement
October 2, 1952	UK detonated its first atomic bomb
November 1, 1952	US detonated "Ivy Mike" world's first hydrogen bomb
March 5, 1953	Josef Stalin died at age 74
July 27, 1953	Korean cease-fire is signed
August 19, 1953	Operation Ajax removed Mohammed Mosaddegh as Prime Minister of Iran and gave Shah Mohammad Reza Pahlavi direct control
September 7, 1953	Nikita Khrushchev was elected First Secretary of Communist Party in the USSR

December 23, 1953	Former NKVD chief and possible successor to Stalin, Lavrenti Beria was executed
March 13, 1954	KGB was created to replace NKVD
May 7, 1954	French forces were defeated at the Battle of Dien Bien Phu
June 18, 1954	Guatemalan President Jacobo Árbenz was removed from power in CIA-backed coup
July 21, 1954	Geneva Accords were signed separating Vietnam into North and South sectors
August 11, 1954	Taiwan Strait Crisis began with the PRC shelling ROC islands
December 2, 1954	ROC and US sign Sino-American Mutual Defense Treaty
April 18-24, 1955	Asia-Africa Conference was hosted in Bandung, Indonesia
May 9, 1955	West Germany joined NATO
May 11, 1955	Warsaw Pact was founded amongst Soviet allies
July 18, 1955	Geneva Summit was held between the Big Four (US, UK, USSR, and France)
November 22, 1955	USSR completed first successful hydrogen bomb test
February 25, 1956	Khrushchev delivered his "Secret Speech" to the 20th Party Congress
June 28, 1956	Poznań protests and strikes took place in Poland
July 26, 1956	Nasser nationalized the Suez Canal in Egypt after the US pulled aid for the Aswan Dam project
October 23 - November 11, 1956	Hungarian Revolution against Soviet influence ended by USSR forces
October 29 - November 7, 1956	Suez Crisis took place after invasion by Israel, UK, and France
December 2, 1956	Fidel Castro landed in Cuba to begin revolution

June 18, 1957	Attempted coup to replace Khrushchev failed
October 4, 1957	Sputnik, the first man-made satellite was launched by the USSR
1958-1962	Great Leap Forward economic programs took place in the PRC
January 31, 1958	Explorer I launched by the US
August 23, 1958	Second Taiwan Strait Crisis began
January 1, 1959	Fulgencio Batista fled Cuba allowing Castro's revolutionary government to take power
July 24, 1959	Vice President Richard Nixon and Khrushchev took part in the "Kitchen Debate" at Moscow exhibition
September 15-27, 1959	Khrushchev visited the US including Hollywood, but is angered by not being able to visit Disneyland
February 16, 1960	France successfully completed Gerboise Bleue, the test of its first atomic bomb
May 1, 1960	U-2 Incident began after Gary Powers was shot down over USSR
August 6, 1960	Castro nationalized US companies and the Eisenhower responded with an embargo
February 1, 1961	Anti-colonial forces in Angola began attacks on Portuguese control
April 12, 1961	Soviet cosmonaut Yuri Gagarin became the first human to enter space and orbit the Earth
April 17, 1961	US-backed Bay of Pigs invasion began and was quickly defeated by Cuban forces
June 4, 1961	Vienna Summit between President John Kennedy and Khrushchev takes place
July 19, 1961	Sandinista National Liberation Front (FSLN) was founded to remove General Anastasio Somoza from power in Nicaragua
August 13, 1961	Berlin Wall construction was begun to close off East Berlin from Western access
October 27, 1961	US forces in Berlin came face-to-face with Soviet tanks at Checkpoint Charlie before crisis was defused

October 30, 1961	Tsar Bomb was detonated yielding a record 50 megaton explosion
October 16-29, 1962	Cuban Missile Crisis brought the world to the brink of nuclear conflict
January 23, 1963	Kim Philby defected to the USSR
June 16, 1963	Valentina Tereshkova of the USSR became the first woman in space
June 26, 1963	Kennedy delivered "Ich Bin Ein Berliner Speech"
August 5, 1963	Limited Nuclear Test Ban Treaty was signed in Moscow
November 2, 1963	President Ngo Dinh Diem of South Vietnam was assassinated in a coup supported by the US
August 4, 1964	Gulf of Tonkin Incident took place off the coast of North Vietnam
October 14, 1964	Leonid Brezhnev led a coup that replaced Khrushchev as General Secretary
October 16, 1964	China successfully tested its first atomic bomb
March 10, 1966	President Charles de Gaulle withdrew French military from NATO command
June 5, 1967	Six Day War began with Israel's invasion into the Sinai Peninsula
October 9, 1967	Ernesto "Che" Guevara was executed by the Bolivian military
January 5, 1968	Alexander Dubček was elected First Secretary of Czech Communist Party and began reforms
January 30, 1968	Tet Offensive began in South Vietnam
July 1, 1968	Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty was signed in Moscow
August 21, 1968	Warsaw Pact troops invaded Czechoslovakia to end Prague Spring reforms
March 2, 1969	Border skirmishes between the USSR and the PRC in Manchuria began

March 17, 1969	US began bombing operations in Cambodia
July 20, 1969	Apollo 11 Mission successfully landed US astronauts on the Moon for the first time
July 25, 1969	President Richard Nixon began withdrawing US troops and the process of Vietnamization
September 2, 1969	Ho Chi Minh died at the age of 79
August 12, 1970	West Germany and the USSR signed the Treaty of Moscow normalizing relations
October 24, 1970	Salavador Allende was confirmed as president of Chile despite US attempts to keep him from office
October 25, 1971	The PRC was recognized as the true representative government of China over the ROC in Taiwan - PRC assumed control over its seat on the UN Security Council
February 21, 1972	Nixon became the first US President to visit China
May 22, 1972	Nixon became the first US President to visit the USSR as part of the Moscow Summit
May 26, 1972	Nixon and Brezhnev signed SALT I and ABM arms limitations agreements
January 27, 1973	Paris Peace Accords were signed ending US direct military involvement in Vietnam
September 11, 1973	Allende was removed from power by a military coup led by Augusto Pinochet in Chile; Allende committed suicide during the coup
October 6-25, 1973	Yom Kippur War took place after Egypt and allies attacked Israel
September 1, 1974	US and East Germany began diplomatic recognition
September 12, 1974	Derg took control of Ethiopia in a coup
April 18, 1975	Pol Pot's Khmer Rouge took power in Cambodia
April 30, 1975	Saigon fell to North Vietnamese forces ending the conflict and uniting Vietnam into one nation the next year
July 15, 1975	Space Race symbolically ended with the Apollo-Soyuz joint mission

August 1, 1975	Conference on Security and Co-Operation in Europe's Final Act known as the Helsinki Accords were signed
November 11, 1975	Angolan Civil War began between communist and western-backed forces after Portugal withdrew forces and independence was declared
November 25, 1975	Operation Condor began in South America
January 8, 1976	Chinese Foreign Minister Zhou Enlai dies at age 77
September 9, 1976	Mao died at age 82
January 1, 1977	Charter 77 was signed protesting the government in Czechoslovakia
July 23, 1977	Ogaden War began after Somalia invaded Ethiopia
March 15, 1978	Ogaden War ceasefire was declared
April 27, 1978	Communist coup in Afghanistan killed autocratic president Mohammad Daoud Khan
December 18, 1978	Deng Xiaoping began Open Door Policy in China
December 25, 1978	Vietnam invaded neighboring Cambodia to oust Pol Pot
January 7, 1979	People's Republic of Kampuchea declared in Cambodia
January 16, 1979	Shah of Iran was deposed as a result of the Iranian Revolution; Ayatollah Khomeini became Supreme Leader of Islamic Republic of Iran
February 17, 1979	Sino-Vietnamese War began with an invasion by the Chinese Army
May 4, 1979	UK elected Margaret Thatcher as its first ever female Prime Minister
May 9, 1979	Salvadoran Civil War began
June 2, 1979	Pope John Paul II visited Poland
June 18, 1979	SALT II was signed by President Jimmy Carter and Brezhnev

July 17, 1979	Sandinistas successfully gained control of Nicaragua from Anastasio "Tachito" Somoza Debayle
November 4, 1979	Iranian students took over the US Embassy in Tehran and took 52 Americans hostage beginning a crisis lasting for 444 days
December 24, 1979	Forces from the USSR invaded Afghanistan three months after the pro-communist president was assassinated
January 3, 1980	Carter withdrew SALT II from the Senate
March 21, 1980	Carter announced US boycott of the Moscow Summer Olympic Games; some allies joined to protest the Afghan invasion
May 4, 1980	Tito died at the age of 87
August 31, 1980	Gdańsk Agreement was signed in Poland allowing greater autonomy for unions and beginning the Solidarity Movement
December 18, 1980	Aleksei Kosygin died at age 76
October 6, 1981	Anwar Sadat was assassinated in Egypt
December 13, 1981	Wojciech Jaruzelski became leader of the Polish United Workers Party and declared martial law
November 10, 1982	Brezhnev died at age 75 and was replaced by Yuri Andropov
March 8, 1983	President Ronald Reagan called USSR an "evil empire" in speech to evangelicals
March 21, 1983	Strategic Defense Initiative (SDI) was announced and was derided as "Star Wars"
September 1, 1983	KAL Flight 007 was shot down by a Soviet fighter while off course over Kamchatka
September 26, 1983	Soviet Lt. Col. Stanislav Petrov avoided a nuclear confrontation by ignoring a false report of incoming missiles from the US
October 25, 1983	US. invades Grenada
November 2-11, 1983	Operation Able Archer 83 war games by NATO were interpreted as preparation for invasion and put Warsaw forces on high alert
February 13, 1984	Konstantin Chernenko became Secretary General of the Communist Party in the USSR

May 24, 1984	Boland Amendment was passed banning US aid to the Contras
July 28, 1984	USSR and some allies boycotted the Los Angeles Summer Olympic Games
December 16, 1984	Thatcher met with Mikhail Gorbachev and announced "we can do business together"
March 10, 1985	Chernenko died at age 73 leading to Gorbachev taking reigns of government
November 21, 1985	Reagan and Gorbachev held first summit in Geneva, Switzerland
April 26, 1986	Chernobyl nuclear reactor meltdown occurred
October 11, 1986	Reykjavik Summit took place discussing major nuclear limitations
November 3, 1986	Iran-Contra Scandal broke
December 8, 1987	Intermediate Range Nuclear Forces Treaty (INF) was signed in Washington DC
May 15, 1988	USSR began withdrawing troops from Afghanistan
May 29, 1988	Reagan met Gorbachev in Moscow and stated he no longer believed the USSR was an "evil empire"
December 7, 1988	Gorbachev spoke at the UN and stated the USSR would no longer interfere with Eastern Europe
January 19, 1989	Solidarity was legalized again in Poland
February 15, 1989	Last Soviet troops withdrew from Afghanistan
June 4, 1989	Tiananmen Square Massacre took place in Beijing
June 4, 1989	Solidarity candidates won every contested seat in Polish parliament
August 19, 1989	Hungary opened their border with neutral Austria allowing for movement of people out of the GDR
October 18, 1989	Erich Honecker was forced to resign in GDR

November 9, 1989	Berlin Wall began to come down after border crossings were resumed
November 10, 1989	Todor Zhivkov was removed from power in Bulgaria
November 17, 1989	Velvet Revolution in Czechoslovakia ended one-party rule
December 3, 1989	Gorbachev and President George H.W. Bush held summit at Malta bringing a symbolic end to the Cold War hostilities between their two countries
December 16-25, 1989	Nicolae Ceausescu was removed from power and then executed in Romania after widespread riots
December 29, 1989	Vaclav Havel was elected President of Czechoslovakia
March 11, 1990	Democracy was restored in Chile
March 11, 1990	Lithuania declared independence
June 12, 1990	Russia led by Boris Yeltsin declared its sovereignty from the USSR
October 3, 1990	East and West Germany were reunited as a single country
October 15, 1990	Gorbachev was awarded the Nobel Peace Prize
July 1, 1991	Warsaw Pact was dissolved
July 31, 1991	START I Treaty was ratified
August 19-22, 1991	Coup was attempted against Gorbachev while he vacationed away from Moscow
August 24, 1991	Ukraine declared independence
August-December 1991	All former Soviet republics followed suit and declared independence from the USSR and some areas of Russia began unrest seeking independence
December 25, 1991	Gorbachev resigned as President of the USSR and the next day the Soviet Union was officially dissolved

KEY TERMS

Individuals:

Konrad Adenauer - First chancellor of West Germany (Federal Republic of Germany) from 1949-1963. Christian Democrat politician known for staunch anticommunism and working closely with the US, he helped develop NATO and solidify European cooperation.

Salvador Allende - First socialist president of Chile from 1970-1973. He was elected as a candidate for the Popular Unity bloc of leftwing groups after several unsuccessful attempts. Despite controlling the most members in Congress, he was overthrown and died during a US-backed coup led by the military under Augusto Pinochet on September 11, 1973.

Aldrich Ames - CIA analyst from 1962 to 1994. He was arrested as a double agent for Russia. He was responsible for identifying spies in the US during the Cold War, but received nearly \$3 million from the USSR/Russia to reveal the name of all US agents in the Soviet Union.

Yuri Andropov - Head of the KGB from 1967-1982 and general secretary of the Communist Party in the USSR from 1982 until his death in 1984. He was part of the Soviet invasion of Czechoslovakia as Ambassador in 1956. He was known for repression as the KGB head and succeeded Brezhnev briefly as leader of the USSR.

Jacobo Árbenz - President of Guatemala from 1951-1954 who sought to continue and extend progressive policies. The former officer's land reforms angered the powerful United Fruit Company and the US alleged he was under the influence of communists at home and abroad. The CIA supported a coup against him and after the military renounced him he resigned on June 27, 1954 and eventually went into exile.

Bernard Baruch - Presidential advisor to Wilson, FDR, and Truman. He helped popularize the term Cold War and was the first representative of the US at the UN Atomic Energy Commission where he proposed international cooperation and joint control of atomic weapons and energy.

Lavrenti Beria - Director of the NKVD (Soviet secret police) from 1938 to his death in 1953. He rose up the ranks in Stalin's government during WWII and after Stalin's death in March 1953, he temporarily led the USSR as one of four deputy prime ministers. He attempted to replace Stalin as the only true leader, but Khrushchev and others orchestrated a coup that resulted in his execution.

Ernest Bevin - Minister of Labour (1940-45) under Winston Churchill during WWII and foreign secretary under Clement Atlee (1945-51) for the start of the Cold War in the UK. He was an architect of the Brussels Treaty and facilitated US and European military, political, and financial ties to counter communist influence.

George Blake - British diplomat and MI-6 officer that became a double agent for the USSR. He secretly defected while a POW in North Korea and was arrested in 1961. He was sentenced to 42 years in prison for giving the Soviets names of hundreds of agents, but he escaped in 1966 and lived in Russia until his death over 50 years later.

Willy Brandt - Leader of the Social Democratic Party of Germany. He served as Mayor of West Berlin (1957-66) during some of the most tense times for the city during the Cold War. He became the Chancellor of Germany (1969-74) and was awarded the Nobel Peace Prize in 1971 for his Ostpolitik that created treaties with the Eastern bloc and helped settle lingering issues from WWII.

Leonid Brezhnev - Leader of the USSR from 1964 after helping to force Khrushchev into retirement. He would continue to be the de facto leader as first secretary/general secretary of the Communist Party until his death in 1982. He would be the only Soviet leader to be chair of the party and the Presidium of the Supreme Soviet. He oversaw the invasion of Czechoslovakia to deter liberalization, but also led détente efforts in the 1970s to normalize relations with the West.

Carlos Castillo Armas - President of Guatemala from 1954 to 1957 after being installed by a US and United Fruit Company-backed coup. He used the military to control the country, remove progressive reforms of his predecessors, and crackdown on any suspected communist activities. He was assassinated by a member of the presidential guard in 1957.

Fidel Castro - Leader of Cuba from 1959 to 2008. He led a nationalist revolution beginning in 1953 which eventually overthrew the dictator Fulgencio Batista on January 1, 1959. Castro would turn his 26th of July Movement into a revolutionary government that sought to throw off US business and political domination. He eventually turned to Marxism and became a Soviet ally in 1960. He allowed Soviet nuclear missiles to be placed in Cuba after the unsuccessful Bay of Pigs invasion supported by the US. He would push for aggressive military action by the Soviets, but was ultimately disappointed by their capitulation and the removal of the missiles. He strengthened his military and provided aid to other revolutions in Angola and Ethiopia and acted independently of the USSR despite their support. He maintained leadership of his communist government, despite the collapse of the USSR, until he transferred control to his brother Raúl beginning in 2006 and permanently in 2008.

Nicolae Ceaușescu - Leader of Romania as general secretary from 1965 and president of the State Council from 1967 until his execution in 1989. He practiced a more Stalinist style of government that was often at odds with Moscow due to differing ideas on cooperation and foreign relations. His authoritarian rule was overthrown in 1989 and he and his wife were tried and executed by the military within days of their attempt to flee.

Chiang Kai-Shek - Leader of a somewhat unified China under the Nationalist KMT beginning in 1928 until he was forced to abandon the mainland in 1949. Despite using Soviet support early on, he renounced it and removed all communists from his party in 1927 and a state of civil war existed through WWII after which Mao's communist forces eventually triumphed. He moved his government to Taiwan and with US aid created an authoritarian, but economically developed nation still claiming to rightfully be called China.

Konstantin Chernenko - Leader of the Soviet Union from February 1984 until his death in March 1985. Despite being seen as an heir to Brezhnev in the 1970s, his health was rapidly failing by the time he gained control of the Soviet government and it robbed him of the ability to make an impact.

Winston Churchill - Prime Minister of the UK from 1940-45 and 1951-55. Churchill was one of the architects of the post-war spheres of influence in Europe and one of the “Big Three” at the Yalta Conference that helped set the stage for the Cold War. He famously delivered his “Iron Curtain Speech” in Missouri in 1946 at the behest of President Truman. He would return as PM during the Korean War and cede leadership of the Western camp more to the US while working for greater European military cooperation. He helped convince the US to back a 1953 coup in Iran and he authorized the UK’s creation of its own hydrogen weapons.

Lucius D. Clay - US Army officer and first director of civilian affairs in Germany after World War II before becoming commander in chief of US forces in Europe in 1947. He oversaw the Allied airlift of Berlin in 1948-49 before retiring. In 1961, he was brought back to act as a special envoy for President Kennedy in West Berlin after the Berlin Wall was built and oversaw the standoff at Checkpoint Charlie during the Berlin Crisis of 1961.

Charles De Gaulle - French leader who acted as Chair of the Provisional French Government after World War II until 1946 to reestablish the French Republic. He was appointed PM in 1958 and started the Fifth Republic as President in 1959 and served until 1969. He was often at odds with NATO powers seeking to maintain French autonomy in colonial, nuclear, and pan-European affairs. He worked to restore relations with Germany and sought to limit the influence of the US and the UK over Europe.

Deng Xiaoping - Influential leader of the PRC from its revolutionary beginnings through most of the Cold War. He was the de facto leader of China from 1978 to 1989 and rapidly modernized the economy after the death of Mao (1976). He was sidelined during the Cultural Revolution as a capitalist traitor, but after becoming the head of the Communist Party he instituted market reforms and improved relations with the West. He made some political reforms, but ended them after eventually ordering an attack on democratic protestors at Tiananmen Square in 1989.

Anatoly Dobrynin - Soviet Ambassador to the US from 1962-1986. He served under every president from Kennedy to Reagan and every Soviet leader from Khrushchev to Gorbachev including an active role in the tense negotiations during the Cuban Missile Crisis.

Alexander Dubček - First Secretary of the Communist Party of Czechoslovakia from 1968-1969 during the Prague Spring. Dubček instituted political reforms and liberalizations in the country before a Warsaw Pact invasion led to him being taken to Moscow and forced to curtail his actions. He was eventually demoted and then removed from the party. He would return to politics after the fall of communist control in 1989.

Allen Dulles - Director of the CIA from 1953-1961 before being removed for the failure of the Bay of Pigs invasion. He was the brother of Secretary of State John Foster Dulles and his powerful connections helped him mold the mission of the CIA from its inception. Under his administration, the Agency undertook coups in Iran and Guatemala and oversaw the U-2 surveillance program.

John Foster Dulles - US Secretary of State during the Eisenhower administration. He served as a diplomat under Truman and helped set up the UN in 1945 and create the formal peace agreement with Japan in 1950. He helped bolster NATO and conceived of SEATO and CENTO. He was an untiring opponent of communism in general and specifically believed the USSR was bent on global domination. His resoluteness in his opinions led to controversies with European allies and non-aligned nations and the support of anti-democratic measures to counter communist movements.

Klaus Fuchs - Nuclear physicist who fled from Germany to England due to communist connections in 1933. He worked on behalf of the UK in the Manhattan Project at Los Alamos, but passed on secret information to the USSR. He was arrested in England in 1950 and released in 1959. He moved to the GDR to be part of their nuclear research efforts.

Costas Georgiou - Greek-Cypriot mercenary and former British paratrooper also known as Colonel Callan during the Angolan Civil War. He fought on behalf of the FNLA against the MPLA and was dubbed a "psychopathic killer" in the press for his brutality to his own troops as well as enemies. He was captured, tried for numerous murders, and executed in 1976.

Władysław Gomułka - Polish leader who began as a resistance fighter against the Nazi occupation during WWII before working with the Soviet-backed Lublin Committee. He became the First Secretary of the Polish United Workers' Party after protesters in the country demanded reforms in 1956. He was responsible for the Polish Thaw that ended in the mid-sixties when he began to enforce more repressive measures. He normalized relations with Germany in 1970, but was forced to resign due to mounting economic difficulties in the country.

Mikhail Gorbachev - General Secretary of the Communist Party in the USSR from 1985 to 1991. He was the final leader of the Soviet Union and through his reformist policies of glasnost and perestroika tried to modernize the country while moving it away from the stultifying politics of the Cold War. His break with the Brezhnev Doctrine allowed for the collapse of the Eastern Bloc via support for popular self-determination and facilitated the end of the Cold War. He received the Nobel Peace Prize in 1990.

Oleg Gordievsky - Colonel of the Soviet KGB and bureau chief in London. From 1974 until leaving the USSR in 1985, he acted as a double agent for the UK's MI6. He was eventually betrayed by US double agent Aldrich Ames.

Klement Gottwald - Premier (1946-48) then President (1948-53) of Czechoslovakia. In 1948, he used the support of the USSR to force out President Beneš and create a Stalinist style regime under his control until his death after becoming ill at Stalin's funeral.

Andrei Gromyko - Soviet foreign minister (1957-1985) for most of the Cold War. He served as Soviet ambassador to the US (1943-46) and then representative to the UN Security Council. He also served briefly as ambassador to the UK before using his extensive knowledge of the West to be appointed deputy and then head of the Foreign Ministry. He would remain in his position until a shake up of Communist Party leadership under Gorbachev.

Ernesto Guevara - Marxist revolutionary known as “Che” that helped lead guerilla resistance efforts in Cuba and other countries. Che was an Argentine medical student that was radicalized by the poverty and exploitation he witnessed while traveling through Latin America in the early 1950s. He tried to support Árbenz before his overthrow in Guatemala in 1954 and then met Fidel Castro in Mexico and joined his invasion of Cuba in 1956. After the success of the revolution in 1959, Che became a leader in the Castro regime and began writing about revolutionary tactics for other people in Latin America. He left Cuba in 1965 and eventually led a band of guerillas in Bolivia in 1966. He was captured with the aid of CIA advisors and executed.

Ho Chi Minh - Founder of the Indochina Communist Party in 1930 and the Viet-Minh in 1941, who became president of the Democratic Republic of Vietnam (1945-1969). Born as Nguyen Sunh Cung in what was then Annam, he led the independence movement against the French then Japanese then French occupiers until the 1954 Geneva Convention. He ceded party authority in North Vietnam to Le Duan and others by the early 1960s, but retained influence on the efforts to support Viet Cong activities in South Vietnam seeking to force reunification under communist rule until his death in 1969.

Erich Honecker - Leader of East Germany (GDR) (1971-1989) through the 70s until the fall of the Berlin Wall. He was able to create a relatively successful economy compared to other Eastern Bloc nations, but did so with a severely authoritarian regime. He was forced out due to growing democratic protests and the loss of support from Gorbachev. He would be charged with abuses of power before being allowed to leave for Chile in 1993 due to ill health.

Enver Hoxa - Leader of communist Albania from the end of WWII until his death in 1985. Albania was a member of the Eastern Bloc, but acted independently of Moscow with Hoxa creating one of the most repressive governments in the world. He was a Stalinist, but aligned more with China, before completely isolating his government from the greater socialist movement.

Wojciech Jaruzelski - Last leader of communist Poland, he controlled the country as a military dictator beginning in 1981. Jaruzelski was a general who became premier in 1981 and president in 1989. Shortly after becoming premier, he declared martial law and banned the Solidarity Movement. He allowed reforms beginning in 1989 in an effort to save the failing economy. He was replaced as president by the election of Lech Walesa and later tried for crimes under his leadership, but ultimately escaped punishment due to ill health.

George Kennan - Leading diplomat, scholar, and policy advisor for the US during the beginning of the Cold War. He articulated the policy of containment via his “Long Telegram” and other writings and lectures. He served as US ambassador to the USSR in 1952 and to Yugoslavia from 1952-53.

Helmut Kohl - Chancellor of West Germany (FRG) (1982-1998) that oversaw the reunification of Germany. He served longer as leader of Germany than anyone since World War II.

Nikita Khrushchev - Leader of the USSR from 1953 to 1964 as First Secretary of the Communist Party. He was able to outmaneuver rivals to take over after the death of Stalin and moved forward with de-Stalinization efforts known as the “thaw.” He saw the USSR through the launch of Sputnik, the U-2 incident, the Cuban Missile Crisis, and numerous efforts to develop ties with post-colonial countries. He attempted to reform both the economy and society, but later pulled back from some liberalization. His reforms alienated Mao and other hardliners and he was forced into retirement in late 1964.

Kim Il Sung - Founder and head of the Democratic People’s Republic of Korea (North Korea) (1948-1994). Kim operated as a near defied dictator that established a hereditary rule after WWII. He tried to reunify the Korean peninsula under his control in the Korean War (1950-53), but was unable to defeat South Korea before US and UN forces arrived. A state of war still exists and North Korea became a hermit kingdom with few connections to the outside world save for the USSR and China.

Henry Kissinger - Diplomat and advisor for US presidents Nixon and Ford who was a foreign policy specialist during the 70s and 80s. He served concurrently as National Security Advisor (1969-75) and Secretary of State (1973-77) for a short time and in both offices separately. He is credited with championing détente between the US and their Cold War adversaries the USSR and the PRC. He received the Nobel Peace Prize (1973) for negotiating the US withdrawal from Vietnam, but was also known for propping up authoritarian regimes responsible for atrocities and genocide.

Aleksei Kosygin - Soviet statesman who served as premier (1964-80) and used his understanding of government and economics to remain in the upper leadership of the USSR from Stalin’s death until his own in 1980. He was part of the triumvirate that replaced Khrushchev in 1964, but lost out to Brezhnev due to his efforts at economic reform.

Le Duc Tho - Military, political, and diplomatic leader of Vietnam that received the Nobel Peace Prize (1973) for negotiating the withdrawal of US troops from the Vietnam conflict. Born Phan Dinh Khai, he helped found the Indochinese Communist Party along with Ho Chi Minh and fought to end French colonial rule. He oversaw the Viet Cong efforts to unseat the US backed government in South Vietnam. He later helped coordinate the successful defeat of South Vietnam (1975) and invasion of Cambodia (1978).

Curtis LeMay - Chief of Staff of the US Air Force (1961-65) and commander of the Strategic Air Command (1947-57). LeMay oversaw the crippling of Japan through firebombing during WWII and continued to be a leading advocate in aggressive bombing plans during the Cold War. He helped create the strategic bombing force for the US nuclear arsenal and famously pushed for an invasion of Cuba during the missile crisis. After retirement, he ran as the vice presidential candidate under segregationist governor George Wallace.

Patrice Lumumba - First prime minister of the Democratic Republic of Congo (1960). Lumumba had fought for the independence of Belgian Congo and the former colonial government tried to keep him from rising to power. After independence, his government was subverted by Belgian interests which supported the secession of the uranium-rich Katanga province. Lumumba reached out to the USSR after the UN would not help stop the secession. He also reached out to other newly independent African nations. His rivals in the DRC government tried to remove him from power and during the struggle, Joseph Mobutu successfully led a coup. Lumumba was arrested and eventually executed in January 1961 by Belgian troops in Katanga.

Madame Nhu - Commonly known as the First Lady of South Vietnam (1955-1963), she was the wife of Ngo Dinh Nhu and sister-in-law of President Ngo Dinh Diem. Born Tran Le Xuan, she stoked controversy for ostentatious habits and her verbal attacks on Buddhists in her country.

Georgi Malenkov - Prominent politician in the USSR who briefly took the lead of the Communist Party after the death of Stalin. He held the position of chairman of the Council of Ministers and party secretary, but was outmaneuvered by Khrushchev for dominance. He worked with Khrushchev to reform industry and agriculture, but was eventually marginalized. In 1957, he attempted a coup against Khrushchev and was removed from the Communist Party.

Mao Zedong - Founder of the People's Republic of China and leader until his death in 1976. He was a supporter of the Chinese Communist Party (CCP) as a young man and became the leader in 1935 during the Chinese Civil War. He would agree to work with the KMT to defeat Japan during WWII and then continue the civil war. He used the power of peasant uprisings and mass movements to win control of China and to maintain an ideological cult of personality for most of his reign. He favored Stalinist-style rule and was fanatically devoted to communism. He attempted to modernize the Chinese economy with the Great Leap Forward (1958-62) and maintain societal focus on national goals and adherence to communism with the Cultural Revolution beginning in 1966. He would break with the USSR, eventually becoming hostile, after Stalin's death due to what he saw as revisionist communism during Khrushchev's thaw. This break led to an opportunity for rapprochement with the US in the 1970s.

Margaret Thatcher - First female and longest serving prime minister of the UK (1979-1990) since 1827. She was known as the "Iron Lady" for her Cold War leadership style. She worked closely as a staunch anti-communist with President Reagan economically, politically, and militarily, but she eventually worked well with Soviet leader Mikhail Gorbachev in seeking a thaw.

George Marshall - General and chief of staff of the US Army during WWII and Secretary of State (1947-49) and Defense (1950-51) during the early Cold War. He was responsible for creating what became known as the Marshall Plan (European Recovery Program) to stabilize economies in Europe and to forestall communist governments from taking hold. He was awarded the Nobel Peace Prize in 1953 for his efforts.

Jan Masaryk - Foreign Minister of Czechoslovakia for the government in exile during WWII and then in the post-war government. He wanted his nation to accept Marshall Plan funds and not be a client-state to the USSR. He was one of the few government officials to retain his post after the communist takeover in February of 1948, but died the next month in a suspicious fall from his apartment window.

Suzanne Massie - Advisor to President Reagan in dealing with the USSR during negotiations. She was a leading Russian historian in the US and acted as a go between for Reagan and Gorbachev. She is credited with increasing Reagan's understanding of the USSR and its culture which aided in ending the Cold War.

Robert McNamara - US Secretary of Defense (1961-68) under presidents Kennedy and Johnson. He used his experience as a pragmatic technocrat and leader of Ford Motor Company to reform the military's operations. He was a key advisor during the Cuban Missile Crisis and originally supported extensive US involvement in Vietnam. He began to discuss a peace option by 1965 and his research into the details of US actions in Southeast Asia led to the Pentagon Papers. He later became the president of the World Bank (1968-81) and wrote extensively on the Cold War and foreign relations.

Erich Mielke - Head of the East German Ministry for State Security (Stasi) (1957-89). He was known as the "Master of Fear" and made the Stasi an almost omnipresent force in the GDR during the Cold War commanding over 250,000 spies and informants in a country of around 17 million. He was eventually imprisoned in 1990 for his actions during the Cold War and released in 1995 after being deemed mentally unfit.

Golda Meir - First female prime minister of Israel (1969-74). She served as the Minister of Labor after Israel's founding (1949-56) before becoming the Minister of Foreign Affairs until 1966. She was seen as one of the founders of the state and led the country during the Yom Kippur War (1973).

Vyacheslav Molotov - Minister of Foreign Affairs for the USSR (1939-49 and 1953-56). Originally named Skryabin, he was a close ally and the key diplomat for Stalin during WWII and the beginning of the Cold War. He also served as the Chairman of the Council of People's Commissars (1930-41) and was part of the troika that led the USSR following Stalin's death. He was removed from leadership after attempting a coup against Khrushchev in 1957 and sent to Mongolia as an ambassador.

Mohammad Mosaddegh - Iranian Prime Minister (1951-53) that was removed in a US/UK-backed coup. His government had attempted economic and land reforms including nationalization that threatened western ownership of Iran's vast oil resources. He was painted by British interests as being likely to turn to communism and the US supported putting the Shah back in power. He was arrested for treason and died under house arrest in 1967.

Imre Nagy - Premier of Hungary (1953-56) known for progressive views despite being a long time member of the Communist Party. He was drafted by the growing revolutionary movement to replace the pro-Soviet government in October of 1956. Though he still called for a socialist government he tried to withdraw the country from the Warsaw Pact and was rebuked by Moscow with an invasion by the Red Army. He was arrested and tried in Romania before being executed in 1958.

Gamal Abdel Nasser - President of Egypt (1954-1970) that navigated his country through the Cold War as a leader of the Non-Aligned Movement. Nasser started as a military officer that helped overthrow King Farouk in 1952 and then replaced the leader of the coup, Mohamed Naguib, to become president. He angered Britain and France by nationalizing the administration of the Suez Canal, but was able to gain support of both the US and the USSR to end the Suez Crisis in his favor. He continued to play the superpowers off each other as he sought to lead a pan-Arab movement. He resigned after the disastrous Six-Day War (1967), but was drafted back into office and remained in power until his death due to a heart attack.

Agostinho Neto - First president of independent Angola (1975-79) after leading the communist-backed MPLA against Portuguese colonizers and rival Angolan revolutionaries until his death from cancer. Agostinho was also an accomplished poet and supporter of the international communist movement. He used Soviet and Cuban support to keep his government in power despite Western-backed rival militias.

Ngo Dinh Diem - First President of South Vietnam (1955-63) after serving as the prime minister (1954-55). He was known for his autocratic rule and repression of Buddhists while he battled against communist forces within and outside of his country. He was known for corruption and his attacks on the Buddhist community eventually lost him the support of the US which implicitly supported a coup that resulted in his death in 1963.

Kwame Nkrumah - First president of Ghana (1960-66) and the Prime Minister of Ghana (1957-60) after it achieved complete independence from the UK and previously under its name the Gold Coast (1952-57) before that. He was a proponent of Pan-Africanism and helped found the Organization of African Unity. He used support from the USSR to modernize the economy, and became more authoritarian when challenged for power. He became president for life in 1964, but was overthrown in 1966 and lived in exile in Guinea.

Mohammad Reza Pahlavi - Shah of Iran (1941-1979) who led an authoritarian regime until being forced to flee during the Iranian Revolution (1979). He was first installed during WWII by an Allied invasion meant to keep his father from supplying the Germans with oil. He was marginalized by a more democratic government until a Western coup gave him complete authority beginning in 1953. He used Western support to modernize the country, but his secular rule and repression led to an uprising that resulted in his exile. He died due to complications from cancer the next year.

Oleg Penkovsky - Colonel in the Soviet Military Intelligence (GRU) (1953-63) that acted as a double-agent for the US and UK. Penkovsky was the highest ranking and probably most important double agent for the West until his arrest, trial, and execution by the USSR. The technical information he shared concerning Soviet missile capabilities was essential to US and NATO military planning.

Stanislav Petrov - Lieutenant Colonel in the Soviet Air Defense Force who was instrumental in avoiding a nuclear response by the Soviet Union in 1983. At a time of peak tensions between the USSR and US following the destruction of KAL Flight 007, Petrov was the duty officer at a detection site that received an alarm indicating a missile launch from the US approaching. He ignored protocol after interpreting the alarm as a mistake and avoided a retaliation by the USSR that could have led to a larger conflict.

Harold 'Kim' Philby - Intelligence officer for MI6 during WWII and the beginning of the Cold War that acted as a Soviet double agent. Philby had been an ideological communist who made connections with like-minded individuals at Cambridge University. He became a Soviet informer in 1933 as a journalist before entering British intelligence during the war. He served as MI-6's chief in the US and used his position to make the Soviets aware of Western agents and activities. He came under suspicion in 1951, but was able to flee to Moscow in 1963.

Augusto Pinochet - President of Chile (1974-90) that achieved his office by leading a US-supported military coup against Salvador Allende in 1973. He led a severely authoritarian regime that kidnapped, tortured, and executed thousands of political critics and leftists. He sought to legitimize his rule with an election in 1988, but was defeated. He was arrested in the UK for human rights crimes in 1998 and eventually stood trial in Chile beginning in 2004, but died two years later before his prosecution was complete.

Ernst Reuter - Mayor of West Berlin as leader of the Social Democratic Party during the Allied airlift (1948-49). He was elected in 1947 and took office in 1948 after the city was divided and served until his death in 1953.

Syngman Rhee - First president of South Korea (ROK)(1948-1960) and founder of the nation. He was a member of the Korean government in exile during Japanese colonial rule and WWII until he returned in 1945. He was elected president by the National Assembly of the Republic of Korea and sought unification of Korea under his rule. He refused to sign the armistice agreement after the Korean War in 1953 wanting to continue to seek reunification by force. He was a strong US ally and anti-communist, but used the military to suppress protests of his government. He was forced to resign and move into exile after his particularly brutal response to the student-led April Revolution in 1960.

Julius and Ethel Rosenberg - US married couple that were the first civilians executed for spying on behalf of the USSR, or during peacetime, in 1953. The information that was passed on regarded weapons and defense initiatives including nuclear bomb designs. Protests erupted in many parts of the world against their planned execution and years later exoneration efforts continued on behalf of Ethel.

Dean Rusk - US Secretary of State (1961-69) under presidents Kennedy and Johnson. He served longer than any head of the State Department except for FDR's Cordell Hull. He was a key advisor to Kennedy during his administration, especially during the Cuban Missile Crisis. He sought a diplomatic rather than military solution to the Crisis, but during Johnson's term he supported the escalation of US military involvement in Vietnam.

Anwar al-Sadat - President of Egypt (1970-81) who won the Nobel Peace Prize (1978) for his groundbreaking efforts to negotiate the recognition of Israel. He was part of the coup against the monarchy in 1952 and supported Nasser, becoming his vice president before being elected president after Nasser's death. He expelled Soviet advisors and sought peace with Israel before becoming frustrated at the continued occupation of the Sinai and leading the Yom Kippur War (1973). He worked with President Carter to negotiate peace with Israel through the Camp David Accords (1979). The agreement created protests in Egypt and in 1981, Sadat was assassinated while viewing a military parade.

Andrei Sakharov - Soviet nuclear physicist who won the Nobel Peace Prize (1975) for his human rights campaign in the USSR and beyond. He originally helped develop the nuclear weapons program for the USSR before becoming disillusioned with the totalitarian aspects of the government and the impacts of nuclear testing. He pushed for nuclear disarmament and spoke out against the treatment of other dissidents. He was exiled internally in 1980 before being allowed to return to Moscow in 1986.

Eduard Shevardnadze - Foreign Minister of the USSR (1985-90, 1991) and leader of an independent Georgia (1992-2003). Shevardnadze was instrumental in guiding the progressive policies of Gorbachev into foreign policy achievements that helped bring about the end of the Cold War. He oversaw the withdrawal from Afghanistan (1988), the INF Treaty (1987), and START I (1991), as well as the non-interference policy that allowed the break up of the Eastern bloc. He resigned in 1990 to protest anti-reform leaders gaining influence over Gorbachev.

Aleksandr Solzhenitsyn - Russian writer that won the Nobel Prize for Literature (1970). He was best known for his novel based on his experiences of living in the Gulag, *One Day in the Life of Ivan Denisovich*. His works remained popular overseas, but by the mid-sixties were repressed in the USSR. His publication of *The Gulag Archipelago* led to his arrest and exile in 1974. He was rehabilitated in 1990 and returned to Russia in 1994.

Anastasio Somoza Debayle - President of Nicaragua (1967-79) and the final of three Somozas to control the country dating back to 1933. He served as commander in chief of the army and assisted the US in attempts to intervene in Cuba and the Dominican. He improved the economy as president, but then repealed the Constitution in 1974 and ruled under martial law to fight against the Sandinista rebels. He resigned and fled after the US dropped their support for his regime in 1979, but was assassinated the next year in Paraguay.

Josef Stalin - Leader of the USSR from 1924 until his death in 1953. Born as Josif Dzhugashvili in Georgia, he adopted the name Stalin (steel) when he became a Bolshevik supporter. He became General Secretary in 1922 and used his control of the Communist Party to take control of the Soviet government as Lenin declined in health. He purged his rivals and millions of dissenters including those seen as anti-party in any way. He sought to take the lead in the international communist movement and to consolidate his power, but was taken by surprise by the German invasion of WWII. He allied with the West out of necessity, but by the close of the war he was already planning on creating a sphere of influence in Europe to protect the USSR from future attacks. He focused less on internationalism and more on becoming a self-sufficient state (socialism in one country) with client states as a buffer against

the West. He became increasingly paranoid about attacks from outside the country and plotters from within. The paranoia led to more repressive measures in the USSR and copy-cat style totalitarian systems in Eastern Europe. When he died of a stroke in 1953, a power struggle took place before he was denounced by the eventual leader of the USSR, Khrushchev, in 1956.

Valentina Tereshkova - First female to enter space and only female to ever fly solo in space aboard Vostok 6 (1963). She began her career as an amateur skydiver and joined the Air Force eventually becoming a major general before retiring in 1997 serving with distinction as a cosmonaut for the USSR. She became a member of the Duma in 2011 and is still in office.

Josip Broz Tito - Leader of the communist government in Yugoslavia from the end of Nazi occupation until his death in 1980. He adopted the moniker Tito in the 1930s as a communist writer after serving in the Austro-Hungarian army in WWI and being sent to Russia as a POW. He led the Partisan resistance against the German occupation during WWII and therefore was able to establish a communist party that was not dominated by the Soviets. He became prime minister in 1945, president in 1953, and in 1974 was named president for life. He created the Socialist Federal Republic of Yugoslavia and his unique approach to socialism led to Stalin kicking him and his government out of the Cominform (1948). He would be a co-founder of the Non-Aligned Movement and develop some relations with Western powers. His authoritarianism kept an extremely diverse set of regions together as a federation, but after his death and the fall of communism in Europe a decade of bloody ethnic-based independence movements would tear the country he created into pieces.

Walter Ulbricht - Leader that helped establish East Germany (GDR) (1949) as First Secretary of the Communist Socialist Unity Party (1950-71). He pushed for the creation of the Berlin Wall to stop the hemorrhaging of East German people into the West and used repressive Stalinist means to control the GDR until he was forced into retirement following successive failures at economic reform. He would die two years after being removed from office.

Lech Wałęsa - Leader of the Solidarity movement in Poland that won the Nobel Peace Prize (1983) for his attempts at reform. He was the first president of Poland (1990-95) elected by popular vote after he led the union-based agitation movement that helped bring down communist rule in the country. He started the movement as a union leader illegally striking against the government's low wages and intolerable work quotas. He originally won concessions before martial law was instituted in 1981 and he was imprisoned. He continued his work underground before successfully pressuring the government into permanent reforms in 1989.

Boris Yeltsin - First President of Russia after the collapse of the Soviet Union (1991-99). He was an influential member of the Communist Party that originally supported Gorbachev before becoming disillusioned by the slow pace of reform. He resigned from the Politburo in 1987 seeking democratic elections and became chair of the Russian Supreme Soviet (1990). He acted swiftly during the coup attempt against Gorbachev in 1990 to rally support against the coup while positioning himself as Gorbachev's savior and then superior. He pushed other states of the USSR to declare sovereignty and in

1991 after becoming the first ever democratically elected leader of Russia, he founded the Russian Federation effectively ending the USSR.

Zhou Enlai - Premier of the People's Republic of China (PRC) (1954-76) that led the country's foreign policy under the reign of Mao Zedong. He acted as foreign minister (1949-58) during the beginning of the Cold War formulating key relationships between fellow socialist countries as well as Non-Aligned nations including representing the PRC at the Bandung Conference (1955). He was instrumental in détente policies that led to normalization of relations between the PRC and the US. He was considered Mao's most likely successor and had been a lead decision maker when Mao stepped back from leadership after the Cultural Revolution, but his own ill-health led to him becoming less involved in the mid-seventies until his death in 1976.

Related Terms:

Attack on Vilnius - After the Lithuanian legislature declared independence on March 11, 1990, the USSR responded with military action on January 11-13, 1991, killing 14 civilians and injuring over a hundred more. The people were trying to keep Soviet troops from controlling the local TV tower and studio to hinder the independence movement. Gorbachev authorized no more military violence after the event.

Austrian neutrality (1955) - The USSR agreed to end post-war occupation along with the Western Allies in the State Treaty of May 15, 1955. It formally reestablished the Austrian republic with pre-1938 sovereignty and borders. Anschluss and restoration of the Habsburgs was forbidden and on October 26th, the day after all occupation forces withdrew a constitutional law of perpetual neutrality was passed.

Balkan Pact (1953) - (aka the Pact of Ankara, Balkan Entente, and the Balkan Union) Agreement between Greece, Turkey, and Yugoslavia to coordinate military actions of a defensive nature. It was seen as a deterrent to Soviet aggression in the region.

Baltic Way - Peaceful demonstration on August 23, 1989, across Lithuania, Latvia and Estonia where around two million people joined hands in a 600km human chain expressing their unity in the struggle for independence from the USSR.

Ban the Bomb Movement - Anti-nuclear movement that began in the UK to protest the installation of missile bases. It was also opposed to the construction of nuclear power plants. It grew as a pressure movement advocating for overall disarmament, the ending of nuclear testing, and the responsible disposal of nuclear waste.

Bandung Conference - (aka Asian-African Conference) Meeting in Indonesia held from April 18-24, 1955, between 29 countries invited by Indonesia, Myanmar, Sri Lanka, India, and Pakistan to discuss means of asserting their influence over policy in Asia and Africa. It condemned colonialism "in all of its manifestations" which was a rebuke of both Western and Soviet actions. It set the stage for the Non-Aligned Movement.

Basic Treaty (1972) - An agreement between West and East Germany that established recognition and economic trade between the two countries. It was an outgrowth of the Ostpolitik of Willy Brandt and cleared a path for both nations to gain admittance to the UN the following year.

Bay of Pigs Invasion - Unsuccessful US-backed invasion of Cuba by exiles opposed to the Castro regime that took place on April 17, 1961. The operation had been planned by the CIA during the Eisenhower administration and Director Allen Dulles convinced Kennedy to follow through. Kennedy feared the implications of the US supporting the effort and denied direct military and air support. The lack of support and the ill-founded belief that Cubans would rise up to support the invasion led to an internationally embarrassing failure.

Berlin Blockade - Soviet blockade of Western supplies into West Berlin starting on June 25, 1948 after the introduction of the deutsche mark in the newly unified Western Allied occupation zones of the capital. The next day, US and UK airships began supplying the city until the blockade was lifted without comment by the USSR on May 12, 1949. It was a crucial early face-off in the Cold War putting the importance of Berlin front and center.

Berlin Wall - Barrier built in August of 1961 that surrounded all of West Berlin to isolate it from East Germany. Millions of East Germans had left their country through West Berlin leading to severe labor shortages, especially amongst skilled and educated workers. The wall started as barbed wire and quickly grew into a series of walls and barriers manned by armed guards that killed anyone trying to cross illegally. The wall was opened on November 9, 1989 and was soon torn down symbolizing the fall of the authoritarian government in East Germany.

Bert the turtle - Mascot for the Federal Civilian Defense Administration's education effort about "duck and cover," a nuclear attack drill communicated to the public. The campaign was aimed at schoolchildren in 1951 to teach them to imitate the cartoon turtle's response to danger. It was used across the country to instill confidence in the chances of survival if a nuclear attack occurred.

Bikini Atoll - Land formation in the Ralik chain of the Marshall Islands in the central Pacific. It was used for nuclear testing by the US from 1946-58. It was the site of the first ever hydrogen bomb dropped by an airplane in 1956. The area is still too radioactive for inhabitants to return.

bomber gap - The purported lead by the USSR over the US in the number of strategic bombers capable of delivering nuclear bombs. This idea existed during the 1950s and early 60s in the US, but due to U-2 surveillance the government was aware that, in reality, the US had significant numerical superiority over the Soviets.

Bretton Woods Conference - Meeting in New Hampshire in July 1944 that created the structure for how the International Monetary Fund (IMF) and the International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD-later the World Bank) would stabilize global currencies and trade. These agreements would eventually set the stage for the US dollar to be the global reserve currency and rebuild and supercharge economies that received an influx of loans.

Brezhnev Doctrine - Policy of the USSR under Leonid Brezhnev that was articulated in 1968 in response to the Prague Spring. It stated that Soviet and Warsaw Pact forces could intervene in a member country where continued socialist rule was threatened.

Brussels Defense Pact - Treaty signed in 1948 by the UK, France, Belgium, the Netherlands, and Luxembourg to cooperate in the military defense of their nations. It laid the foundation for the creation of NATO and increased overall European cooperation and integration.

Cambodian-Vietnamese War - Conflict that technically lasted from 1978-1989 after Vietnam invaded its neighbor to topple the Khmer Rouge/Democratic Kampuchea under Pol Pot. Vietnam then established a friendly government called the People's Republic of Kampuchea. International pressure from both China and the US led to Vietnam's withdrawal in 1989.

Cambodian Coup (1970) - Prince Norodom Sihanouk was deposed by a vote of the Cambodian National Assembly on March 18th. Prime Minister Lon Nol helped orchestrate the coup, became the country's leader, and with US support tried to ban North Vietnamese troops from his country. This would lead to the Cambodian Civil War and lead to the Khmer Rouge controlling the country by 1975.

Cambridge spy ring - (aka Cambridge Five) UK spy ring that worked on behalf of the USSR from the 1930s to the 1950s. The members were all acquaintances at the exclusive British University of Cambridge and consisted of Donald Maclean, Guy Burgess, Kim Philby, John Cairncross, and Anthony Blunt. They procured and shared copious amounts of secret intel with their Soviet handlers, but were all eventually unmasked in embarrassing and destabilizing moments for British intelligence and their US partners.

Castle Bravo - A series of nuclear weapon tests by the US under the codename Operation Castle were started on March 1, 1954, with the Bravo detonation at Bikini Atoll. It was the most powerful nuclear detonation performed by the US. It had a 15 megaton yield despite it being predicted to be only 6 megatons. The unpredicted spread of the fallout affected the crew of the Lucky Dragon Number 5, a Japanese fishing vessel, and created widespread protests against atmospheric testing.

CENTO - (Central Treaty Organization, aka Baghdad Pact) Agreement between Turkey, Iran, the UK, Iraq, and Pakistan signed in 1955 that was originally known as the Middle East Treaty organization. The group was to provide mutual defense against possible Soviet aggression in the region. The US became an associate member after Iraq withdrew in 1959. It lasted in some form until Iran withdrew after the Revolution of 1979.

Charter 77 - Document created in Czechoslovakia in 1977 by Václav Havel and nearly 2,000 others that pushed for democratic reforms after a crackdown on dissent by the communist government. It called for the implementation of human rights guaranteed under the Helsinki Accords signed in 1975. Members of the group that produced it were jailed and persecuted.

Checkpoint Charlie/standoff 1961 - (aka the Berlin Crisis) A confrontation between US and USSR occupation forces in Berlin at the main crossing point between their respective sectors of control. Under their post-war agreement, US military personnel could pass into any zone, but two months after the creation of the Berlin Wall, East German and Soviet officials began trying to limit such travel. This led to a show of force by the US under General Clay where 10 US Army tanks faced off with 10 Soviet tanks on October 27th until the next day when the Soviet tanks retreated approximately 5 meters back. Their move was matched by the US forces and eventually both sides moved away from the checkpoint.

Chilean coup (1973) - Military overthrow of president Salvador Allende and his democratically elected government that was backed by the Nixon administration due to Allende's socialist-leaning policies. The coup was led by the Chilean Army under Augusto Pinochet on September 11th and resulted in the death of Allende and the establishment of authoritarian rule under Pinochet.

Church Committee - (aka the Senate Select Committee to Study Governmental Operations with Respect to Intelligence Activities) Congressional committee in 1975 headed by Senator Frank Church (D-ID) that investigated illegal activity by the FBI, CIA, and NSA including extrajudicial assassinations and coups. It led to the creation of congressional oversight of intelligence activities and a ban on assassinations.

Comecon - (aka Council for Mutual Economic Assistance) Economic aid organization started in 1949 to promote development in the Eastern bloc countries. It eventually spread to include other communist countries such as Mongolia and Cuba. It was a response to the Marshall Plan and sought to create more efficient trade amongst the countries that limited redundant production of materials that would increase competition. It was able to further integrate the socialist nations, but their diverse economies and a lack of cooperation made gains minimal.

Cominform - (aka Communist Information Bureau) International organization founded in 1947 that lasted until 1956. It was the heir to the pre-war Cominform and consisted of the communist organizations in Bulgaria, France, Italy, Hungary, Poland, Romania, Yugoslavia, and the USSR. It was meant to spread communist ideology and propaganda abroad to help the movement spread worldwide. It was disbanded as part of the post-Stalin thaw.

communism/democratic socialism/social democracy - Various forms of socialist political thought and theory. Generally, social democracy consists of efforts to further equalize democratic systems with socialist policies and institutions such as providing government services to all. Democratic socialism favors a transition to complete socialism or shared ownership of the means of production through democratic systems. Communism is a theoretical state of pure equality in a classless and moneyless society that is achieved by total government control of all factors of production that is often sought via a dictatorship of the proletariat that ostensibly moves society towards this goal using socialism.

containment policy - An approach to foreign policy by the US under the Truman administration inspired by George Kennan's 1947 articles on the USSR. The Truman Doctrine was the start of putting these ideas into practice by supplying the anti-communist efforts in Greece and Turkey in order to keep communism from spreading in the Mediterranean.

Cuban Missile Crisis - Standoff between the USSR and the US over the placement of nuclear weapons in Cuba that lasted from October 22-November 20, 1962. It began with the discovery of missile sites being built by U-2 flights and became the most tense moment of the Cold War as varying strategies by each side could have easily led to a nuclear exchange. The US imposed a quarantine around Cuba to keep further weapons from landing and in secret negotiations between the Kennedy administration and representatives of Khrushchev, they agreed to eventually withdraw NATO's nuclear weapons in Turkey and publicly promise to not invade Cuba. Khrushchev eventually agreed to these terms to the dismay of Castro. It weakened his position politically in the Soviet Union and was part of the reason for his removal from power two years later.

Cuban Revolution - A movement that was begun by Fidel Castro against the rule of Fulgencio Batista with an unsuccessful attack on Santiago on July 26, 1953. After his arrest and eventual exile to Mexico, Castro, his brother Raul, Che Guevara, and others invaded Cuba on December 2, 1956, and began a guerilla war. In 1958, the movement was buoyed by the end of US support for the Batista regime and gained wide-spread backing after Batista tried to rig the presidential election in favor of his ally. Castro's forces continued to make gains and by January 1, 1959, Batista was forced to flee. Castro arrived in the capital of Havana a week later and began removing, arresting, and executing Batista supporters. He sought to continue his revolutionary movement in other Latin American countries and his nationalization of US-owned companies and interests in Cuba led to an expansion of the US embargo. Castro consolidated his power from other members of the revolution and by 1960, claimed to have transformed the revolution into a Marxist movement.

Cultural Revolution - Initiative under Mao Zedong from 1966 to 1976, to focus more of China's cultural energy on his vision of communism and the national spirit. He wanted people to recommit to a single-minded focus on the communist revolution which had the effect of inspiring widespread attacks by mobilized youth groups called the Red Guards on anyone seen as elitist, intellectual, or unorthodox.

Czech coup (1948) - (aka the February Coup) The overtaking of the Czechoslovakian government in favor of a single-rule communist government. Klement Gottwald was the prime minister of the coalition government created by elections in 1946, but the Communist Party was losing support by 1948. The police and defense apparatus had been filled with communists and they began silencing critics with arrests and harassment. Stalin ordered Gottwald to begin purging other government offices of non-communists and on February 21st, many non-communist ministers resigned in protest. Gottwald forced President Benes to replace them with communists and a new constitution was in place by May, creating a people's democratic state with Gottwald as president.

Détente - An easing of tensions during the Cold War from the late-sixties to the late-seventies that was highlighted by Nixon's visit to China, the Helsinki Accords, and the SALT agreements. It fell out of favor in the US with those fearing Soviet human right abuses were being acquiesced to and the expansion of Soviet influence in Africa and other places was being overlooked. It ended with the Soviet invasion of Afghanistan.

Dien Bien Phu (1954) - Final major battle of the First Indochina War between Viet Minh and French colonial forces. The mountainous fortified location was supposed to supply the French with a base for last minute gains before peace negotiations, but resulted in a decisive defeat instead. The base was surrounded, cut-off, and overrun by May 7, 1954.

domino theory - foreign policy political belief adopted by the US in the Cold War that asserted the “fall to communism” of one country in a region would lead to others following suit. President Truman pushed the theory to support Greece and Turkey in the Mediterranean and it was used as justification for involvement in Vietnam and Southeast Asia.

Downwinders - People living in areas downwind of the Nevada Test Site such as residents in St. George, UT that suffered increased incidences of radiation-related illnesses. The Radiation Exposure Compensation Act of 1990 allowed some government compensation to these victims, but was limited to \$50,000 per person.

Dr. Strangelove - (or How I Learned to Stop Worrying and Love the Bomb) Film directed and co-written by Stanley Kubrick that was released in 1964. It was one of the first films to be included in the Library of Congress’s National Film Registry for its farcical look at the dangerous possibilities associated with Cold War tensions and mistrust.

East Berlin Revolt (1953) - Mass protests against harsh government work and production quotas without wage increases. Discontent bubbled over in June just months after the death of Stalin when some citizens expected reform, but were met by even more draconian measures from the Ulbricht regime instead. Strikes turned into a popular movement against the government. Soviet troops in Berlin responded and quelled the resistance to save the GDR’s government.

Eastern bloc - Term for the socialist countries of Eastern Europe aligned with the USSR during the Cold War. The group was generally considered to include Bulgaria, Czechoslovakia, East Germany, Poland, Hungary, and Romania. Yugoslavia was originally included before its split with Stalin in 1948. Albania was also aligned with the Soviets, but more independent than the others and withdrew from a direct alliance in 1961. The others stayed true to Moscow for the most part, but Romania often bucked directives and all other countries, save for Bulgaria, saw significant uprisings fueled by desires to move out of the Soviet orbit.

East German/Prague Refugee Crisis - Situation in the late summer to early fall of 1989 that saw thousands of East German citizens travel to Prague and pass inside the gates of the West German embassy to try and obtain visas to the West. Eventually negotiations led to the refugees being allowed to travel to West Germany, but were made to give up their East German citizenship.

Eisenhower Doctrine - Policy announced on January 5, 1957, that dedicated the US to provide military and economic assistance to countries in the Middle East trying to resist communist aggression. It was inspired by Soviet actions to increase their support in the region after the Suez Crisis.

Eurocommunism - Movement amongst European communist parties away from ties to the USSR beginning in the 1970s. The invasion of Czechoslovakia in 1968 helped inspire the move. Eurocommunists believed in socialist solutions for their countries, but did not want to be aligned with a world-wide movement, especially one associated with the totalitarian tendencies of the USSR.

Euromissile Crisis - A ramp up of tension in the Cold War after the thaw of détente that began in 1977 with the deployment of the advanced and mobile SS-20 missiles by the USSR in Eastern Europe. NATO responded with plans to install new Pershing II missiles in Western Europe. The deployment escalated tensions and started protests from Europeans, who felt it destabilized the arms race and put them more directly in target areas. The crisis ended in 1987, with the INF Treaty that banned ground-based intermediate missiles.

French Strikes of 1947 - Series of post-war strikes that began at the Renault automobile factory in April against continuing production quotas and low pay that were sparked by a reduction in the bread ration. The French Communist Party joined the strike and the government responded by removing all FCP officials from their positions. The government pushed through a wage increase to get most workers to return, but the tumult convinced observers that the government and economy were under threat of falling to communism.

GATT - General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade that reduced tariffs in order to facilitate trade in the post-WWII global economy based on a lack of discriminatory policies resulting in all countries benefitting from negotiated tariff rates. Twenty-three countries agreed to the terms in 1947, and starting on January 1, 1948, world trade began to boom. GATT would be replaced by the World Trade Organization (WTO) in 1995 with 125 nations and 90% of trade under its guidance.

Geneva Accords (1954) - Agreements issued at the Geneva Convention on July 21, 1954, concerning the future of the former French colony of Indochina. It called for a ceasefire and division of Vietnam along the 17th parallel. It also called for elections in Laos and Cambodia the following year and Vietnamese elections before July 1956 to unify the country under a single government. The agreements were non-binding and though followed in part, the situation quickly devolved into new conflicts. Diem of the South refused to sign the agreement and refused to allow the reunification elections it called for.

Geneva Summit (1985) - First meeting between superpower leaders President Reagan and Secretary Gorbachev in November 1985. No agreements were made, but the discussions about arms control built up a rapport between the two leaders that would allow for further agreements that helped facilitate the end of the Cold War.

Gerboise Bleue (nuclear test) - Codename of the first French nuclear bomb test on February 13, 1960. The explosion had a 70 kiloton yield, about three times as powerful as the devices dropped on Japan. It was tested in the desert region of western Algeria (at the time a French colony). The achievement was part of France's effort to remain aloof from the constraints of NATO which it believed created an over-dependence on the US.

German reunification/Treaty on the Final Settlement with Respect to Germany - (aka Two Plus Four Agreement) Agreement that reunified Germany in October 1990. The parties involved were East and West Germany along with the WWII Allies (France, the UK, US, and USSR). It ended the post-war occupation of Germany and finalized the border changes between Germany, Poland, and the USSR bringing a final conclusion to the interim situations created by WWII.

Glasnost - Soviet policy championed by Mikhail Gorbachev that focused on transparency and openness of government action. It included the wider dissemination of information and allowed for more political discourse.

Great Leap Forward - Effort by the Chinese Communist Party from 1958 to 1960 to industrialize and empower the economy of the country. Chairman Mao did not believe the Soviet system was effective for China and the country would need to rely on increased output from its abundant labor supply to jumpstart industrialization and create agricultural surpluses. Collectivized farms and worker communes were created, but were badly managed with often counterproductive goals and directives. Twenty million people are estimated to have died from starvation due to the inefficient programs that created a disastrous lack of food exacerbated by natural disasters and crop failures.

Great Purge - Trials and prosecutions in the USSR from 1936-1938 that removed former Bolshevik leaders from power in the Communist Party and government based on charges of treason. The NKVD coerced many of the confessions used in the trials via torture and threatening the families of the accused. The resulting executions and imprisonments removed any possible rivals to Stalin's control of the country.

Greek Civil War - Confrontation between EAM-ELAS (communist) forces and the EDES (nationalist) army after the withdrawal of German occupation forces in 1944. The UK helped end the conflict temporarily in 1945, but by 1946, it had restarted and the US was forced to intervene to help the EDES. The last communist resistance ended in 1949.

Gulf of Tonkin Incident/Resolution - A naval confrontation off the coast of northern Vietnam on August 2, 1964, where North Vietnamese ships were reported to have launched an unprovoked attack on the USS Maddox. A subsequent attack was reported on August 4th that included the USS Turner Joy. The second attack was never confirmed to actually take place, but President Johnson used the events the next day to urge Congress to pass a resolution that gave him the ability to take "all necessary measures" to prevent further attacks. It would lead to a dramatic increase in US involvement in Vietnam.

Hallstein Doctrine - The policy of West Germany to refuse diplomatic relations with any other nation that officially recognized East Germany (save for the USSR). It lasted from 1955-1970, and was named for diplomat Walter Hallstein. It ended with a switch to Ostpolitik.

Harmel Report (aka Report of the Council on the Future Tasks of the Alliance) - Outlining of policy in 1967, that transformed NATO's outlook to align with a dual-track set of goals via détente and deterrence. It was named for Belgian Foreign Minister, Pierre Harmel.

Helsinki Accords (aka Final Act of the Conference on Security and Cooperation in Europe (CSCE)) - Agreement signed on August 1, 1975, to reduce Cold War tensions by codifying post-war borders and political controls in Europe. The US, Canada, and all of Europe (except Albania) signed the agreements which were non-binding, but had significant impacts. It included “baskets” on security, trade, and human rights commitments such as freedom of travel and information. The commitments would energize dissent organizations globally and within the Eastern Bloc.

Helsinki Watch Committees (aka Human Rights Watch (as of 1988)) - Organization founded in 1978, to push the USSR and Eastern Bloc countries to adhere to the Helsinki Accords. It sent monitors into countries and shared information about abuses to put pressure on governments to follow through on human rights commitments

Ho Chi Minh Trail - System of transportation routes through the dense jungle of Cambodia and Laos that supplied North Vietnamese and Viet Cong forces during the Vietnam War. It began use in 1959 and by 1974, it included highly-developed supply stations and support facilities.

Hungarian Uprising (1956) - Resistance against the communist government in Hungary in late 1956. Fighting broke out in October after mass protests and led to a new government under Imre Nagy. Nagy declared Hungary to be neutral and withdrew from the Warsaw Pact. He called for a multiparty democracy and other political reforms. The USSR invaded on November 4th and crushed all resistance after installing a new communist government.

hydrogen bomb (aka thermonuclear bomb) - Nuclear weapon that uses nuclear fusion as opposed to fission to create a massive explosion. The process of hydrogen isotopes (deuterium and tritium) fusing into helium and releasing energy is caused by a trigger device based on a traditional atomic bomb and is significantly more powerful. Its yield is measured in megatons as opposed to the kilotons used for earlier atomic weapons.

ICBMs (Intercontinental Ballistic Missile) - Land-based devices that follow ballistic flight paths to allow a range of over 3,500 miles. They are used to deliver nuclear warheads across vast distances and the technological sophistication and resources required are so limited that only the US, USSR(now Russia), and the PRC developed any.

INF Treaty (Intermediate-Range Nuclear treaty) - Agreement between the US and the USSR that banned medium and intermediate range nuclear weapons on land. It was signed in 1987, and was the first to ban an entire category of nuclear weapons and not just limit them. Observers were allowed into each country to verify the actions. The US withdrew from the treaty in 2019.

Iran-Contra Scandal - Activities, cover-up, and investigation related to the National Security Council illegally selling weapons to Iran to fund Contras opposing the leftist Sandinistas of Nicaragua. The operation was meant to facilitate the release of hostages in Lebanon during the Reagan administration. The actions violated the Boland Amendment and ran counter to other congressional regulations against supplying terrorist organizations. The ensuing congressional hearings led to protests and prison terms.

Iranian Crisis (1946) - Confrontation in Iran where the USSR refused to withdraw troops after the end of WWII. The Soviets tried to retain influence in the country by supporting rebels along their shared border. The US and UK had major influence over the oil in Iran and did not want Soviet interference. They protested USSR actions to the UN and after oil agreements between the Soviets and Iran were reached, troops began withdrawing on March 24, 1946. When the troops left, the US helped end the rebel activities, and Iran ended its oil agreements with the Soviet Union.

Iranian coup (1953) - The US and UK backed regime change in Iran that removed Mohammad Mosaddegh as premier and gave increased power to the Shah, Mohammad Reza Pahlavi. Mosaddegh had led parliament to nationalize the oil industry that supplied the Western powers a significant amount of their energy. The Eisenhower administration used CIA assets under the direction of Kermit Roosevelt to pursue regime change.

Iron Curtain - Symbolic border between the Eastern and Western camps in Europe during the Cold War. It was popularized by Winston Churchill with his 1946 speech in Fulton, Missouri. The borders of the Eastern Bloc were physical and psychological barriers to movement, communication, and culture between the socialist and capitalist systems.

Islamic Revolution in Iran - Uprising that began in January of 1978 and ended with the removal of the government under the Shah on February 11, 1979. The Shah's regime became increasingly autocratic and its secular and Western policies fomented increasing amounts of dissent. Student protests against the continued exile of Ayatollah Khomeini led to a declaration of martial law and deadly repression. Strikes turned into a general protest that shut down the capital and led to the Shah fleeing the country. The military refused to support the interim government after Khomeini returned in February, and the government collapsed completely.

Italian Election of 1948 - Initial parliamentary elections in the newly created Republic of Italy. The US, via the CIA, provided financial and material support to the campaign of the Christian Democrats and their allies to oppose the Communist Party's candidates, who hoped to secure a plurality and control the government. The Communists and allies still garnered 31% of the vote despite the intense US-backed propaganda efforts, but the Catholic Church's support (and anti-communist rhetoric) helped the CDP control the government with 48%.

KAL Flight 007 - A commercial jet with 269 passengers travelling from Anchorage to Seoul on September 1, 1983. It was shot down by a Soviet fighter jet after it flew off course over Russian territory (Sakhalin Island). The Soviets claimed the flight was part of an espionage operation by the US. A US Congressman was aboard and the flight occurred around the time of a Soviet test launch in the region, but no information was discovered to implicate the flight in any spying.

Khmer Rouge - Regime formed from the Communist Party of Kampuchea in Cambodia that controlled the country from 1975 to 1979 after emerging victorious from the civil war started after the 1970 coup. It was led by Pol Pot and killed millions of people in the country that were deemed a threat to the government. The Khmer was ousted due to an invasion by Vietnam in 1979.

Kitchen Debate - Nikita Khrushchev and Vice President Nixon squared off in the middle of a mock US home (largely near the kitchen set) in an American National Exhibition in Moscow on July 24, 1959. The impromptu debate about the merits of their rival economic systems was broadcast the next day in the US and later in the USSR. Reactions were mixed, but it raised Nixon's profile in the US.

Korean War - Conflict that started with the invasion of South Korea (ROK) by North Korean forces (DPRK) on June 25, 1950. The fighting lasted until July 27, 1953, though a technical state of war still exists as no formal peace treaty was ever signed by the two parties. The UN became involved led by the US (due to a Soviet boycott of the Security Council) and after initially falling back to the Pusan perimeter the US, under Douglas MacArthur, made a dramatic landing at Inchon to force the North Koreans back. The PRC entered the conflict as UN forces approached their border at the Yalu River. The war devolved into a stalemate near the original line of demarcation at the 38th parallel and a cease fire kept the areas under military control at the time as the de facto borders for North and South Korea.

“launch on warning” (LOW) - A military tactic that allowed for a nuclear strike to be ordered when an enemy strike seemed imminent. The decision capability was to be given to high-level military commanders and not reserved solely to the president. The strategy was in place in the US from 1979 to 1997, but retired due to the possibility of a false alarm triggering a nuclear strike.

League for the Independence of Vietnam/Viet Minh - Insurgency movement formed in China in 1941, during WWII by Ho Chi Minh. It fought against Japanese occupation and declared independence for Vietnam in 1945. The French attempted to retake the colony from the Viet Minh starting in 1946. The Viet Minh transformed into the Vietnamese National Popular Front (Lien Viet) by the end of the war and the Communist Party became the leading political force in the country with most of its leadership coming from the Viet Minh.

Laotian Civil War (aka Secret War) - Conflict between royalist and communist factions in Laos from 1959 to 1975. A 1962 agreement to form a coalition government to end the hostilities fell apart by 1964. The Paris Accords of 1973 led to an eventual ceasefire and a new coalition government. The victory of the communists in Vietnam in 1975, helped bolster the Pathet Lao communists in Laos and the Lao People's Democratic Republic came into being in December after the monarchy was abolished.

Lebanon Crisis (1958) - A general strike that took place to protest the government of Camille Chamoun and to push for Lebanon joining the new (Soviet-aligned) United Arab Republic of Syria and Egypt. Chamoun requested UN intervention to quell the uprising he blamed on UAR-backed agitators. US troops landed near Beirut and the insurrection eventually ended without the US becoming overly involved, but still asserting itself in the region to prevent further Soviet influence.

London Poles - Government-in-exile during WWII while Poland was occupied by German and Soviet forces. The government maintained influence in Poland via its contacts with the Home Army resistance effort. It lost out on a possible return to power when the Soviet-supported Provisional Government took power in 1945. It continued to exist in some form until 1990.

Lublin Committee - (aka Polish Committee of National Liberation) Group of communist leaders that set up a provisional Polish government as of July 22, 1944, in the city of Lublin after it was liberated from German occupation. As Soviet-controlled territory increased, so did the power of the Lublin group. It transformed into the Provisional Government of the Republic of Poland and was recognized by the USSR in 1945.

M.A.D. (Mutually Assured Destruction) - Political and military tactic of deterrence based on the logic that no nuclear attack could take place between the superpowers due to the fact that a launch by one nation would force the other to respond in kind ensuring that both were destroyed by a nuclear attack and fallout. The theory became popular in the mid-sixties as the idea of a limited nuclear war became less feasible. The term was coined by Donald Brennan who disagreed with the strategy.

Malta Summit (1989) - Meeting aboard naval vessels off the coast of Malta between President George H.W. Bush and Secretary Gorbachev on December 2-3, 1989. It was declared to be the end of the Cold War by the participants despite a lack of firm agreements. The two leaders did make symbolic acknowledgements that the era of the Cold War had ended as indicated by the recent tearing down of the Berlin Wall.

Marshall Plan - Economic stimulus and recovery program sponsored by the US under the direction of Secretary of State George Marshall that lasted from 1948 to 1951. It gave supplies and subsidies to 17 European countries to recover from WWII and to stabilize them politically to help ensure democratic and mainly capitalist systems would endure past looming threats of destabilization that US leaders feared would promote communist regimes. \$13 billion in aid was extended during the plan which was offered to Eastern Bloc nations, but was declined by order of Stalin.

Mathias Rust flight (1987) - Unauthorized flight by an amateur West German pilot from Helsinki to Moscow on May 28, 1987. He landed next to Red Square in an effort to create better connections between East and West. He was arrested and imprisoned before being pardoned. The flight was embarrassing for the vaunted Soviet defense network, but highlighted changes from previous responses to incursions.

May 1968 Uprising (France) - Student revolt (during a year of world-wide youth protests) that led to a general strike in the country. Riots took place in Paris and the country ground to a halt. Students protested specific restrictions at universities in Paris and harsh police responses led to the Night of Barricades on May 10th, where 40,000 students built defenses and were attacked by police in the middle of the night. Workers joined the cause and factories were seized. De Gaulle left the country for a time and considered using military force, but made a speech calling for new elections that helped motivate his supporters and others that wanted a return to stability to counter demonstrate. The uprising faded, but de Gaulle would be out of office within a year.

military industrial complex - The multifaceted connections between those responsible for making military, political, and business decisions that help perpetuate a focus on developing military technology and capabilities for the enrichment of the individuals and companies rather than based on the needs of the country and the people. The term was coined by President Eisenhower in his Farewell Address in 1961, where he warned against the growing power of the complex that existed in the US.

MIRVs (multiple independent reentry vehicle) - Specific design of a nuclear missile that can target multiple warheads within the device to separate locations. The development of this technology briefly destabilized the nuclear deterrent status quo between the US and USSR.

Molotov-Ribbentrop Pact (aka German-Soviet Nonaggression Pact) - Agreement signed on August 23, 1939, that created an increased area of control for the USSR beyond its current borders by allowing Nazi Germany to expand as well without conflict. It is named for the foreign ministers that built the agreement, Vyacheslav Molotov and Joachim von Ribbentrop. The USSR (through two additional secret protocols) received the eastern half of Poland as well as all of Lithuania, Latvia, Estonia, Finland, and Bessarabia in Romania. All of these areas were independent at the time of the agreement, but most would be absorbed into the Soviet Union through force.

Morgenthau Plan - Original post-war Allied policy for Germany as articulated by Secretary of Treasury Henry Morgenthau in 1944. It sought to completely eliminate Germany's war making capabilities by destroying its industrial base in the Ruhr Valley and possibly interning workers in labor camps. President Truman wanted a more moderate approach and by 1946, the Restatement of Policy on Germany by Secretary of State James Byrnes officially redirected Allied plans.

Moscow Summit (1988) - Meeting between President Reagan and Secretary Gorbachev from May 29-June 3, 1988, that finalized the INF Treaty and produced seven agreements that further evolved relations between the two countries by increasing cultural exchanges and agreements on economic policies. It was the last full summit before the election of George H.W. Bush.

Moscow Treaty (1970) - Agreement between the USSR and West Germany that was signed in Moscow on August 12, 1970. It was brought into being through Willy Brandt's Ostpolitik efforts and helped bring about the Helsinki Accords. It agreed to end the Hallstein doctrine by recognizing the GDR and recognized the current boundaries of Germany that had resulted from WWII.

Mujahedeen - Guerilla fighters and groups that opposed the Soviet invasion of Afghanistan. It comes from the Islamic term for those that fight for the faith or simply "holy warriors." Various groups worked together despite rivalries to attack Soviet troops and eventually defeat the communist government in Kabul. They were well supplied by the US with military supplies including stinger missiles via Pakistan. Many of these fighters would be involved in the al-Qaeda and Taliban movements after the war.

My Lai Massacre (aka Pinkville Massacre) - Event that resulted in the murder of up to 500 unarmed Vietnamese in the village of My Lai on March 16, 1968, by US soldiers in Charlie Company under the command of Capt. Ernest Medina. Some of the worst actions were committed under 1st Platoon leader William Calley that rounded up civilians, including children, to be executed. Some villagers were saved by US helicopters that intervened to block further attacks. The events were covered up despite a report of the attack, but a fellow soldier gathered evidence and sent his findings to members of Congress and the Defense Department. Medina was court-martialed, but acquitted and Calley was charged with the murder of 109 civilians and sentenced to life in prison for 22 counts. President Nixon decided to commute his sentence to house arrest and it was eventually reduced to a three-year term. Those charged in the cover-up were also subsequently acquitted. The events surrounding the massacre increased protests around the war and furthered the perceived credibility gap concerning official information about US activities in Vietnam.

National Front for the Liberation of South Vietnam/Viet Cong (Liberation Army of South Vietnam) - A combination of regular and irregular combatants in South Vietnam operating in general coordination with the North Vietnamese communist government. Viet Cong comes from a term for Vietnamese communist and members were often referred to as VC by US troops.

NATO (North Atlantic Treaty Organization) - Defensive alliance established in 1949 to create military stability and cooperation in Europe and North America. It currently has 32 member states after starting with 12 founding members (Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, Iceland, Italy, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, the UK, and the US). The key agreement is Article V of the founding document that calls for mutual defense if one member is attacked. It has only been invoked once (after the 2001 attacks in the US). The alliance was conceived to help Western Europe defend against USSR forces which held a sizable advantage in conventional forces even when compared to the collective strength of NATO.

Nedelin Catastrophe (aka Baikonur explosion) - Accident that occurred on October 24, 1960, at the USSR Baikonur Cosmodrome in Kazakhstan where as many as 120 were killed by a rocket explosion. It was the worst disaster of the Space Race era and was named for the head of the USSR missile force, Mitrofan Nedelin. Due to a rushed schedule, safety procedures were overlooked and a short-circuit during repairs caused the engine to prematurely ignite resulting in a massive explosion. The event was covered up until 1989.

Nicaraguan Civil War (aka Nicaraguan Revolution) - Conflict between right-wing and US-backed Contras that supported the ousted Somoza regime and the leftist and Soviet-backed Sandinistas (FSLN) from 1978-1990 in Nicaragua. The Sandinistas came to power in 1978, after the fall of the Somoza regime and the Contras began attacking the new government. They received covert support from the Reagan administration beginning in late 1981. An end to the fighting was eventually ended by the Tela Accord signed in 1989.

Non-Proliferation Treaty - Agreement signed on July 1, 1968 between the USSR, UK, US, and 59 other countries that banned the development of nuclear weapons by any other countries. France and China (who both had independently developed their own weapons) eventually signed in 1992, and it was extended to 174 countries by the UN in 1995. North Korea withdrew in 2003. India, Pakistan, and Israel are the only countries to have never signed.

Non-Aligned Movement (NAM) - International organization representing countries that did not want to be dependent on or committed to the Eastern or Western powers during the Cold War. It began as a concept at the Bandung Conference of 1955, and was officially founded at the Belgrade Conference of 1961. The founding leaders were Tito of Yugoslavia, Nehru of India, Nasser of Egypt, Sukarno of Indonesia, and Nkrumah of Ghana. It has persisted as an organization that focuses on international cooperation and continues to include countries that are not part of a multilateral military alliance.

Novocherkassk Massacre - Attack on striking workers in Novocherkassk, Russia by the Soviet Army that killed at least 24 workers and injured dozens more on June 2, 1962. The Electric Locomotive Works plantworkers struck after they received wage cuts after price increases were announced nationwide. Thousands joined with the workers to protest and began to march on the local Communist Party headquarters. The Army fired on the protesters and arrested hundreds. Many were imprisoned and seven strikers were executed after their trials. The victims were buried outside the city and the incident was covered up. The event showed that Khrushchev's thaw and liberalization efforts remained limited.

Nuclear Test Ban Treaty (1963) (aka Treaty Banning Nuclear Weapons Tests in the Atmosphere, in Outer Space, and Under Water) - Agreement between the US, USSR, and the UK signed in Moscow on August 5, 1963, to stop all nuclear weapons testing that was not conducted underground. It was inspired by increased concerns about the fallout and environmental destruction caused by atmospheric testing. France and China did not sign the agreement as they were still seeking to expand their own nuclear capabilities.

Ogaden War - (aka Ethio-Somalia War) Conflict between Somalia and Ethiopia for control of the Ogaden region of Ethiopia from 1977-78. The USSR had been a strong ally of Somalia, but a new communist government had come to power in Ethiopia and the Soviets decided to side with it against Somali aggression. Somalia was forced to withdraw its invasion force after Ethiopia routed it with the aid of Soviet military material and 12,000 Cuban troops. Somalia's military regime would lose prestige over the defeat and the country would become embroiled in a civil war by 1981 that is still ongoing.

Open Skies proposal - Policy presented by President Eisenhower at the 1955 Geneva summit with fellow Allied occupational powers. The plan was discussed after talks on German reunification fell through and Eisenhower sought to salvage a benefit from the discussions. It called for the US and USSR to share information about their military base locations and allow surveillance of the location to monitor arms control agreements. The USSR rejected the plan as a form of espionage.

Operation Able Archer - 1983 iteration of annual NATO joint exercises that took place in Western Europe and is seen as a time the world came dangerously close to nuclear war. The five-day exercise increased its level of realism from previous years' exercises and in the context of heightened Cold War tensions, it was viewed by some Soviet officials as an actual prelude to an attack on the Eastern Bloc. Warsaw powers were put on alert and nuclear warheads were loaded onto their bombers and fighters. NATO leaders did not counter the Soviet preparations and ended the exercise on November 11th stopping what could have been a self-feeding cycle of preparation for a nuclear exchange.

Operation Blue Bat - Codename for the landing of 14,000 US Marines and Army troops on the beaches of Lebanon near Beirut on July 15, 1958 in support of President Camille Chamoun during the Lebanon Crisis against pan-Arab inspired resistance. It was justified by the Eisenhower Doctrine of the previous year.

Operation Chrome Dome - US Air Force mission from 1961-1968 to maintain a 24 hour-a-day airborne presence of B-52 bombers armed with nuclear weapons. The bombers flew a pattern around the US, Canada, and Greenland into the Arctic Circle to be ready to attack the USSR at any moment. The often dangerous operation became less important with the advent of ICBM technology.

Operation Condor - Organization of South American military regimes from 1975 to 1983 that was created by Augusto Pinochet and his intelligence department when they invited their counterparts from other autocratic regimes in Argentina, Brazil, Bolivia, Chile, Paraguay, and Uruguay to Chile to collaborate on the repression of dissidents in their countries. Thousands in each member country were reported killed or missing based on the training, communication, and actions planned by this group.

Operation Mongoose - (aka Cuban Project) Covert campaign led by the CIA to undercut the Castro regime in Cuba including attempted assassination. It was authorized on November 30, 1961, and operated out of an office on the campus of the University of Miami. It also involved resources and members of the US Armed Forces.

Operation PBSuccess - Codename for the CIA operation to support the overthrow of Jacobo Árbenz in Guatemala in 1954. It used mainly psychological warfare to make the government, army, and general populace believe that a significant rebel force under Carlos Castillo Armas was heading to the capital and that the government had no hope of surviving what was becoming a popular movement.

Operation Rolling Thunder - Bombing campaign by the US military from March 1965 until October 1968 that targeted sites in North Vietnam. President Johnson approved the operation to weaken the North Vietnamese ability to supply their southern forces and to try and destabilize the economy and force negotiations. The bombings were gradually increased every year until 1967 when some leaders, such as Secretary of Defense McNamara, began to argue that the operation was not effective. This was despite the tonnage of explosives dropped on North Vietnam being more than all tonnage used by the US during WWII. The significant loss of bombers and fighters involved in the operation led to an overhaul of the Air Force's strategic approach to air combat.

Operation RYAN (Russian acronym for 'Nuclear Missile Attack -RYaN) - Largest Soviet intelligence gathering operation during the Cold War era. It began in 1981, when the Politburo believed the Reagan administration was planning a preemptive nuclear strike on the USSR. The intelligence was supposed to help the Soviets detect the first steps in preparations for the attack. The attempt at eliminating the chance for a surprise attack conversely led to an increased chance of a false alarm being interpreted as real.

Operation Unthinkable - Plans for an attack on the USSR prepared for Prime Minister Churchill by the British military in May of 1945. It called for a surprise offensive against the still-allied Soviet Union by UK and US forces in order to remove the Soviets from East Germany and Poland. The assault was to begin in July before the US and UK demobilized their troops following victory in Europe. Churchill's government was defeated in July and the fears of a land war in Russia proved too strong for further development of the plan.

Operation Urgent Fury - Code name for the US invasion on October 25, 1983, of Grenada to put Paul Scoon back in power. The governor-general had called for assistance before being placed under arrest by supporters of the Marxists NJM. The island had previously been aided by Cuba and had some Cuban troops involved in the conflict.

Ostpolitik - (Eastern Policy) Foreign policy of West Germany beginning under Willy Brandt in the late 1960s and early 70s. It led to recognition of East Germany and developed economic and political relations with the USSR.

Palomares incident (1966) - Nuclear accident on January 17, 1966 over Palomares, Spain. A US Air Force bomber collided with a fueling vessel in the air leading to an explosion. One of the four nuclear bombs aboard the B-52 fell into the ocean and two of the others exploded. The nuclear warheads did not detonate, but radioactive material was spread across a large area. The device lost in the water took almost three months to recover. The area was treated for contamination, but needed further remediation in 2015, by the US and continues to have radiation. Spain banned such flights after the incident.

Paris Charter (1990) (Charter of Paris for a New Europe) - Agreement of European countries, the US, and Canada on November 21, 1990. The treaty formalized the Helsinki Accords and created the Organization for Security and Co-operation in Europe (OSCE). The goal was to integrate the former Eastern Bloc nations politically with the West and create a new lasting framework for stability.

Paris Peace Accords (1973) - Agreement signed on January 27, 1973 that committed the US to cease involvement in Vietnam. It was signed by the North, South, US, and Viet Cong, but most of the provisions for a ceasefire were broken very quickly after the agreement.

Pentagon Papers - (aka US Decision-Making in Vietnam, 1945-68) Documents that outlined US activity in Vietnam and Southeast Asia. They were created by order of Secretary of Defense Robert McNamara. The *New York Times* received thousands of pages of this information from Daniel Ellsberg who had helped create the documents. The *Times* began publishing them on June 13, 1971. The *Times* and the *Washington Post* fought an order by the Department of Justice to cease publication and the Supreme Court

agreed they had the right to do so. The information further eroded public confidence in the government's credibility and Nixon's response led to parts of the eventual Watergate scandal.

Perestroika (restructuring) - Policy of the USSR under Mikhail Gorbachev to reconstitute the government and economy in order to modernize the country beginning in 1985. It sought to add market-style reforms, which were welcome, but the limited changes did more to harm the existing structure than improve it.

ping pong diplomacy - Foreign policy episode between the US and China in the early 1970s. It began when the two nation's table tennis teams became friendly at the World Championships in Japan. Their interactions led to an invitation for the US team to visit China. The visit in April 1971, was the first for a US group to China since 1949. The thaw helped make secret visits by Henry Kissinger possible, laying the groundwork for an eventual visit by President Nixon in 1972.

Pope John Paul II visit to Poland (1979) - The second trip by John Paul II after becoming pope. He spoke to massive crowds and stated they had a right to freedom. The largely Catholic nation was energized by the visit which helped spark protests against the government.

Potsdam Conference - Meeting from July 17-August 2, 1945 of Allied leaders during WWII to discuss the end of the war in the Pacific and the future of Europe. President Truman represented the US and Stalin the USSR. Churchill was present until his government was voted out of office and was replaced by the new prime minister, Clement Atlee. At the conference, Truman would inform Stalin of the successful Trinity test, Stalin committed to attacking Japan, and the countries further solidified plans for reparations and occupation zones in Germany and Austria. Further Allied conferences were planned to help align the administration of post-war Europe, but they would fail to involve any real cooperation.

Poznań Riots (1956) - A popular uprising in the Polish town of Poznań during June 1956. Workers struck against low wages and high prices on June 28th and soon 30,000 people were demonstrating. Riots ensued and troops responded, killing dozens. The demonstrations were halted, but convinced the ruling Polish United Workers' Party to change policies and put Władysław Gomułka in power as the first secretary.

Prague Spring - Time of reforms in Czechoslovakia in 1968, that was violently halted by an invasion of Warsaw Pact troops. Changes to the economic and political systems that favored market and democratic reforms were championed by Alexander Dubček. Students and writers started to foment resistance and began protesting in the years leading up to the Spring. This pressure along with economic difficulties in the country forced the communist leader Antonín Novotný to resign in favor of Dubček. His new Action Program inspired the Two Thousand Words manifesto to be issued in June that called for full democracy. Feeling that the reforms were getting out of hand and becoming "counterrevolutionary," the Warsaw Pact met and warned Dubček. He believed he had negotiated a truce with Moscow, but on August 20th troops invaded and took Dubček to Moscow resulting in the Moscow Protocol that rolled back reforms and eventually replaced his government.

PRC/ROC - The Republic of China (ROC) was established in 1912 under Sun Yat-sen of the Kuomintang (KMT) Nationalist party. His successor, Chiang Kai-shek, largely unified the country until the 1927 civil war with the Chinese Communist Party (CCP) broke out. Shortly after WWII, the CCP gained control and established the People's Republic of China (PRC) in 1949. The KMT retreated to Taiwan and maintained the majority of international recognition as the sanctioned government of China as the ROC until 1971, when the PRC gained control of China's seat on the UN Security Council. The ROC dropped its claim to representing the whole of China in the 1990s, but still claims independence which the PRC refutes.

Project Nutmeg - Search conducted by the US military for an alternative nuclear testing site located inside the contiguous US after the Marshall Islands were deemed too expensive and vulnerable. The study favored islands off the coast of North Carolina due to the favorable wind conditions that would limit the possible exposure to fallout. By 1950, the Nevada Proving Grounds, 70 miles northwest of Las Vegas, was chosen due to its remote location and "low-utility" populations being located in the fallout areas.

Radio Free Europe - US broadcasting operation started by the CIA in 1950 to send information into the Eastern Bloc. It reached approximately 35 million people and helped provide news and opinions to people living in areas where information was heavily censored by the government. Control of the operation switched from the CIA to the Board for International Broadcasting in 1971.

Realpolitik - Political practice centered around achieving desired outcomes with little regard to specific ideals or ethical restraints. It tends to focus on situations as they are, rather than how some might hope them to be, and is not constrained by moral concerns.

Reykjavik summit - Meeting in Iceland between President Reagan and Premier Gorbachev from October 11-12, 1986. It was noted for coming close to a complete abandonment of nuclear weapons by the superpowers. The attempts at negotiations created an understanding between the leaders that resulted in a limiting of weapons and a relationship that would help to greatly reduce tensions and facilitate an end to the Cold War.

SALT I and II (Strategic Arms Limitation Talks) - Agreements to reduce stockpiles of ballistic nuclear missiles controlled by the US and USSR. The first was signed by Leonid Brezhnev in 1972 with the Nixon administration after talks had started under Johnson. It included the Anti-Ballistic Missile Treaty that kept the deterrent against using nuclear weapons in place. The second set of negotiations began almost immediately and lasted until 1979. It limited the number of MIRVs and total weapons allowed and was signed by President Carter, but failed to gain ratification and was pulled from consideration after the Soviet invasion of Afghanistan.

Salvadoran Civil War - Conflict in El Salvador from 1979-1992 that pitted the US-backed government against the left-wing FMLN. It began after the Revolutionary Government Junta took control on October 15, 1979. It received support from the US to forestall the FMLN and their Cuban allies from taking power. The war was noted for human rights abuses and resulted in the death of over 75,000 people with 8,000 disappeared.

Second Cold War - Period of increased tension between the US and USSR that began with the end of détente in the late 1970s before fully emerging after the Soviet invasion of Afghanistan in 1979. It peaked during the Reagan administration with policies of increasing arms and attempted rollback, but began to thaw with the appointment of Mikhail Gorbachev as General Secretary in 1985.

Sino-Soviet Treaty of Friendship, Alliance, and Mutual Assistance (1950) - Agreement between the USSR and the PRC signed on February 14th that sent technical and economic assistance to China which helped them support Korean War efforts and mobilize their economy after the end of the long civil war. It also began discussions of military cooperation in order to support the new communist government and help diminish the chances of a US invasion to support the claims of the exiled ROC. The treaty would technically remain in effect until 1979, but after de-Stalinization efforts began in the USSR, the relations between the two powers became strained and then adversarial.

School of the Americas (Western Hemisphere Institute for Security Cooperation as of 2000) - Training installation run by the US Department of Defense that began in 1946 as the Latin American Training Center before becoming the US Army Caribbean School. Its mission was to train Latin American military personnel to fight communist and revolutionary efforts in their countries. It was located in Panama before being forced to relocate to Fort Benning, GA. Opponents of the installation point to many of its graduates, like Manuel Noriega and Hugo Bánzer Suárez, being responsible for regimes maintaining power through torture and executions.

Sino-Soviet Border skirmishes (1969) - Conflict beginning in March of 1969 when PLA troops clashed with the Soviet Army in Manchuria on islands in the Ussuri River. Two larger battles ensued in the border river and troops began to mass. The USSR began considering nuclear options and China placed their nuclear forces on alert. Aleksei Kosygin met with Zhou Enlai in September in Beijing to deescalate the situation. The poor relations between the countries that had been deteriorating for over a decade did not greatly improve, but the skirmishes stopped.

Six-Day War - Conflict between Israel and the allied forces of Egypt, Jordan, and Syria from June 5-10, 1967. Israel had struck against Syria and Jordan earlier in the year and Nasser responded by creating a mutual defense pact between Jordan and Egypt. He closed the Gulf of Aqaba in May to limit Israeli trade and Israeli air power responded with a preemptive assault on Egypt. Israeli forces captured the Sinai Peninsula and the Gaza Strip(Egypt), West Bank and East Jerusalem(Jordan), and Golan Heights (Syria).

Socialism with a Human Face - Moniker for the slate of reforms that would incorporate the Action Program under Alexander Dubček announced in April 1968, that created the Prague Spring. It included market reforms and removed censorship of literature and the press.

Solidarity Movement (aka Independent Self-Governing Trade Union) - A Polish trade union movement that sought to create a union independent of the government. It was founded on September 22, 1980, and won concessions from the communist government until the movement was outlawed in December 1981. It became the leading political power after being legalized in 1989, as reforms were again instituted and its leader, Lech Wałęsa, was elected president in 1990.

Soviet Coup attempt (1957) (aka Anti-Party Group crisis) - Event in the USSR where rival party leaders attempted to remove Nikita Khrushchev from power. The effort was led by Georgi Malenkov, Lazar Kaganovich, and Vyacheslav Molotov. It was a response to the de-Stalinization efforts of Khrushchev, but the rival efforts to put Nikolai Bulganin in as First Secretary were thwarted due to Khrushchev's control of the Central Committee and his support from the Red Army. The failed leaders were labeled Anti-Party and were demoted to various posts across the USSR.

Soviet Coup attempt (1991) - Failed attempt during August 19-21, 1991, to remove Gorbachev from power in the USSR. The Soviet President was vacationing in Crimea when he was taken hostage in his own dacha. Hardliners in the government, led by Gennady Yanayev, formed the State Committee on the State of Emergency (Gang of Eight) to stop Gorbachev's reform efforts. Boris Yeltsin led popular protests against the coup efforts outside of the White House in Moscow and troops refused to fire on demonstrators. The coup collapsed quickly and its plotters were arrested. Their actions further eroded already weakened support for the Communist Party and despite Gorbachev's return the Party's activities were suspended in the USSR by the end of August.

Soviet invasion of Afghanistan (1979) - Conflict that started in December of 1979, after a coup led by an extremist Marxist group overthrew the Soviet-backed communist government that had only come into power the previous year due to their own coup. The USSR decided to remove Hafizullah Amin from power in favor of Babrak Karmal. None of the communists had popular backing and the Soviets were drawn into a Vietnam-style quagmire with unclear goals and a lack of general support. The US supplied rebel Afghans (mujahideen) with supplies which allowed them to control most of the rural area in the country. The conflict drained the struggling USSR of blood and treasure, and they were forced to sign a withdrawal agreement in 1988 that was completed on February 15, 1989.

Space Race - Competition between the US and USSR to gain prestige and influence through success in space exploration. It was kicked off by the successful launching of the first man-made satellite, Sputnik, by the USSR on October 4, 1957, and would last through the 1960s. It was highlighted by the movement to land a human on the moon which President Kennedy committed to doing by the end of the 1960s in a speech on September 12, 1962. The US accomplished the goal with the Apollo11 mission on July 20, 1969.

“Speech of Hope” - Address by Secretary of State James Byrnes on September 6, 1946, in Stuttgart that announced a realignment of US policy towards the rehabilitation of Germany. The UK and US had created a Bizone of their occupation areas the day before and the speech outlined support from the US for Germany to create its own government and work toward full-sovereignty and economic independence.

Stalinism - Repressive style of rule under Joseph Stalin from 1929-1953 known for purges, paranoia, and totalitarianism. It focused on using nationalism, class warfare, and intimidation through an extensive police apparatus to create a cult of personality around the leader and maintain control.

Stasi (Ministry for State Security) - Secret police apparatus in East Germany from 1950-1990. It was modeled on the NKVD and KGB in the USSR. Erich Mielke expanded the Stasi into a seemingly omnipresent spying organization with 100,000 employees and some 2 million informants.

Strategic Defense Initiative (SDI) - A theoretical defense system proposed by President Reagan on March 23, 1983, that would prevent nuclear missiles from reaching the US. The interception of missiles required technology years beyond anything conceived at the time and the hurdles would ultimately prove too much for the system to advance towards practical application. Despite its lack of feasibility, the concept itself served to destabilize the strategic situation between the superpowers as the Soviets were afraid they would no longer have an equal nuclear deterrent to a US strike. This served to increase tensions and proved a stumbling block to arms reduction negotiations.

Suez Crisis - Conflict in Egypt that began in October 1956, after France and the UK conspired with Israel to invade the Sinai Peninsula as a pretense for seizing the Suez Canal that Gamal Abdel Nasser and recently nationalized. Israel invaded on October 29th and the UK and France landed troops to “protect” the canal zone. The US was not informed of the plot and quickly made their displeasure known by sponsoring a UN resolution to remove all foreign troops. The event diverted attention from the USSR invasion of Hungary and gave cover for the Soviets who framed the Suez Crisis as aggressive imperialism.

Taiwan Straits Crisis (First and Second) - Confrontations between the PRC and the ROC on the islands in the Taiwan Strait that both governments claimed sovereignty over. The first crisis occurred in 1954, when the PRC began shelling Quemoy/Jinmen, Matsu, and Dachen islands. These islands were claimed by the ROC, who saw them as vital to their defense. The threat by the PRC resulted in the Eisenhower administration signing the Sino-American Mutual Defense Treaty in December. Congress gave the president the ability to defend the islands in January and by April the PRC ended its assault. The second crisis took place in 1958, when the PRC shelled Jinmen and Matsu while the US was involved in the Lebanon Crisis. The US resupplied the threatened ROC garrisons and an unspoken agreement of shelling on a predicted schedule fell into place that lasted until normalized US and PRC relations in 1979.

Tbilisi Riots (1956) - Protests from March 4-10, 1956, against the “Secret Speech” by Khrushchev that denounced Stalin, a native of Georgia. The protests began with a memorial on the anniversary of Stalin’s death and quickly escalated to protests calling for a change in government. The Soviet Army was called in on the night of the 9th and crushed the protest killing dozens.

Tet Offensive - Coordinated attacks, named for the New Years holiday, by the North Vietnamese and Viet Cong on January 31, 1968. They took place in South Vietnamese cities in an effort to inspire a general uprising against the government. Though the effort failed and could be considered a major defeat, the ability of the North to mobilize tens of thousands of troops deep inside the South with little awareness of the US military shook the confidence of the US and was seen as a major embarrassment for the military and Johnson administration. Almost 10,000 civilians were killed in the South and over 2,600 troops died. The North was reported to have suffered as many as 60,000 troops lost.

The (Khrushchev) Thaw - The liberalization of government controls in the Soviet Union over culture and discussion. It allowed cinema, art, and literature to be created more freely and political dissent to be expressed more openly. It was generated by the de-Stalinization process led by Khrushchev beginning in the mid-fifties. It allowed for the publication of iconic works such as *Doctor Zhivago*, *One Day in the Life of Ivan Denisovich*, as well as films and artwork that did not stick to the previously required confines of socialist realism. The thaw was not even-handed and many of the discussions and creations that resulted were subsequently repressed as anti-Soviet or harmful to society.

The Day After (1983) - Made for television movie that dramatically described a situation where a nuclear war breaks out between NATO and the Warsaw Pact over Germany. It follows characters affected by the strike and the fallout in Kansas. Over 100 million people watched the film when it was broadcast on November 20, 1983, on ABC representing 62% of the viewing audience. President Reagan viewed the film in advance and remarked that it was “very effective and left me greatly depressed.” It created a larger nation-wide discussion on the threat of nuclear war and the lack of realistic ways to survive it. It was also shown in the USSR in 1987.

Third World - Term used during the Cold War (starting in 1952) to refer to countries that were not part of the capitalist or socialist system political systems led by the US and USSR. The phrase generally referred to the countries of Africa, Asia, and Latin America.

Tiananmen Square Massacre (1989) - The violent end to a months-long student-led protest for democratic reforms in Beijing. The protests were linked to several efforts throughout the country that kicked off after the death of former general secretary and liberal, Hu Yaobang. The economic reforms of the 1980s in the PRC and the political reforms in socialist nations in Europe inspired students to demand more political freedoms. A visit by the reform-minded Gorbachev to Beijing further emboldened the protests, but soon after the Soviet premier left the military was called out to completely dismantle the protest site, killing hundreds at a minimum. The details of the event have since been suppressed in China.

Truman Doctrine - Policy announced by President Truman on March 12, 1947, that committed the US to aid countries that were threatened by communist revolutions. It was inspired by the situations in Greece and Turkey where communist insurgents were making gains and by the fact that the UK had announced it could no longer afford to support anti-communist efforts in the Mediterranean region.

Tsar Bomba - The “King of Bombs” that was detonated by the USSR on October 30, 1961 near the Arctic. It was the largest nuclear weapon ever detonated and had a yield of over 50 megatons (originally designed for 100 megatons). It could be seen from over 600 miles away and would have caused severe injuries over 60 miles away.

U-2 Incident - Political standoff between the US and USSR after Francis Gary Powers and his U-2 spy plane were shot down over the Soviet Union on May 1, 1960. It led to the Paris Peace Conference between the two countries ending abruptly after the US was forced to retract their original denials of being responsible for any such flights.

US Invasion of Cambodia (1970) - US Army troops moved into neutral Cambodia from positions in South Vietnam on April 28, 1970. This was part of an effort to cut off the Ho Chi Minh trail used by the North Vietnamese to supply NVA and Viet Cong fighters. The incursion came a month after a coup in Cambodia and would last until late July. Protests sprang up in the US and Congress began to seek new ways to limit President Nixon's ability to unilaterally use military force.

USSR - Fifteen areas that comprised the Union of Soviet Socialist Republics which was first established in 1917 and lasted until 1991. It was the largest country at the time and covered $\frac{1}{6}$ of the land area on Earth. Its government was headed by local Soviets that fed into the Supreme Soviet in Moscow, though the Communist Party apparatus had de facto control. The Republics consisted of Armenia, Azerbaijan, Belorussia, Estonia, Georgia, Kazakhstan, Kirgiziya, Latvia, Lithuania, Moldavia, Russia, Tajikistan, Turkmenistan, Ukraine, and Uzbekistan.

Venona project - Secret operation by the US Army Signal Intelligence Service and then the NSA that started in 1943. Until 1980, it used access to KGB cypher books to translate messages about Soviet espionage activities including agents in the Manhattan Project and the Cambridge Five.

Vietnam War (aka the American War) - Conflict between North and South Vietnam from 1954-1975, that followed the removal of French colonial forces in 1954. The North would be aided by the USSR and PRC and by the Viet Cong in South Vietnam. The South would be aided by the US until its withdrawal in 1973. The South would be overrun by the North in 1975, and the war would end with the unification of the country under communist rule.

Vietnamization - Policy announced by President Nixon in 1969, that sought to gradually make South Vietnam more responsible for military activities in their country. It would lead to the eventual withdrawal of active US forces in a cease-fire signed in January of 1973.

War Powers Act (aka War Powers Resolution) - Law passed in the US on November 17, 1973. The law, inspired by prolonged involvement in Vietnam and other parts of Southeast Asia (specifically Cambodia), curbed the ability of a president to use troops overseas without congressional approval. Many presidents have followed the law without claiming their actions were actually required by the law.

Warsaw Pact - Mutual Defense treaty signed on May 14, 1955 that lasted until July 1, 1991. It included Albania, Bulgaria, Czechoslovakia, East Germany, Hungary, and Poland. Albania would withdraw in 1968 due to the Czech invasion. It was inspired by the addition of West Germany into NATO.

Warsaw Uprising - Attempt by Polish resistance fighters (Home Army) to push out occupying German forces from August to October of 1944. Soviet troops were within striking distance, but waited for the conflict to play out and the partisans to be defeated before advancing on the German positions and taking the city. The Allies were not allowed to use nearby bases to drop supplies to the Poles, and the result was a massacre of Polish forces and residents that destroyed the political base of the non-communist government-in-exile.

Yalta Conference - Meeting of the Big Three (Churchill, FDR, and Stalin) in February 1945, to discuss the post-war world. It would be the final meeting of the three due to changes in leadership. The agreements from the conference were for free elections in most of the territories formerly occupied by Axis powers, but much of this never came to be as Stalin used troops on the ground in liberated territories to enforce his desires. The USSR also agreed to join in the Pacific War in exchange for land concessions and the structure of the UN Security Council was agreed to.

Yom Kippur War (aka Fourth Arab-Israeli War) - Conflict that began on October 6, 1973, when Egypt and Syria attacked Israeli forces to regain territories occupied by Israel during the Six-Day War (1967). Israel was taken by surprise and was retreating before the US agreed to resupply their forces. The US changed their policy after the USSR began supplying Arab forces. The fighting ended on October 26th after intense pressure from the UN. The conflict would eventually lead to the return of the Sinai to Egypt, laying the groundwork for the Camp David Accords.

SECTION II - PRIMARY READING SELECTION

SUMMARY OF “NUCLEAR FOLLY” BY SERHII PLOKHY

“Of course, I was scared. It would have been insane not to be scared... If being frightened meant that I helped avert such insanity, then I’m glad I was frightened. One of the problems in the world today is that not enough people are sufficiently frightened by...nuclear war.”

-Nikita Khrushchev, December 1962

Preface

Hawaii had a false alarm about inbound missiles on January 13, 2018. It was a mistake, but the system, which had not been tested since 1987 began being re-tested in 2017 due to aggressiveness from North Korea’s Kim Jong-un. North Korea had tested a hydrogen bomb in October of 2017. In 2020, Iran withdrew from the agreement to limit its nuclear weapons development. Leon Panetta and John Bolton called the situation the worst nuclear crisis since Cuba. Vladimir Putin threatened a crisis in 2019 with the possibility of having supersonic missiles in Russian subs near the US coast. In 2020, the US assassinated Iran’s Qasem Suleimani and Iran formally withdrew from the nuclear deal. These events all brought mentions of the Cuban Crisis.

Much has been written on the Crisis, but gaps exist. Robert Kennedy’s *Thirteen Days* is a popular source of information, but contains biases exposed by the ExCom tapes. More works such as those by Dobbs and Cuban historians have expanded understanding. Much of the work focuses on what was done right, but this work focuses on the mistakes that could have easily compounded. JFK gave his cabinet and military leaders Barbara Tuchman’s *The Guns of August* to make them aware of how small decisions can lead to catastrophes like WWI. JFK pushed for a strike on Cuban missiles without knowing if they were armed or the levels of troop strength supporting them. Khrushchev did not expect such a response and lost control of the situation. Castro was eager to confront the US. The one factor that kept them out of war was Khrushchev and JFK’s fear of a nuclear confrontation.

These leaders came of age after Hiroshima and Nagasaki and lived with the knowledge of the massive destructive power shown through the hydrogen bomb tests of Castle Bravo (1954) and the Tsar Bomba (1961).

The Intermediate Range Nuclear Forces Treaty (1987) signed by Ronald Reagan and Mikhail Gorbachev was abandoned in August 2019. A week later, a Russian nuclear cruise missile (Skyfall) exploded accidentally.

Prologue

“That was horrifying. I meant that had a US invasion been carried out...there was a 99 percent probability that nuclear war would have been initiated.”

-Robert McNamara

Former Secretary of Defense Robert McNamara did not learn of the actual number of Soviet troops in Cuba in 1962 (43,000) until a conference on the 30th anniversary of the Crisis. The Kennedy administration had believed there were no more than 10,000. Former Commander of Warsaw forces, General Anatoly Gribkov also revealed the presence of previously unknown tactical nuclear weapons

known as Luna/Frog missiles. These were meant to defend against invading forces and their use was up to Soviet commanders on site.

Part I: Nemesis

Chapter 1: Apprentice

“Ask not what your country can do for you - ask what you can do for your country... We shall pay any price, bear any burden, meet any hardship, support any friend, oppose any foe to assure the survival and success of liberty... Let us never negotiate out of fear. But let us never negotiate.”

-Kennedy Inaugural Address

“In a parliamentary government, I’d have to resign. But in the government, I can’t, so you and Allen have to go.”

-Kennedy to Bissell after the Bay of Pigs

JFK was the youngest president to be elected (43). His predecessor was former general Dwight Eisenhower (70). Robert Frost wrote a poem for the inauguration comparing JFK’s term to an “Augustan age.” JFK’s speech did not mention the USSR or Khrushchev directly, but the speech was, in part, directed at them. JFK called out to Latin American countries to oppose aggression and work with the US.

Cuba was a former Spanish colony. Nearby Haiti became independent from France in 1804 and Mexico separated from Spain in the same year. Simón Bolívar helped Venezuela gain independence (1821). Cuba did not revolt until a 10-year campaign starting in 1868. More revolts occurred in 1879 and 1895. The US invaded Cuba in June 1898, as a response to publicized Spanish atrocities and to defend the Monroe Doctrine of 1823. President Monroe declared the US would defend against European threats to independence in the Americas. This conflict expanded the doctrine to include supporting independence from European countries in the Americas. Independence was declared in 1902.

In 1820, Jefferson thought Cuba could be a new state, but in 1902 the Platt Amendment of the US Army Appropriations Act of 1901 kept Cuba nominally independent and the US able to intervene with broad latitude. This led new rebels to seek to remove Cuba from the status of a US protectorate. It was a colony in all but name. General Fulgencio Batista was president of Cuba (1940-44) and then dictator after a coup (1952) and was a close ally of US agricultural companies and Mafia groups operating in Cuba. On July 23, 1953, Fidel Castro (26) and other young revolutionaries attacked the Mocada Barracks in Santiago. He and his brother were imprisoned after the attack failed. They were released in 1955 and went to Mexico. In November 1956, they led a group aboard the *Granma* to reinvade Cuba.

The group operated a guerilla war from the Sierra Maestra mountains after 19 (including Che Guevara) of 81 survived the landing attack. Batista came down hard on the new rebels which soured US public opinion. The US stopped selling Batista weapons in 1958 which was a turning point for the rebels. On December 31st, Castro attacked Santa Clara which led to Batista leaving Cuba. Castro paraded through Havana on January 8, 1959. Castro executed nearly 200 officials and purged enemies to secure dominant power.

In 1959, Castro limited the size of land holdings and redistributed the excess. In 1960, he nationalized all US businesses without compensation. Eisenhower boycotted Cuba’s lead export of sugar. Castro visited the US in 1959 and distanced himself from communist beliefs, but the next year after

Anastas Mikoyan visited Cuba, the USSR began assistance and Khrushchev claimed he would protect Cuban independence with nuclear arms.

The CIA led a coup in Guatemala in 1954 to protect the United Fruit Company from reforms. Eisenhower supported a similar path in Cuba. The plan to foment an uprising was planned, but not put in action before JFK took office. Allen Dulles was the CIA Director for Eisenhower and JFK. He presented the Cuba plan a week after JFK's inauguration. Richard Bissell was the plan's creator. He planned for the initial invasion to be supported by an OAS-backed US occupation. The Joint Chiefs of Staff did not believe the six-eight thousand insurgents being trained was enough and worried about the need for US military support. Secretary of State Dean Rusk worried there would be an international backlash.

JFK tried to balance the goal of containment of communism with not using military might to control the Americas. JFK suggested using small groups to infiltrate Cuba. Bissell eventually countered with a plan using air support painted in Cuban colors. This required moving the landing to Bahía de Cochinos/Bay of Pigs, because it had a landing strip that could be used to look as if the rebels were from the Cuban Air Force. JFK approved the invasion at night, so US support ships could be gone by daylight. It was set for April 16th. It was codenamed Zapata and JFK received updates while "vacationing" in Virginia.

Around 1,400 exiles left Nicaragua with 8 B-26 bombers to take out Cuban air support. UN Ambassador for Cuba, Raúl Roa, called for an emergency meeting of the Political and Security Committee. The raid against the Cuban Air Force was claimed to be successful and of Cuban origin by a secretly CIA-planted pilot landing in Miami with one of the B-26 bombers. US Ambassador to the UN, Adlai Stevenson, showed a picture of the plane to prove the US was not involved.

JFK still had to give final invasion approval. Reports were already out exposing the pilot in Miami as being a CIA plant. JFK finally consented and late on April 16th, Brigade 2506 landed. Later at Playa Girón in the Bay of Pigs, a radio broadcast of the invasion alerted Castro. The Cuban air power had only suffered minor damage. The invaders lost the *USS Houston* and the *USS Escondido* and their supplies. Coral reefs blocked transports from landing directly leading to a loss of more supplies. Rusk was angered by the CIA pilot stunt that led to Stevenson unknowingly lying at the UN. He supported JFK in his decision not to allow the CIA further air support that came directly from the US. As the invasion floundered, JFK allowed for more air support in Cuban-colored planes on April 19th. Cuba shot down two planes and claimed to recover the body of a US pilot. On April 20th, the invaders surrendered hopelessly outnumbered and without supplies needed to continue. JFK was angered by what he saw as an operation that overpromised, underperformed, and was forced upon him. Bissell, Dulles, and Lemnitzer were removed. JFK and military leaders now mistrusted and blamed each other.

Chapter 2: Master of the Game

"Do you want to make us turn the arms race into a competition? We will beat you! Our missile production is on a conveyor belt."

-Khrushchev addressing the UN

"We helped elect Kennedy...It can be said that we elected him."

-Khrushchev to Soviet leaders in 1961

“If there is any madman that wants war, he should be put in a straitjacket.”

-Khrushchev to JFK at Vienna

“We do not want to fight, but we have fought before. And others in earlier times have made the same dangerous mistake of assuming that the West was too selfish and too soft and too divided to resist invasions of freedom in other lands. Those who threaten to unleash the forces of war on a dispute over West Berlin should recall the words of the ancient philosopher: ‘A man who causes fear cannot be free from fear.’”

-JFK announcing military build-up after Khrushchev’s Berlin declaration

Khrushchev was inspired by his mother’s desire to see him succeed whereas JFK was pushed by a powerful father. Khrushchev and Kennedy were opposites in many ways from upbringing to style. JFK led a PT-109 torpedo boat in WWI while Khrushchev managed people his entire adult life, but was 60 before dealing with foreign relations. He was 23 years older than JFK, who was born in the year of the 1917 Russian revolution. Khrushchev was upset by Eisenhower’s U-2 flights and favored JFK over Nixon in the 1960 election. He believed he could intimidate JFK more. He directed KGB officer, Yuri Barsukov (posing as an *Izvestia* reporter), to contact Robert Kennedy about helping JFK’s campaign. RFK asked the USSR to do nothing and after the election they could improve relations. Khrushchev continued to attack Eisenhower and push the false “missile gap” rhetoric including during a speech at the UN.

Barsukov contacted RFK after the election. He reported that JFK wanted a nuclear test-ban treaty, an agreement on Berlin, and to discuss common problems with China. Khrushchev believed relations would improve and had JFK’s inaugural address published in the USSR. He released the captured RB-47H surveillance crew, Captain Freeman Bruce Olmstead and John McCone, that had been shot down over the USSR on July 1, 1960. Khrushchev was eager to meet with JFK and more so after seeing the mistakes of the Bay of Pigs.

Khrushchev and JFK met at the US Embassy in Vienna on June 3, 1961. Khrushchev remembered that JFK had been late to a meeting with Senators during Khrushchev’s 1959 visit to the US. The US was surprised that the conference was still on after the Bay of Pigs, but USSR Ambassador Andrei Gromyko and US Ambassador Llewellyn Thompson had met and confirmed the need “to build bridges.” The leaders were to discuss the Laotian Civil War, Berlin, and nuclear disarmament. Khrushchev instead drew a hardline on Berlin and attacked JFK relentlessly.

The Potsdam Conference (1945) with Truman and Stalin had created West Berlin. It had US, UK, and French troops controlling sectors of the city, 100 miles inside East Germany. The Soviet sector became East Berlin. In June 1948, Stalin ordered a blockade of West Berlin ground transportation from the West. The air corridors were still open and 13,000 tons of food were airlifted daily. The blockade ended in May 1949. The Federal Republic of Germany (West Germany) was created that month and ended military occupation there. In October, the German Democratic Republic (East Germany) was created. Berlin remained occupied by the four powers. The Marshall Plan from the US created a booming FRG economy. The struggling GDR began bleeding people to the opportunities of the West.

In June 1953, a strike-turned-riot in East Berlin threatened Walter Ulbricht’s control of the country. Khrushchev used the opportunity to assert power in the USSR which was in transition after Stalin’s death. Lavrentii Beria (former head of the NKVD) was removed from control for supposedly being soft on the West and lacking support for the GDR. Khrushchev consolidated his power in July 1957,

when he removed Soviet leaders opposed to his economic commitment to the GDR. In 1958, Khrushchev made the threat of signing a peace agreement with the GDR which would remove Western access to Berlin.

JFK voiced concerns over the impact of any nuclear miscalculations. Khrushchev countered that to avoid them, there needed to be a formal end to the war with Germany, recognition of the FRG and GDR, and make Berlin a free city. If not, the USSR would sign a separate peace agreement with the GDR. When JFK pushed back, Khrushchev said a treaty would be signed by the end of the year, and any attempt to violate GDR sovereignty would lead to Soviet involvement. Khrushchev continued to threaten war stating it would be the fault of the US if it happened. Khrushchev stated that “force will be met with force,” to which JFK replied then “it will be a cold winter.”

JFK called the summit the “roughest thing in my life.” Khrushchev believed JFK was immature and inexperienced. JFK was on crutches due to his increasing back pain. Khrushchev released a statement on June 11th that the USSR would sign a peace agreement with the GDR in six months. He blamed the “capitalist monopolist” for using the Cold War to prepare for war. JFK received an estimate of 70 million casualties in a possible nuclear war with the USSR. The US population was around 180 million. JFK compared the losses of one missile (600,000) to all those lost in the US Civil War and noted the country had not “gotten over that in a hundred years.”

JFK wanted to show strength. Congress had just authorized \$12 billion in arms and JFK asked for \$3.25 more. He also added 90,000 new military recruits. Khrushchev called JFK’s speech calling for increased defense spending a “preliminary declaration of war” when he met with John J. McCoy, the US disarmament negotiator.

Khrushchev needed a Berlin solution to stop the 130,000 people leaving the GDR for the West in 1961. The GDR leader, Walter Ulbricht, wanted to stop the flow by building a wall around West Berlin. The Eastern bloc feared a retaliatory economic blockade. After the JFK defense speech, Khrushchev gave approval for a wall. On August 13th, the border was blocked with troops and barbed wire. Khrushchev delayed his threatened peace treaty and hoped the wall would help with the Berlin situation.

JFK had not expected the wall, but it actually helped diffuse the tension surrounding the Berlin situation. The Western Allies were still able to access East Berlin and the US framed it as mainly affecting East Germans. People in West Berlin were not pleased and Mayor Willy Brandt asked for, and received, an additional 1,500 US troops in the city. Khrushchev pushed for a peace treaty in communications with JFK in October of 1961. JFK supported the status quo of the wall and Khrushchev dropped his push. Ulbricht protested the abandonment of the fight for GDR sovereignty.

General Lucius Clay was the US military governor of Germany that oversaw the Berlin airlift. JFK sent him back to Berlin in 1961 to appease West Berliners upset about the wall. He precipitated a crisis at Checkpoint Charlie on October 27th, when US and USSR tanks faced each other in a show of force over access by US personnel to East Berlin. The Soviets eventually began a slight withdrawal that the US mirrored and a crisis was averted. RFK and Soviet Colonel Georgii Bolshakov had negotiated an end to the conflict in secret.

Part II: Red Gamble

Chapter 3: Triumph of Communism

"If Mr. Kennedy does not like socialism, well, we do not like imperialism! We do not like capitalism! We have as much right to protest over the existence of an imperialist-capitalist regime 90 miles from our coast as he feels he has to protest the existence of a socialist regime 90 miles from his coast."

-Castro declaring the Cuban Revolution to be socialist

The Twenty-second Party Congress was held from October 17th-31st in 1961. Khrushchev unveiled his third (and purportedly final) plan for communist development in the Soviet Union. The first plan from 1902 was to topple the Czar and the second in 1919 was to build a socialist state. The third plan was to complete the transition to complete communism. Khrushchev invited a member of the former imperial Duma that had witnessed Nicholas II abdicate. During the congress, the USSR detonated the largest bomb in history, the Tsar Bomba aka Big Ivan, a hydrogen bomb that exploded near the Novaia Zemlia Archipelago in the Arctic Ocean. It was 58 megatons versus the 15 ton Castle Bravo test by the US at Bikini Atoll in 1954. On the day of the Tsar Bomba test, the congress voted to remove Stalin from the viewing area next to Lenin.

Zhou Enlai was the head of the Chinese communist government contingent and China still revered Stalin. China's leader, Mao Zedong, saw attacks on Stalin's cult of personality by Khrushchev as an attack on him. A CIA assessment of the Sino-Soviet rift stated Khrushchev favored "peaceful coexistence" and supporting communism abroad as opposed to the militant and more revolutionary Chinese communists. Cuba was the main focus of Third World communist development. Despite praise for success at the Bay of Pigs, Khrushchev did not recognize Castro as a Marxist. He believed the revolution to be nationalist rather than socialist. Moscow was wary of embracing Castro as part of the communist movement and needing to defend Cuba.

Castro had declared his revolution to be socialist on International Workers Day (May 1st) 1961. Castro felt the Bay of Pigs was a prelude to a larger US invasion and asked the USSR for \$200 million in aid including SAM sites that could shoot down U-2 spy planes. Khrushchev agreed to \$150 million. Castro went on to call himself a Marxist-Leninist on December 2, 1961 in his "I am a Marxist" speech. Soviet media did not fully embrace the declaration. They grouped Castro with Sukarno of Indonesia, Nehru of India, and Nkrumah of Ghana as anti-imperialists sympathetic to socialist ideals. Khrushchev believed Castro's statement was a mistake since it would alienate some that might support his revolution.

In 1962, JFK announced new economic embargos on Cuban sugar and cigars that greatly weakened the Cuban economy. Castro tried to consolidate his power by purging Anibal Escalante and other Cuban Communist Party leaders. Escalante had been the powerful secretary of the Integrated Revolutionary Organizations and supported Moscow's policies. Escalante went to Moscow and claimed Chinese influence was growing in Cuba. Moscow renounced Escalante in favor of Castro. Khrushchev's son-in-law, Aleksei Adzhubei, was the editor of *Izvestia*, and reported to the Central Committee that he had discussed Cuba with JFK, and believed an invasion was still likely.

On April 12, 1962, the Presidium of the Central Committee approved 180 antiaircraft SAM missiles for Cuba. Some of the other supplies sent were taken from shipments earmarked for Abdel Nasser's regime in Egypt. Though less missiles than asked for, Castro also received 10 bombers and 4 cruise missile launchers, meant to better repel an invasion. By May 1962, \$228 million rubles worth of equipment was agreed upon. Since Cuba's economy was failing, Khrushchev agreed to forgive the debt

owed on the armaments and negate future payments for the next two years of shipments. Khrushchev also replaced the ambassador to Cuba with the KGB station chief in Havana, Aleksandr Alekseev, whom Castro favored. The plan, approved in May, also included economic planning and agricultural assistance. On the one-year anniversary of the Bay of Pigs, April 18, 1962, Khrushchev formally welcomed “Comrade Fidel” into the communist movement.

Chapter 4: Rocket Man

“While I was on the official visit to Bulgaria,...one thought kept hammering away at my brain: ‘what will happen if we lose Cuba?’...We had to think up some way of confronting America with more than words...We had to establish a tangible and effective deterrent to American interference in the Caribbean, but what exactly?”

-Khrushchev reflecting on his state visit to Bulgaria

...the United States wants to incite me, as head of the Soviet government, to compete with him as to who will ‘push the button’ first?...The president of the United States of America made an ill-advised statement. Is it wise to threaten someone who is at least as strong as you? Pushing the button and taking ‘the initiative in a nuclear conflict with the Soviet Union’ would actually mean committing suicide.”

-Khrushchev in Bulgaria responding to JFK’s statements about a possible first nuclear strike

“Khrushchev had a rich imagination, and when some idea took hold of him, he was inclined to see in its implementation an easy solution to a particular problem, a sort of cure-all,”

-Khrushchev’s assistant, Oleg Troianovsky, remarking on the idea to introduce nuclear missiles in Cuba

Khrushchev visited First Secretary Todor Zhivkov of Bulgaria to sign an agreement with the culturally and politically sympathetic country. Zhivkov would hold power from 1954 to the fall of communism in Bulgaria in 1989. 250,000 people gathered in Sofia (a city of 800,000) to welcome Khrushchev as an honorary guest. Khrushchev used the trip to show his authority over the world communist movement almost as a “communist pope.” Despite the adulation, he was focused on Cuba.

In April 1962, the US resumed atmospheric nuclear testing with a bomb on Christmas Island. Khrushchev fired his commander of the Strategic Missile Forces, Marshall Kirill Moskalenko (aka General Panic), for the increasing missile gap with the US. The new US “Minuteman” missile was a solid fuel ICBM that was instantly ready for deployment. This was a huge advantage over Soviet liquid fueled rockets. The budget and research had been increased on solid fuel rockets after Sputnik launched in 1957, and the new missile was successfully tested in 1961 by Boeing. Moskalenko had been an ally of Khrushchev, arrested Beria, defended Khrushchev against the 1957 coup attempt and had success, but had to go. He was able to announce the R-16/SS-7 ICBM capable of reaching Washington was ready after its catastrophic failure at Baikonur in 1960 (which had killed Moskalenko’s predecessor, Marshal Mitrofan Nedelin). It still required hours of prep to launch. Missile designers Mikhail Yangel (R-16) and Sergei Korolev (Sputnik/R-9) were struggling to match anything that could deter a first strike from the US. The missile gap was widening in quality and quantity. Missile engineer, Vladimir Chelomei, was authorized to design the Universal Rocket 500 (capable of carrying a Tsar Bomba like warhead) and 200 (capable of traveling 12,000 km) systems. Yangel was instructed to build the R-36 (aka the SS-18 Satan), a multiple

independently targetable reentry vehicle (MIRV). It wouldn't arrive until 1974. Marshal Sergei Biriuzov replaced Moskalenko, who became inspector in chief of the Ministry of Defense.

Khrushchev met with US Press Secretary Pierre Salinger in Moscow and attacked JFK for saying there were scenarios where the US would use nuclear weapons first against the USSR. He retracted the remarks, but Khrushchev was not placated. Khrushchev spoke out about the PGM-19 Jupiter missiles in Turkey and Italy. The medium-range missiles were ready by early 1962 and could reach Moscow. 120,000 US personnel and associates were in Turkey around the launch sites. During his visit in Bulgaria near Varna, Khrushchev decided he would turn the US's own tactic against it in Cuba. This could overcome the Soviet shortfall in longrange missiles. R-12 (SS-4 Sandals) missiles had a 2,000 km range and were able to be produced "like sausages," as claimed. Khrushchev asked Andrei Gromyko (foreign secretary) about the idea to introduce nuclear missiles to Cuba, and Gromyko did not support the idea. Khrushchev agreed a nuclear war was not the goal, but still believed in his new strategy.

Chapter 5: Going Nuclear

"I told them that the consequences could be dangerous or even catastrophic. The Americans could launch a strike on our missiles and destroy them in several minutes...What would we have to do then? Just swallow that, look disgraced in front of the entire world and possibly lose Cuba, for whose sake we are doing everything? Or retaliate with a nuclear strike, which would mean the initiation of the war?"

-Mikoyan arguing against Operation Anadyr

"They must be given to understand that, in attacking Cuba, they will be dealing not only with one stubborn country, but also with the nuclear might of the Soviet Union. The price of a military venture against Cuba must be raised to the maximum, and in some measure the threat to Cuba must be made comparable to the threat to the United States. Logic suggests ... that only the installation of our rockets with nuclear warheads on Cuban territory can be such a means."

"Since the Americans have already surrounded the Soviet Union with a ring of their military bases and multipurpose missile installations, we should pay them back in their own coin and give them a taste of their own medicine so that they find out for themselves how it feels to live as a target of nuclear arms,"

-Khrushchev arguing for Operation Anadyr

Khrushchev held a meeting on May 21, 1962, with the Defense Council to announce his plan. He framed it as the only way to save Cuba from an invasion. First Deputy in the Council of Ministers, Anastas Mikoyan, dissented to the plan stating the US would attack the bases and the USSR would most likely need to retaliate and risk a nuclear confrontation. Khrushchev agreed it was a risk, but thought if the missiles were installed secretly it could work. Mikoyan did not agree. The Defense Council agreed to the plan to install the missiles secretly and discuss a mutual defense treaty with Castro. Khrushchev had removed all experienced opposition in 1957 so that, except for Mikoyan, few were left to voice differing opinions

The Soviet Minister of Defense named by Khrushchev in 1957 was Marshal Rodion Malinovsky of Ukraine. He was a Spanish Civil War and WWII veteran. Malinovsky and Biriuzov were in charge of creating a plan for the Cuba operation. Secretary of the Defense Council, Colonel General Ivanov, had Major General Anatoly Gribkov secretly create the proposal for the plan. 44,000 soldiers and 1,300

support civilians were proposed to go to Cuba with the equipment. Seventy-eight transports would be needed. It would be named the Group of Soviet Forces in Cuba. 24 R-12 (medium-range) missile launchers and 16 R-14 (intermediate range) launchers would be stationed with 60 total missiles. The goal was to complete the transport by September, so the R-12s could be operational 10 days after transport. The R-14s would take four months to install. It was named Operation Anadyr for the Siberian river near Alaska. The Central Committee Presidium heard the plan on May 24th. Leonid Brezhnev, Aleksei Kosygin, Frol Kozlov, and Mikoyan were present.

Khrushchev continued to try and convince Mikoyan by having Marshal Malinovsky state Cuba could be overrun within a week. Mikoyan asserted that the installation could not be hidden from the US due to the poor cover in Cuba (he had visited in 1960). Aleksandr Alekseev was the ambassador to Cuba and a former KGB officer. He believed allowing a Soviet base in Cuba would go against Castro's stated policies. Khrushchev decided to propose the plan to Castro and have Biriuzov visit Cuba first before moving on. Khrushchev ended the meeting by arguing for defending Cuba and using the missiles to make up for the Soviet missile gap and balance against the threat of missiles in Europe and Turkey which could reach the USSR in 10 minutes. He believed the US would not risk nuclear war and since the Soviets accepted the Turkey situation, they would accept the same situation in Cuba.

Uzbek Communist Party Secretary Sharof Rashidov, Biriuzov, and Alekseev left for Conakry, Guinea to connect to Havana (it would become the main route taken for the Soviets to the "island of freedom"). They met with Castro the next day. Fidel asked for a mutual defense pact similar to the Warsaw Pact to deter a US invasion by linking any attack on Cuba to one on the USSR. Biriuzov stated that missiles could achieve that. Castro wanted to consider the dramatic shift in Soviet policy. He believed he could overcome his statements against foreign bases in Latin America by claiming the missiles were to defend socialism worldwide.

Castro met with the Integrated Revolutionary Organization (his version of a Communist Party) with Che Guevara and Blas Roca. They agreed to accept the missiles to defend the regime. The next day (May 31st), Biriuzov and Raúl Castro (Minister of Defense) reviewed possible sites. Raúl did not believe the 20+ meter long missiles could be hidden. Biriuzov raised no such concerns, as he was likely feeling the pressure to make the mission go forward regardless of the realities on the ground. On June 10th, the Central Committee Presidium heard Biriuzov's conclusions and decided to proceed with Operation Anadyr.

Chapter 6: Operation Anadyr

"We in the Central Committee decided to toss America a 'hedgehog' by placing our rockets in Cuba so that America would be unable to swallow the 'Island of Freedom.'"

-Khrushchev to generals before they left for Cuba

Major General Leonid Garbuz was appointed deputy commander of the Soviet task force in Cuba. Khrushchev gave him and the other generals headed to Cuba a pep talk about the defense of Cuba from the US. The Chief Soviet military adviser in Cuba was Aleksei Dementiev who told Khrushchev that "there's no place there to hide a chicken, let alone a rocket." Raúl Castro travelled to Moscow and also raised concerns, but Khrushchev claimed he could bully JFK if the missiles were discovered.

Colonel General Vladimir Tolubko traveled to the 43rd Missile Division of the 43rd Missile Army in Romny, Ukraine and informed the commanders that they were moving, but not to where. Major

General Statsenko was the commander of the division. He was considered a model soldier from Chornobyl and had become a general at age 43. He had basically created the division and dealt with malfunctioning equipment and delays in creating launchpads for his missiles. His unit was the furthest from Europe and therefore the least effective and would not be missed. General Pavel Dankevich commanded the 43rd Missile Army. He and his deputy, General Leonid Grabuz, would also go to Cuba. The missile group going to Cuba would be renamed the 51st Missile Division aka the “Statsenko outfit.”

Issa Pliev was named commander of the Group of Soviet Troops in Cuba. It was a surprise to him and others. Dankevich was the expected choice since he was a missile commander, but Khrushchev felt that would make the point of the mission obvious. It also reflected the need for coordination of naval, air, and armed forces. Pliev was also trusted by Malinovsky. Pliev fought under him in WWII and earned two Gold Stars. He was made General of the Army (just below Marshal) in 1962. He gained notoriety by attacking strikers and protestors in Novocherkassk on June 2nd. Twenty-seven people were killed and the revolt ended. The event was covered up by the USSR, but it was exposed by Aleksandr Solzhenitsyn in a 1968 novel. Pliev’s exact role is unclear, but it gained him favor with Soviet leadership. Khrushchev trusted him despite his age and that he was mainly experienced in the cavalry. Dankevich became Pliev’s first deputy. Garbuz became deputy in charge of battle readiness. Dementiev was made deputy in charge of ground troops.

Pliev had no diplomatic experience, understanding of missiles, and had kidney disease. He was not respected by the younger subordinates. His name was changed to Pavlov to hide his identity. He left on the first ever Soviet flight from Moscow to Havana on a Tupolev 114 to see if passenger flights would be viable between the cities. They stopped to refuel at Conakry where a Soviet built airport was opening. The mission was the first time missiles were shipped outside of the USSR. Major Anatoly Burlov was told he and other officers were agricultural specialists and had to adopt the names on their passports which were misspelled or wrong. They stopped in the Bahamas due to a storm and were photographed by curious US tourists.

Biriuzov had told others the weather was enjoyable in Cuba, but he had not experienced hurricane season. Sidorov and others also found he was wrong about the terrain. It was ill suited for hiding missiles and had poisonous plants. They scouted over 150 new locations with the Cubans and found 10 suitable areas to install missiles, but not hide them. The bridges were not strong enough and the power stations were on a different frequency than what was needed for the Soviet equipment. Moscow finally acknowledged there was little chance of hiding the missiles so antiaircraft equipment was sent ahead of the missiles to stop U-2 spy planes from fly-over missions. This fooled the US into thinking all the arriving equipment was of a defensive nature.

Chapter 7: High Seas

“We’re being taken for slaughter,...I’m ready to lose my party card as long as I get back to the Union...The best thing to do on encountering Americans is to surrender and be taken prisoner.”
-Captain Sizov to a KGB informant aboard the Nikolai Burdenko traveling to Cuba

Ilia Mechnikov was the ship that delivered the first Soviet weapons to Cuba in 1960. It would eventually be sunk during the Yom Kippur War in 1973 while in Syria. It was said to be carrying 1,260 tons of freight to Le Havre in France, but it actually took military equipment and personnel to Cuba. Captain Zozulia was the KGB officer assigned to the ship. The ship’s mechanic became sick and needed

an appendectomy. Zozulia would not let him go ashore and risk exposure of the false cargo manifest or secret destination. Doctors onboard performed the surgery in the “Lenin room” meant for indoctrination. The surgery was not successful and they were told to put the mechanic on a Soviet boat heading back to port. They refused to let him go to the closer port of Gibraltar under control of the British. He was taken there anyway due to his poor condition. No one on board actually knew Cuba was the destination until after the ship passed through the Strait of Gibraltar. At that point, the Captain opened a sealed envelope with the destination.

Colonel Georgii Voronkov was the commander of the 27th Antiaircraft Missile Division (aka Antiaircraft Division no. 10 or Volgograd Division) which was the first of its kind in Cuba. The next division was under Major General Mikhail Tokarenko (Antiaircraft Division no. 11 in the USSR and 12 in Cuba). They had missiles capable of reaching high-altitude U-2s. R-12s first arrived on September 9th aboard the *Omsk*. Colonel Ivan Sidorov commanded the missiles as part of Missile Regiment no. 637. Sidorov was added late to the operation and had two days to assume his command and move his equipment to Sevastopol, Ukraine before shipping out to Cuba. The trains used to transport the equipment also were loaded along with winter clothing since it was announced they were headed north. The men were then given summer and civilian clothes at Sevastopol.

The ships to Cuba were well over capacity with personnel. The soldiers were confined below decks to maintain secrecy creating a humid steamy cell. Almost 75% became seasick. The hydrogen peroxide fuel for the rockets had to be kept below 35 degrees Celsius which was difficult since the crew areas were twice that temperature.

Dmitrii Yazo (last Soviet Minister of Defense under Gorbachev) traveled to Cuba aboard the *Victory* which had at least four times as many passengers aboard than it was designed for. They travelled from the Baltic to the North Sea and then to Cuba suffering from storm-induced seasickness.

Each ship had about half a dozen informants working for the resident KGB officer. They reported that many being sent to Cuba were going against their wishes. More than one thousand soldiers and five hundred officers were found unfit. Many went AWOL to escape the assignment. Some soldiers were upset that their three-year terms were about to end, but they would have to serve in Cuba beyond their term. The KGB feared desertion and defection via jumping overboard while passing through the Bosphorus. All passengers were restricted below decks and guarded. Sailors manning the ships were also upset by the assignment. One locked himself in his room with a woman and wouldn't come out. Some officers were reported to be drinking heavily and setting bad examples.

US overflights of Soviet ships increased as more ships neared Cuba. As August progressed more overflights occurred. Khrushchev had tried to negotiate an end to reconnaissance with JFK, but the President wanted a deal on Berlin and so nothing materialized.

Part III: Agony of Decision

Chapter 8: Prisoner of Berlin

“In reading the history of past wars and how they began, we cannot help but be impressed how frequently the failure of communication, misunderstanding, and mutual irritation have played an important role in the events leading up to fateful decisions for war.”

-JFK replying to Khrushchev about Berlin

“Every time I want to make the West scream, I squeeze on Berlin.”

-Khrushchev

A “Friday news dump” is a public relations strategy of announcing bad news right before the weekend to minimize attention by the media. On Friday, August 31st there was no delaying the impact of the news that arrived. General Marshal S. Carter was the acting-head of the CIA and reported to JFK that a U-2 captured images of Soviet SAM sites in Cuba. This was bad political news for JFK who knew Republicans should use it to attack him in the lead up to the Congressional elections. New York Senator Kenneth Keating led the charge claiming he knew the USSR was building missile bases in Cuba. He had been told by a military source in Cuba that the sites were being built in 1961. They were not, but now news showed they likely were being constructed.

JFK wanted to make a public statement. He decided against going to Khrushchev because he no longer trusted him to negotiate honestly. Cuba was becoming more pressing than Berlin and JFK wanted a comprehensive briefing on Tuesday after the Labor Day holiday. JFK’s foreign policy team was full of highly-educated individuals. McGeorge Bundy had been a dean at Harvard and became the National Security Advisor. Robert McNamara had been the president of Ford Motor Company and became the Secretary of Defense. RFK was the Attorney General. Dean Rusk was a Rhodes scholar and had become the Secretary of State. Plans in Berlin were looked at from the “Poodle Blanket” military analysis of possible responses. Phase one was already happening with the Soviets interfering with some access to Berlin. Khrushchev had sent a letter to JFK in July that sought a removal of occupation forces in Berlin. JFK responded by alluding to *The Guns of August* and how WWI era leaders had stumbled into a global war.

Khrushchev backed off his threats over Berlin in late July. He told US Ambassador to the USSR, Llewellyn Thompson, that he did not want to cause trouble for JFK leading up to Congressional elections. In exchange, Khrushchev wanted an end to US flyovers of Soviet ships heading to Cuba. Khrushchev secretly had no more aspirations about changing Berlin since the building of the wall. He pushed back on Ulbricht’s continued desire for a separate peace agreement, but Khrushchev would still use Berlin as a bargaining chip to pressure the West. JFK’s advisors thought that Soviet actions in Berlin (i.e. removing the office of Soviet commandant so Western powers had to communicate directly with GDR authorities) were a precursor to more aggression.

Operation Mongoose was the only US activity in Cuba until August 1962. It involved sabotage and psychological warfare. The CIA did not believe the Soviets would move significant troops into Cuba, but by late August, they discovered soldiers had already landed. RFK, McNamara, Rusk, and Bundy had gathered to discuss Operation Mongoose, but had to shift gears when presented with new CIA data about possible SAM sites. They considered a blockade of Soviet materials to Cuba, but Bundy feared such a move would lead to a blockade of Berlin. CIA Director John McCone noted that US activity on the island was becoming more difficult due to increased security. RFK suggested staging an attack on the US base at Guantánamo, but McCone felt the chances of success were limited. He met personally with JFK and let the President know that the CIA could not be sure that the SAM sites were not actually surface-to-surface missiles. McCone suggested a three stage plan to rid Cuba of Castro that would culminate in an invasion if the first two destabilizing stages did not remove him. Some thought the missiles in Turkey and Italy could be removed without losing tactical advantages. JFK was concerned about what would happen in Berlin based on actions in Cuba and vice versa.

JFK met with his foreign policy team on September 4th. Rusk had prepared a statement that stated offensive weapons in Cuba would lead to immediate action by the US. What would fall under “offensive weapons” or “action” was vague and debated. McNamara suggested a blockade again, but JFK wanted to use the threat of action as leverage for a possible Soviet blockade of Berlin. McNamara instead suggested mobilizing reserves. It would mollify Congress and would be necessary if an invasion was eventually needed. The final statement to the press did not include the original promise to avoid an invasion of Cuba nor did it include the planned promise to uphold the Monroe Doctrine. The situation was framed as a Cuban issue and not a Soviet one. JFK met with Congressional leaders to ask for reserves to be called up. He stated that he believed a blockade would be an act of war and an invasion was unnecessary because there were no nuclear warheads present. He believed Berlin would actually be the main crisis before the end of the year.

Chapter 9: Tip-Off

We will give him a choice—to go to war or sign a peace treaty... War in this day and age means no Paris and no France, all in the space of an hour,...It's been a long time since you could spank us like a little boy—now we can swat your ass.”

-Khrushchev to Secretary Udall on September 6, 1962

“Both we and the Americans talked about Berlin—both sides with the same aim, namely, to draw attention away from Cuba; the Americans, in order to attack it; we, in order to make the USA uneasy and postpone attacking Cuba,”

-Khrushchev to a Czechoslovak delegation on October 30, 1962

“In a situation of an enemy landing on the island of Cuba and of the concentration of enemy ships with amphibious forces off the coast of Cuba in its territorial waters, when the destruction of the enemy is delaying [further actions] and there is no possibility of receiving instructions from the USSR Ministry of Defense, you are permitted to make your own decision and to use the nuclear means of the ‘Luna,’ IL-28 or FKR-1 [short-range cruise missiles] as instruments of local warfare for the destruction of the enemy on land and along the coast in order to achieve the complete destruction of the invaders on Cuban territory and to defend the Republic of Cuba.”

-Instructions to Commander Pliev

Khrushchev visited his native village of Kalinovka before heading to a missile factory and finally to Yalta on August 1st. Later that month in Moscow, he celebrated the return of the first dual space flight in history. Che Guevara met with him on August 30th to discuss a defense treaty. Assurances of help were made, but Khrushchev and Malinkovsky believed the US would not invade over the missiles being installed in Cuba. Khrushchev agreed to a possible ban on atmospheric testing proposed by UK PM Harold Macmillan on August 27th. He withdrew his demand for a ban on underground testing as well. All efforts were made to play nice and distract from Cuba. The US reaction to the SAM sites arrived on September 5th. Khrushchev took the warning as a sign that he must hurry his plans and have the nuclear missiles operational in Cuba as soon as possible.

Khrushchev had a villa in Pitsunda on the Black Sea. US Secretary of the Interior, Stewart Udall visited on September 6th. He threatened to sign a separate treaty with the GDR in response to JFK's

statement on Cuba. He stated we would not allow military access to Berlin. He threatened war if JFK would not accept the peace treaty. He claimed Cuba was receiving defensive weapons and that any attack by the US on Cuba would result in a USSR attack on a US base in Turkey or Europe. The Soviet Cuba expert, Anastas Mikoyan, stated that Berlin was used as a focus to divert attention from Cuba, despite there being no real intent to solve the Berlin situation. The US helped in this ruse by being so singularly focused on Berlin.

Khrushchev added new types of equipment to his package for Cuba in anticipation of an invasion. Malinovsky proposed ten to twelve IL-28 bombers with six atomic bombs. These were smaller tactical nuclear weapons designed to be used in combat. He also wanted to send 18 Zemlia (Earth) cruise missiles and Luna (Moon) aka Frog missiles. These were to defend the ranged nuclear missiles.

The weapons could be hurried to Cuba by air, but not the necessary launching pads. It was decided to send them by sea with the other missiles. This was a dramatic shift caused by the JFK statement. The day after approval of tactical weapons, Marshal Matvei Zakharov, the chief of staff of the Soviet armed forces, ordered Lunas and IL-28 bombers to Cuba. Pliev was given new instructions on the use of tactical and long range nuclear weapons in Cuba. Nuclear submarines were also to be sent to Cuba. Nuclear weapons could only be deployed with permission from Moscow/Khrushchev. If communication was not possible, Pliev could make a decision about using tactical nuclear weapons to defend against an invasion. These additional directions were not yet signed by Khrushchev.

On September 8th, JFK announced the call up of reservists. Khrushchev responded on September 11th. His statement was over ten times as long as JFK's initial statement on Cuba. He announced Soviet troops would be put on alert. Khrushchev bluffed that the USSR had no need to put missiles outside of its borders because of their range and strength. He threatened nuclear war if Cuba was attacked. Congress gave JFK approval to invade Cuba and Khrushchev again threatened nuclear war. Khrushchev used the carrot/enticement of a possible test-ban treaty and the stick/threat of action in Berlin after the elections to distract JFK.

JFK brought in Ambassador Thompson and former Soviet ambassador Charles "Chip" Bohlen to ask about Khrushchev's intentions with Cuba. Bohlen wanted JFK to rebuke Khrushchev and felt JFK was being frozen by nuclear threats. He felt JFK was considering Berlin too much when dealing with other problems. JFK responded to Khrushchev on October 8th focused only on setting a goal of January 1, 1963 for the test-ban treaty. There would be no more communication until the "offensive" weapons were discovered in Cuba.

Chapter 10: Honeymoon

CIA Director McCone was in the French Riviera on his honeymoon during September after marrying Theilline Pigott, a wealthy widow. McCone was growing concerned that the SAM sites were a prelude to nuclear weapons. He told his deputy, Carter, of his suspicions. Carter agreed, but did not share the communications with the White House.

On August 30th, a U-2 was identified over Soviet airspace near Sakhalin Island, the US apologized, but another was shot down by the Chinese on September 8th. Rusk was suspicious that the CIA was using the flights to provoke conflict and requested a meeting. Rusk requested a stop of overflights over Cuba so he could focus on Berlin. Flights continued over international waters. Bundy suggested just crossing the island with flights instead of traveling its entire length. Carter was upset by the

suggestion and stated they needed to view the SAM sites. McCone warned Carter from France that the SAMs could keep the U-2s from detecting nuclear missiles.

Most did not share the CIA's leaders' anxiety about Cuba. The September 19th intelligence assessment claimed the Soviets were using Cuba for political purposes only and that nuclear weapons would be a greater risk than the Soviets appeared to be willing to take. The CIA had an accurate assessment of Soviet ships in Cuba, but not a good estimate of equipment and troops. There were approximately 40,000 troops in Cuba as opposed to the CIA estimate of 4,000. The Soviets were installing 576 anti-aircraft missiles at sites in Matanzas, Havana, Mariel, Bahia Honda, Santa Lucia, San Julián, and La Coloma.

A U-2 photographed a SAM site under the command of Major General Mikhail Tokarenko. He had been awarded the Hero of the Soviet Union for his piloting exploits during WWII. He was eager to prove himself, but was not focused on the secrecy needed for his mission. On July 24th, he assured some Cubans that Soviet troops and equipment were on their way and they would help defend the island. Pliev relieved Tokarenko of command and effectively ended his military career. The Cuban officers he talked to were detained to try and keep the information from spreading.

R-12s began arriving at the end of August. The docks of the Casilda sugar factory were used to unload the Soviet ships, but could only handle one at a time. They began unloading on September 9th. General Igor Statsenko was in charge of unloading. To maintain secrecy the missiles were only unloaded at night. The ports were guarded with ships and divers. The approaches to the ports had troops guarding them. The discovery of the SAMs by the US led to a shortened installation schedule. Sidorov's R-12s were supposed to be combat-ready by November 1st. The R-14s would take longer and were set for November 1st-January 1st. The first full regiment did not fully arrive until October. They could move only at night to their construction destinations. Cuban troops and vehicles would go ahead and clear the routes and stage accidents to close access. Soviet troops dressed as Cuban soldiers and used limited Spanish phrases they learned.

Roads had to be built and in the Cuban towns the Soviets feared they would have to demolish buildings and at one point a statue of Yuri Gagarin. Once the equipment arrived, the launchpads had to be built from scratch. Crews had to be changed every hour due to the heat and humidity of hurricane season. Disease and rains also hampered efforts. Despite the obstacles, Sidorov's first launchers were ready on October 8th and the entire regiment was ready on October 18th ahead of schedule. Nuclear warheads arrived on October 4th. The missiles could be launched with warheads within 10 hours.

McCone considered firing Carter while still in France. He had not been aggressively pushing the idea that nuclear weapons could be headed to Cuba by sharing McCone's cables. He returned on September 26th and received a report that a R-12 had been spotted on the roads in Cuba. Cuban refugees were giving information about the secrecy around Cuban military and police activities. McCone met with JFK and RFK on October 9th and suggested resuming full length U-2 flights over Cuba. Chances of a U-2 pilot being shot down by the SAM sites was about one in six. If a pilot was shot down, McNamara suggested claiming it was an Air Force mission and therefore wanted to use Air Force pilots. JFK agreed and Major Richard Heyser was trained to fly over on October 14th. He would fly from Edwards Air Force Base in California to McCoy Air Force Base in Florida and cross Cuba on the way for seven minutes of the seven hour flight.

Heyser was not fired upon and his film was flown to Andrews Air Force Base near DC. Experts at the National Photographic Interpretation Center in Maryland reviewed it on October 15th. They would find evidence of the MRBMs.

Chapter 11: Wipe Them Out

"You better believe it,...Ken Keating will probably be the next president of the United States."

-JFK revealing the situation in Cuba to Kenneth O'Donnell

"Last month I said we were not going 'to allow it.' Last month I should have said we don't care. But when we said we're not going to, and then they go ahead and do it, and then we do nothing, then I would think that our risks increase."

-JFK to his advisory group

JFK started the morning of October 16th reading papers in bed as he normally did. He was reading the coverage of his reception of Algeria's new president, Ahmed Ben Bella, who had just successfully led the end of French colonial rule. Ben Bella wanted to be a mediator between Cuba and the US. He was travelling to see Castro next and JFK sent him with the message that there would be peace if he didn't try to change the status quo in Latin America. Something like Yugoslavia or Poland would be acceptable, but Cuba could not become an offensive outpost for the Soviet military to spread revolution. News of Eisenhower breaking the unwritten rule of never criticizing one's successor was also in the papers. JFK had stated that the previous administration had ignored Latin America and Eisenhower shot back with references to the Berlin Wall and bases in Cuba. Eisenhower was helping the Republican cause in the upcoming elections. Eisenhower had been in Boston and attacked senate candidate, Edward Kennedy.

Bundy informed JFK of the photographic evidence of offensive missiles after 8AM. Their range covered most of the US. JFK felt Khrushchev had lied directly to him. Soviet Ambassador Anatoly Dobrynin had assured him there would be no escalations regarding Berlin and RFK had met with Georgii Bolshakov and heard the same story only a week prior.

JFK's appointments secretary was Kenneth O'Donnell. He was a close friend and confidant. He told JFK, voters didn't care about Cuba. JFK revealed the information about the missiles and joked that Ken Keating would be the next president. JFK's advisory team met at 11:50AM. It consisted of RFK, Bundy, McNamara, Rusk, and others. McCone was at his step-son's funeral and the CIA was represented by Carter. JFK had a secret recording system in his Cabinet Room where the group met. It was to keep track of meetings and most likely to be used for a possible memoir.

The director of the Photographic Center (Arthur Lundahl) and his aide (Sidney Graybeal) made their presentation. Graybeal was a former pilot and missile specialist. He explained there was a chance that the MRBM could be intermediate range missiles if they did not have their nose cones attached during the photography. Intermediate missiles could reach most of the United States. These missiles were not operational, but they did not have all the information they needed to confirm that. JFK approved more U-2 missions.

Rusk was asked for his opinion. He had received the news the night before and came up with two options. Either they attack the sites unannounced or apply pressure to force their removal. Everyone agreed the missiles could not be allowed to stay. The choice was between a military or a diplomatic option.

Rusk favored diplomacy if there was enough time before the missiles were operational. He wanted to tell Castro that the Soviets had put him in danger of invasion. JFK wanted to know how much time he would have before the news leaked. McNamara estimated one week before at least some people in Congress found out. They were not considering the time it would take to make the missiles operational. JFK considered four options from the original two given by Rusk. They could do a surgical strike, a wider strike on all missiles, an all out air attack and naval blockade, or diplomacy. RFK mentioned an invasion as a fifth option. JFK believed Khrushchev saw him as weak after the Vienna summit. If he did not respond aggressively Khrushchev would continue to try and bully him.

JFK did not want to tip off Khrushchev by approaching him about the missiles and did not believe NATO would support an air strike. At the end of the meeting, JFK had narrowed the options to either a surgical strike or a general strike. An invasion would take two weeks to prepare and the president did not believe they had that much time. JFK favored the surgical strike and wanted to plan for it at a later 6PM meeting.

JFK spoke with UN Ambassador Adlai Stevenson about the crisis and the diplomat pushed for a peaceful solution, but JFK was not convinced. He met with General Maxwell Taylor, the chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff. Taylor believed the missiles would alter the strategic balance between the superpowers. McNamara disagreed, as did JFK, who thought the Soviets already had equal capabilities. JFK was still focused on why the Soviets would make such a drastic move. Undersecretary of State Alexis Johnson unwittingly landed on Khrushchev's motivation when he mentioned that the US had put missiles in Turkey five years prior due to their lack of ICBMs.

The State and Defense Departments, and the Joint Chiefs all had different reasons for opposing the strike JFK preferred. Rusk wanted diplomacy, McNamara wasn't sure the strike would be effective, and the military didn't want to alert the USSR before a possible invasion. McNamara discussed how a strike would not be effective if the missiles were operational. The Joint Chiefs pushed for a full invasion.

McNamara proposed a naval blockade only. He also wanted to announce that if Cuba attacked, the US would be prepared to attack the USSR. JFK was skeptical about the effectiveness and the risk of warning Khrushchev. The blockade did not have enough support in the room. McNamara said naval ships would have to fire on Soviet ships if they did not stop to be inspected, but that was risky in international waters. McNamara stated that Cuba was a political problem and a blockade would not make the US look like it was attacking Cuba, but focusing on Soviet action. JFK stated it was a military and political problem since he had previously announced the US would not allow offensive weapons in Cuba. If they allowed them, they would increase the risks of other aggressive actions.

Previously Kennedy had responded to Khrushchev's actions by increasing defensive readiness, but he felt direct action was now required. RFK wanted even more aggressive action. He wanted to stage an attack at Guantanamo and "just get into it and get it over with." The meeting ended with no action decided on. They were split eleven for a blockade and seven for a strike (plus the Kennedys).

JFK left to attend a dinner for Charles Bohlen, who was leaving to be ambassador to France. JFK wanted him to stay to advise on Russia, but Bohlen did not want to raise suspicions. No one was aware that the missiles in question were already operational. A strike might have triggered a nuclear response. JFK decided to weigh his options.

Chapter 12: Quarantine

"You are in a pretty bad fix," he told the president. Kennedy had had enough. He interrupted the general: "What did you say?" LeMay repeated the phrase: "You are in a pretty bad fix." "You are in there with me," Kennedy shot back with a forced laugh. "Personally."

-Exchange between General LeMay and JFK discussing options for Cuba

"Within the past week unmistakable evidence has established the fact that a series of offensive missile sites is now in preparation on that imprisoned island. The purpose of these bases can be none other than to provide a nuclear strike capability against the Western hemisphere.... "I call upon Chairman Khrushchev, to halt and eliminate this clandestine, reckless, and provocative threat to world peace and to stable relations between our two nations."

-JFK address to the nation

JFK and Vice President Lyndon Johnson claimed to have colds which necessitated them returning to Washington. Salinger told the press traveling with the president about the cold, but he had his own doubts. He confronted JFK on Air Force One and was told he would know the truth once they landed. RFK had asked his brother to return to make a final call on what steps to take. At the same time, Sidorov's regiment was finishing their missile construction. The site, which was decorated with a red-and-white pole resembling a Soviet border post and a sign that read "Motherland or death," was capable of firing on Washington and just short of Chicago.

On October 18th, U-2 flights detected what Lundahl believed to be IRBMs which would have twice the range of the MRBMs. Rusk decided to favor JFK's immediate strike idea based on the new report. Rusk also warned about Tuchman's *Guns of August* and stated there might still be a chance to get Khrushchev to back down. JFK believed warning Khrushchev would just lead to a counter warning about Berlin. RFK half-joked that trading Berlin for the missiles would be a good trade. The group worked through the possible scenario of the Soviets taking Berlin. Rusk believed they would have to at least use tactical nuclear weapons in that scenario.

JFK had a prearranged meeting with Soviet Foreign Minister Andrei Gromyko who had been at the UN. McCone counseled the president that a sneak attack by the US would lead to a "Pearl Harbor indictment." He wanted JFK to give the USSR twenty-four hours to dismantle the missiles and associated support material. JFK and Rusk did not mention the missiles to Gromyko. Gromyko focused on Berlin and stated all weapons sent to Cuba were for defensive purposes. He was prepared to say that missiles existed, but JFK never directly asked. JFK wanted to maintain the possibility of a surprise strike. Gromyko felt JFK was stern and Rusk tense, but thought the meeting went well and that any threat to Cuba was fading. While JFK was in the meeting, support for a strike had faded amongst his advisors.

Ambassador Thompson had suggested the blockade earlier in the day. He feared a strike would kill Soviet troops and escalate the situation. We went further to say they should announce the blockade on Sunday and say they would be surveilling Cuba until all weapons were removed. JFK weighed his options and decided to continue on with his regular campaigning to avoid suspicions.

On Friday, JFK met with the Joint Chiefs. Only General Taylor was part of the advisory group. The Chiefs had been pushing for an invasion of Cuba since the Bay of Pigs. They welcomed the missiles in Cuba as a justification for the invasion. JFK explained his fears that a blockade of Cuba would lead to one on Berlin and then a nuclear war. The Chiefs were now pushing for a general air attack. General

Curtis LeMay was the main proponent and was the Air Force Chief of staff. He had been the head of the Strategic Air Command. He claimed the Soviets would not do anything about Berlin if they made an air assault on Cuba. He compared the blockade to the failed strategy of appeasement leading to WWII that had been linked to Joseph Kennedy while Ambassador to the UK.

JFK had left his brother in charge of the debate over a blockade in the advisory group. He was a hawk on Cuba and opposed the blockade. He tried to push his beliefs aside and act as the president's representative. He slowly came around to support a blockade despite wanting to remove Castro. He reviewed a speech by Ted Sorenson for JFK to announce the action.

The CIA presented information on Saturday that the MRBMs were operational. The Chiefs and Bundy still favored a strike, but everyone else was for the blockade, though for differing reasons. McNamara supported trading missiles in Turkey or Italy for those in Cuba. He also mentioned Guantánamo could be a bargaining chip. RFK wanted to threaten Khrushchev with the possibility of the US giving nuclear weapons to the FRG.

JFK had been swayed by the operational nature of the missiles. A strike now had the chance of triggering a nuclear response. There would be no negotiations. JFK wanted to announce the blockade and prepare for a strike if the missiles were not dismantled. JFK called Eisenhower to inform him. Eisenhower supported the move, but felt an invasion would be needed. He did not believe the Soviets would respond in Berlin.

JFK informed Congressional leadership of the plan on Monday afternoon and at 7PM he made a televised address to the nation. He announced a quarantine of Cuba which he distinguished from the Berlin blockade of 1948.

Part IV: Moment of Truth

Chapter 13: Moscow Night

"That's it. Lenin's work has been destroyed,"

-Khrushchev upon hearing of the US's discovery of missiles in Cuba

News of a crisis began leaking over the weekend. JFK asked publishers not to print any news on a possible situation in Cuba. They did not use their confidential sources, but information that was publicly available was reported on. *Pravda* began reporting on JFK's planned announcement and other rumors about troop activity the next day in Moscow. Khrushchev knew the speech was most likely about the discovery of the missiles. He called the Presidium to meet. The meeting was supposed to deal with possible next steps regarding Cuba and Berlin, but Berlin was never mentioned. Malinovsky urged caution. He called JFK's speech an election stunt. General Ivanov of the Defense Council reported that three of the four R-12 regiments were ready along with the tactical nuclear weapons. Khrushchev also wanted caution, but admitted to being surprised by the announcement. He stated that the situation could easily escalate to a general war, but did not put the missiles on high alert. Khrushchev believed an invasion was likely, but a blockade was also possible. Two scenarios were discussed; the Soviets could claim an attack on Cuba was an attack on them or they could say it was entirely a US-Cuban affair.

Mikoyan spoke out against the latter possibility. He knew the US would fully attack Cuba if it was said they were in control of nuclear weapons. A mutual defensive announcement was also tabled. They decided to put Soviet troops in Cuba on alert. A draft message to Pliev stated that all weapons should be readied, but Khrushchev realized that included nuclear missiles and changed it. Luna tactical weapons

were authorized to be used to defend against an invasion. They held the message until after the president's speech. They still did not want to allow the use of strategic missiles. Everyone was panicked by the situation.

Soviet Ambassador to the US, Anatoly Dobrynin, was summoned to meet with Rusk just before JFK's national address. Rusk gave him the text of the speech and a letter for Khrushchev demanding removal of the missiles. Dobrynin had not known about the missiles. Khrushchev had received the speech around the same time from his foreign office. He was joyful that there was a blockade planned instead of an invasion. Khrushchev went to sleep without undressing so he could be ready for any unexpected developments. They messaged Pliev to be combat ready, but did not send the authorization to use tactical nuclear weapons.

All Soviet ships with weapons were ordered to turn around to avoid running into the US Navy. The nuclear warheads (carried by the *Aleksandrovsk*) and nuclear subs were ordered to continue to Cuba. Mikoyan wanted the subs to avoid Cuba so that the US would not react to them, but Malinovsky convinced the Presidium to order them on to Cuba.

A letter from Khrushchev to Castro was discussed. They would stop the weapons headed there, but not remove the missiles in place. His letter to Kennedy stated that the blockade should not be implemented to avoid an escalation of the situation. The Presidium met for twelve hours on October 23rd before adjoining. Khrushchev had initially thought military action would be necessary, but now believed the use of nuclear weapons could be avoided.

Chapter 14: Blinking in the Dark

"It looks like hell—looks real mean. Doesn't it? But on the other hand, there is no other choice. If they get this mean on this one, it's just a question of where they go about it next. No choice. I do not think there was a choice."

-JFK to his brother on October 23, 1962

"They somehow seemed to tumble into war...through stupidity, individual idiosyncrasies, misunderstandings, and personal complexes of inferiority and grandeur."
-JFK referring to the lead up to WWI

"We are eyeball to eyeball, and I think the other fellow just blinked,"
-Rusk to Bundy upon hearing Soviet ships to Cuba had stopped

RFK visited Dobrynin late on October 23rd. He was frustrated that the ambassador had been unaware of the missiles in Cuba. He was also upset that Khrushchev had lied about not making any aggressive moves before the elections. Dobrynin claimed that he still did not know of any missiles in Cuba. He also said Khrushchev valued his ability to communicate with JFK. RFK asked what orders were given to Soviet captains pertaining to the blockade. Dobrynin was not aware of any new orders and assumed they would stay on course and not obey what they saw as an unlawful blockade. RFK insisted they would be stopped, and Dobrynin replied that would be an act of war.

On October 23rd, JFK was dealing with implementing a blockade while not triggering a larger incident. He officially named his advisory group, the Executive Committee of the National Security Council (ExCom). The group was relieved that there hadn't been a severe reaction by the Soviets as of

yet. McCone reported that they were not sure where the previously detected missiles had been moved to due to heavy camouflage. The group began discussing reactions if there was a strike by the Soviets from Cuba or in Berlin. They agreed that if a U-2 was shot down, the retaliation would be limited to the SAM site responsible. JFK made Lucius Clay, in West Berlin, aware of the situation. The Organization of the American States (OAS) had endorsed the blockade. JFK decided that ships headed to Cuba should be stopped, but not those that turned around. RFK wanted to search all the ships to find evidence of offensive weapons and gain knowledge by examining them. They also debated how far out they should stop ships. RFK argued for 1,800 miles, but McNamara wanted to wait. Rusk was against stopping ships that had turned around. JFK decided to wait until the next day.

Rusk and Thompson made a draft for JFK to send to Khrushchev warning Soviet ships to avoid the quarantine line. They had included a line stating that the US had no desire to fire on Soviet vessels, but JFK took it out. JFK argued to ExCom that if a ship did not stop, a battle could result. Later, the Kennedys discussed Khrushchev's actions. They agreed that JFK would have been impeached if he had not reacted to the missiles. RFK suggested establishing a backchannel, perhaps through Bolshakov. He also discussed using OAS representatives to inspect Soviet ships. JFK then met with RFK, Sorensen, and O'Donnell. JFK, again, alluded to *The Guns of August* according to RFK's recollection. RFK went to see Dobrynin to help avoid possible misunderstandings.

Khrushchev did not want to look weak by allowing the US to search Soviet ships. He also wanted to avoid a confrontation by resisting the searches. He decided to push the ships through to Cuba before the blockade was in place. Five ships were already through the Strait of Gibraltar and one their way to Cuba. A US plane flew over the *Divnogorsk* seven times on October 22nd. It arrived on October 23rd in Cuba. *Aleksandrovsk* and its nuclear warheads for the IRBMs were behind schedule. It changed its destination to a closer Cuban port. The blockade would be in effect as of 14:00 hours GST on October 24th.

The blockade began at 10AM EST as ExCom met again. McCone knew the messages had been sent to all the Soviet ships in the Atlantic. The quarantine line of 500 nautical miles from Cuba had been decided by JFK, the night before in consultation with the UK ambassador, David Ormsby-Gore. McNamara focused the group's attention on the *Gagarin* which had declared its cargo to be technical equipment and its destination as Conakry. He believed it was headed to Cuba and most likely was accompanied by Soviet subs. It was, in fact, carrying R-14 missiles to Cuba. It had been ordered to stop near the Bahamas by a US ship on the 22nd, but continued. The *Kimovsk* was also suspected of carrying missiles. It had already brought weapons to Cuba and was headed back with R-14 missiles. Admiral George Whelan Anderson Jr. was the chief of naval operations. He planned to intercept both ships. As McNamara and JFK discussed the logistics of the operation McCone interrupted that he had news that all six Soviet ships in Cuban waters had stopped or reversed. The group was unsure if the note was in reference to ships leaving or arriving in Cuban waters. McCone sought clarification as ExCom discussed how submarines could be made to surface with practice depth charges. JFK did not want a sub to be the first encounter, but McNamara asserted it was necessary for the safety of US naval vessels. JFK gave in. It was at that moment that his brother believed he was most concerned about events spiraling out of his control. As the group played out responses to sinking a soviet vessel, McCone reentered to clarify the incoming ships had stopped.

The group quickly agreed the Navy had to be informed that they should not pursue any ships that had stopped or changed course. The council was relieved. That tense moment was almost like the failure of European leaders to avoid WWI. JFK was having to make tough calls on outdated intel. When

McNamara talked about targeting the *Kimovsk*, it was already on its way back to the USSR. The *Gagarin* had headed back early on October 23rd. That evening, a US plane dropped explosive charges in front of it. Another plane overflew the vessel six times. Three more planes buzzed the ship. They continued flyovers until 1:40AM. The captain, Kim Holubenko, allegedly used a fire hose to chase away the US planes. He later received the golden star of Hero of Socialist Labor.

Chapter 15: Wooden Knife

"We'll all meet in hell."

-Khrushchev to William Knox

"You cannot fail to remember that both Hitler and Napoleon used such language in their day when speaking with small countries...Do you really think even now that the USA is made of one dough and countries that you threaten another?"

-Khrushchev in a personal letter to JFK

"I ask you to recognize clearly, Mr. Chairman, that it was not I who issued the first challenge in this case, and that in the light of this record, these activities in Cuba required the responses I have announced."

-JFK telegram to Khrushchev on October 25, 1962

"Fighting is not to our advantage: the future does not depend on Cuba but on our country—that's for sure."

-Khrushchev explaining his reversal to the Presidium

"All right, sir, let me ask you one simple question: Do you, Ambassador Zorin, deny that the U.S.S.R. has placed and is placing medium- and intermediate-range missiles and sites in Cuba? Yes or no—don't wait for the translation—yes or no?"

"You can answer yes or no. You have denied they exist. I want to know if I understood you correctly. I am prepared to wait for my answer until hell freezes over,"

-Stevenson at the UN

Romanian leader, Gheorghe Gherorghiu-Dej was visiting Moscow on October 23rd when Khrushchev received word that the blockade was about to be implemented. Khrushchev threatened to "nuke" the White House in front of the Romanian leadership. Khrushchev had the group attend the Bolshoi Theater to display a public aura of calm in the Kremlin. Khrushchev continued to act tough in front of the Romanians. They had distanced themselves from the USSR since Khrushchev took over and removed troops from their country. They also had not sided with him in the split with China. Fear and confusion were the reality behind Khrushchev's aggressive public front. Gheorghiu-Dej saw another outburst the morning before he left Moscow. Khrushchev threatened to "crush that viper," when he heard of JFK continuing with the blockade.

Khrushchev later met with Westinghouse President William Knox. He had been on business in the USSR when he was suddenly asked to the Kremlin. Khrushchev surprisingly admitted to Knox that Cuba had Soviet nuclear missiles. He stated that he didn't want war, but would use the missiles if the US attacked Cuba. He also said he was willing to meet with JFK and that the crisis was threatening their

agreement on a nuclear test ban. He made a joke comparing nearby nuclear missiles being something they both would have to live with like a farmer and the smell of his goat.

Khrushchev had replied to JFK's letter by stating that a blockade was illegal and he would not have his ships turn around. He felt emboldened by the news that nuclear warheads aboard the *Aleksandrovsk* had reached Cuba. Khrushchev wanted to send a personal letter to JFK through Bolshakov. The same conduit that JFK was so angry about giving him the false information. He had told the president that weapons in Cuba were all of a defensive nature and nothing would be done before the elections. Khrushchev's personal letter also claimed the weapons were not offensive and stated they were under his direct control. He suggested the nuclear weapons could be removed and sunk in the Caribbean if the US did the same with their weapons. He held the letter to send until the next day.

Based on JFK's refusal to delay the blockade, Khrushchev believed military action was imminent and that included attacks on the USSR. He knew SAC had moved to Defense Readiness Condition (DEFCON) level 2. The highest level of alert in their history. General Thomas Power was the SAC commander and told troops he felt they were prepared for any emergency. Khrushchev was made aware that SAC bombers were repeatedly flying patterns near the Soviet bloc. In response, Khrushchev rushed to cancel his personal telegram to JFK and called the Presidium together.

Khrushchev was ready to alter his course, but presented the move as a victory for the Soviets. He wanted a promise from the US not to invade Cuba in exchange for removing the strategic nuclear missiles. Khrushchev argued that the USSR could still attack the US with the missiles it had within their own country. They had gotten the world's attention on Cuba and now it was time to make sure war did not ensue. The decision received support and the group moved on to the next order of business: how to deal with Castro. Khrushchev suggested telling him that the removal may be temporary. Khrushchev had Pliev ship the recently arrived warheads back to the USSR. If there was an emergency the *Aleksandrovsk* and its cargo would be sunk.

On October 25th, the Soviet Ambassador to the UN, Valerian Zorin, tried to claim there were no missiles in Cuba and the US was lying to the world. He claimed the CIA had provided falsified evidence. Ambassador Stevenson replied assertively and confronted Zorin about the missiles with photographic evidence. JFK watched and was impressed by the televised performance. Zorin had not been informed about the weapons by his government. It also appears Khrushchev was not informed about the UN debacle.

Chapter 16: The Americans are Coming!

"We, for our part, will declare that our ships, bound for Cuba, will not carry any kind of armaments. You would declare that the United States will not invade Cuba with its forces and will not support any sort of forces which might intend to carry out an invasion of Cuba. Then the necessity for the presence of our military specialists in Cuba would disappear."

-Khrushchev letter to JFK on October 26, 1962

"However difficult and horrifying this decision may be, there is, I believe, no other recourse,"

-Castro suggesting that the USSR consider a preemptive nuclear strike against the US

“You say that this disturbs you because it is 90 miles by sea from the coast of the United States of America. But Turkey adjoins us; our sentries patrol back and forth and see each other. Do you consider, then, that you have the right to demand security for your own country and the removal of the weapons you call offensive, but do not accord the same right to us? You have placed destructive missile weapons, which you call offensive, in Turkey, literally next to us. How then can recognition of our equal military capacities be reconciled with such unequal relations between our great states? This is irreconcilable.”
-Khrushchev in letter to JFK

Khrushchev received information on October 26th that the US was preparing for an invasion of Cuba. Dobrynin sent word that reporters in Washington were sharing leaks about an invasion beginning within twenty-four hours. Khrushchev's new letter, with an offer to remove the missiles in exchange for a pledge not to invade Cuba, was delivered to the US Embassy in Moscow. Its 2,748 words took until 9:15 to transmit and deliver to the White House. He did not fully admit to the presence of nuclear missiles in the letter. It was the beginning of a negotiation and an attempt to halt escalations.

Fidel Castro had been trying to reassure his people since JFK's address on October 22nd. Castro gave an interview the next day saying he would not allow inspections of Cuba and stated all weapons were defensive in nature. Castro was worried that news of a possible ultimatum from JFK to UN secretary general U Thant about removing the missiles was a prelude to an invasion. Castro and his government were unsettled by the UN debate between the US and USSR on October 24th and on the 26th Cuban diplomats believed they saw signs of a US invasion coming immediately. Castro sent a letter to U Thant attacking the US's constant flyovers of Cuba. He ordered anti-aircraft stations to begin shooting down US planes.

Castro met with Pliev and wanted the Soviets to declare the weapons were in Cuba under Soviet control. Castro felt his pleas were not being attended to. President João Goulart of Brazil told Castro that the US would attack in forty-eight hours if the missiles were not dismantled. Castro met with Alekseev who telegraphed Moscow that a letter for Khrushchev was being prepared, but that it was vitally urgent since Castro believed an invasion was coming soon. In his letter, Castro asked Khrushchev to be the first to use nuclear weapons because he believed the US would eventually use them anyway. Khrushchev reacted in an extremely unfavorable manner towards the letter.

Pliev sent a letter to Khrushchev that he was planning on shooting down over-flying US aircraft. The Presidium approved of his position, but warned against any escalation of a nuclear variety. He was prohibited from using any nuclear weapons, including tactical ones. He was also told to stop construction of any launch sites because it was “aggravating the United Nations”

Khrushchev did not believe a US attack was coming. He saw the lack of an invasion as a possible weakness and decided to seek concessions from the US in Turkey and perhaps Pakistan, which was a U-2 base for the US. The final proposal focused only on Turkey. Mikoyan stated that an article by Walter Lippmann in the *Washington Post* gave Khrushchev the idea of a missile swap. Khrushchev had not received a reply to his previous letter and decided this new letter would replace it and serve as a response to U Thant's proposal. The UN head had asked that the US lift the blockade if the Soviets promised not to send weapons to Cuba. Khrushchev did not openly admit to the nuclear missiles, but he linked them to the US missiles in Turkey. He proposed a swap of the missiles and mirror pledges of each superpower respecting the independence of neighboring countries. He linked the proposal to approval of a test-ban treaty. To speed up the process and avoid a response to the first letter before JFK received the new letter,

the Presidium decided to broadcast the letter. It was received in the US on October 27th. JFK now had two letters in two days to deal with.

Part V: Black Saturday

Chapter 17: Turkish Quagmire

JFK received word of Khrushchev's missile swap proposal while meeting with ExCom at 10AM on Saturday, October 27th. The group was in disbelief until JFK realized the reports were about a second letter they had not seen yet. JFK had been considering such a swap since the beginning of the crisis. The US Ambassador to Turkey, Raymond Hare, had reported that such an idea did not sit well with the Turkish allies. The Undersecretary of Defense, Paul Nitze, suggested putting the possibility of removing the Jupiter missiles to Khrushchev, but saying it would have to be after Cuba was settled. Bundy suggested only responding to the first letter, but JFK wanted to wait to ensure accuracy of the second letter.

Rusk had brought up Turkey at the first meeting about Cuba on October 16th. The missiles were a first generation medium range missile designed by former German missile designer Wernher von Braun. They had been rejected by the independent-minded French President de Gaulle, but accepted by Turkey and Italy in 1959. In 1961, Senator Albert Gore Sr. thought the missiles were provocative and compared them to Soviet missiles in Cuba. They were operational by the end of 1961.

JFK had started the crisis with no sympathy for the Soviet's perception of the missiles in Turkey. Soon he began to see the connection between them and Cuba. Rusk had proposed the UN take control of any missiles outside the borders of a nuclear power. JFK stated he would rather swap them out completely. JFK considered the weapons worthless since they took fifteen to twenty minutes to be launch-ready. They were likely to be destroyed by a Soviet strike before they could be used in any open conflict. He thought they created an excuse for a first strike rather than deter it. JFK wanted Nitze to look at how to remove the missiles. Nitze worried about the perception of NATO allies that the US was pulling back its nuclear protection.

The possibilities of a swap had leaked to the press in the interim and Walter Lippmann (who is credited by some for coining the term "Cold War") proposed the idea publicly in his column "Today and Tomorrow." JFK became focused on the swap after the second letter from Khrushchev. It helped him remove the existing missiles in Cuba which the blockade did not. Aides to the president did not support the swap, but JFK pushed forward after the second letter's contents were confirmed. Rusk and members of the State Department were afraid of the impacts on Turkey of even mentioning removing the missiles. Bundy again suggested only responding to the first letter. Most in ExCom were against the swap due to it showing weakness to NATO allies. JFK finally agreed to at least figure out which Soviet offer was valid.

JFK met with the state governors about preparing for a possible nuclear war. RFK and the Joint Chiefs still favored an airstrike followed by an invasion. It was recommended to begin the next day. The White House released a statement saying that negotiations were focused on the Western Hemisphere and could only begin when launch site construction was stopped. JFK was more closely aligned in thinking to Khrushchev at this point, but the political situation didn't allow for an easy solution. The public nature of Khrushchev's proposal had basically made it poisoned fruit.

Chapter 18: Losing Control

“This means war with the Soviet Union.”

-McNamara upon learning of a wayward U-2 on October 27, 1962

“How do we interpret this?” responded McNamara. “I do not know how to interpret it.”

-McNamara upon learning of a U-2 being shot down over Cuba

While at DEFCON 2, SAC had around seventy-two nuclear bombers in the air as part of Operation Chrome Dome. KC-135 Stratotankers refueled them in the air. LeMay suggested to a meeting of the Joint Chiefs that a draft plan of a Cuban invasion be recommended to the president on October 27th. This included OPLAN 312-62 for a series of airstrikes and OPLAN 316-61 for an invasion five days later. McNamara agreed with the strike plan, but wanted to wait until the missile swap issue was sorted out. The military wanted to strike Sunday or Monday, but agreed to wait and state they were in favor of one if missile construction continued.

During the meeting, McNamara was informed that a U-2 had gotten lost over the North Pole and accidentally crossed into the USSR. JFK was informed that Soviet fighters were pursuing the U-2 and US planes were scrambled to protect it. The president worried the mistake would be interpreted as preparation for war. JFK remembered the U-2 debacle caused in 1960 when Gary Powers was shot down over the USSR. Captain Charles Maultsby was not trying to enter Soviet airspace as Powers had. He was part of Project Star Dust to take air samples for detecting nuclear activity by the Soviets. The conditions over the pole required star chart navigation and after leaving Alaska on his mission, Maultsby was confused by the blur caused by the aurora borealis. Maultsby tried to return and received conflicting instructions from a rescue pilot and what turned out to be a Soviet controller. He was 1,000 miles off course. SAC intercepted the Soviets messages when they spotted the U-2, but could not use the information without exposing the fact that they had access to their secret communications.

Soviet MiGs were chasing the U-2, but they could not reach its altitude. Convair F-102 Delta Daggers were scrambled to protect the U-2. Due to DEFCON 2 preparations, they only carried nuclear warheads to defend themselves. The MiGs and the U-2 were short on fuel. The fighters turned back to Soviet airspace and Maultsby had to glide his aircraft back as he was guided by the F-102 pilots.

JFK did not want to make any announcement about the U-2 snafu if possible. He focused on possible missile negotiations. He favored replying to Khrushchev that discussions could begin when missile construction in Cuba stopped. He wanted ExCom to give him options of removing the missiles in Turkey either through the Turks or NATO. The group was still opposed to a swap and RFK invited JFK to attend to other issues while the group dealt with a response to Khrushchev. Unlike the Soviets, that were ostensibly equals on the Presidium, ExCom was composed of advisors to the president. Ironically, they had much more leeway in their ability to discuss openly with the president than the Soviets did with Khrushchev.

Installations in Cuba had begun firing at US reconnaissance planes. McNamara believed retaliation would be necessary soon. JFK favored a general retaliation that included Soviet positions. He wanted to decide the next day, but a U-2 was shot down. The pilot (Major Rudolf Andereson) appeared to have been killed by a Soviet SAM site. Upon the news, Admiral Charles Griffin ordered Plan 312 (Shoe Black) be updated to plan for retaliation. JFK and his advisors were left wondering how to respond to what seemed like a major escalation.

Chapter 19: Target Destroyed

US Navy Vought F-8 Crusaders were flying over Cuba on a regular basis on October 27th. It was part of Operation Blue Moon to photograph the island. These planes provided Stevenson's evidence at the UN. On October 27th, Cuba began firing at the planes. The planes could also be bombers and the constant flights unnerved the Soviets and Cubans who were expecting an attack at any moment. Pliev met with Castro and Chief of Staff General Pavel Akindinov to discuss what sites the US was aware of. They believed Statsenko's missiles had been discovered and they sent word to Moscow that they were prepared to use all their anti-aircraft resources to repel a US attack. The missile sites received a coded message that war would begin at dawn on the 28th.

Statsenko was still trying to meet a November 1st deadline to have two regiments of R-12s ready. The R-14s were set for a later date with most of their equipment still on the way when the blockade was announced. Colonel Dmitrii Yazov (later the Minister of Defense) was stationed in an area that had poisonous plants and bacteria that spread to the canned food. Aleksandr Voropaev was in an infantry unit that almost revolted due to the humid conditions and spoiled food. Worms appeared in the canned meat and it reminded them of the famous revolt on the battleship *Potemkin*. Dysentery spread quickly.

On October 26th, the warheads were delivered to Sidorov and by the next day his positions were ready to fire. On October 27th, Pliev changed orders to only fire if fired upon. Anderson's U-2 flew over Cuba for over an hour taking pictures. He was tracked and the anti-aircraft sites requested permission to engage. Major Serovoi called General Stepan Grechko of Pliev's staff for permission. They believed the U-2 was supplying information for a future bombing raid. Pliev was resting due to his kidney disease. After a prolonged debate Grechko gave permission to shoot it down. He had direct connections to Khrushchev. In Moscow, he was under the direct command of General Pavel Batisky. Batisky had shot Lavrentii Beria in 1953, cementing Khrushchev's ascension to the leadership of the USSR. Lieutenant Riapenko fired the missile that shot down the U-2. Radio Havana reported the news and Cuban troops were excited. Pliev realized that his worn out troops were no longer responding directly to his orders. He and his fellow officers assumed a retaliation was coming.

Chapter 20: Secret Rendezvous

JFK: "The way you're eating up all that chicken and drinking up all my wine, anybody would think it was your last meal."

Powers: "The way Bobby's been talking, I thought it was my last meal."

The downing of the U-2 flight impacted the discussions by ExCom. General Taylor stated that they needed to destroy the site that had shot down the plane and if more fighting commences, they would make a general strike against the island. With the onset of the evening, the strike would have to wait until the next day. The group was still discussing Turkey. McNamara agreed with removing the US missiles, but for different reasons. He knew if an invasion occurred the missiles would be "sitting ducks." He wanted them removed in a prelude to a Cuban invasion. While JFK was at appointments, the group was preparing multiple responses to Khrushchev. While they worked, LeMay and the Chiefs of Staff informed them that a strike on the SAM site was not possible because of the risk that the nuclear missiles at other sites were operational. They called for an all-out strike to get all possible missiles.

RFK briefed his brother on the ExCom debates. JFK insisted on giving the Soviets every chance to make a peaceful withdrawal from Cuba that wouldn't embarrass them. JFK still supported a missile swap,

but approved a letter to Khrushchev that did not mention a trade-off. The letter wanted the missiles removed via the UN in order to lift the blockade. There was originally a mention of the Turkey missiles being under NATO control, but that was left out. The US would also promise not to invade if the conditions were met. JFK also wanted RFK to go to Anatoly Dobrynin to negotiate the missile swap in secret. He informed select members of ExCom about the strategy (LBJ was not included). Rusk suggested that RFK mention there could be no public quid pro quo, but it could be agreed to eventually. Raymond Hare, the US Ambassador to Turkey, had come up with the idea. They all agreed to the plan and to keep it secret which meant that neither the CIA or Joint Chiefs would know.

Rusk later said the secret deal was not just his idea. He stated that since the missiles were scheduled to be removed anyway it should not be a limiting factor in a Cuban solution. He intimated that RFK was actually responsible for the deal. Most did not believe that the deal would happen since it was with a known adversary.

RFK met Dobrynin at the Department of Justice. He informed him of what the US knew about the situation in Cuba and that the death of the U-2 pilot was forcing JFK's hand on a military response. Dobrynin had no specific instructions and was still operating without full knowledge of Khrushchev's letters. RFK noted that any unilateral action on the missiles would be detrimental to NATO and so could not be publicly agreed to. RFK made sure to communicate that secrecy was essential to any deal and that he must know a response within a day to forestall a military response. RFK left no records of any direct talks about a swap.

JFK had already had his family and those of his staff evacuated out of Washington in case of an attack. RFK met with the president and his special assistant David Powers to discuss his meeting with Dobrynin. Powers was responsible for observing ExCom meetings and discussing the president's performance. None of them were optimistic about the chances of avoiding a conflict. JFK had a back up plan to use U Thant to propose the swap if Khrushchev did not respond. That night, Powers, JFK, and his mistress, Mimi Alford, watched *Roman Holiday* at the White House. That same night, the military gave instructions that no nuclear weapons would be used for the Cuban attack they were planning. The instructions also stated that if "Sino/Soviet Cuban attacks nuclear weapons can be used," without clarifying how to tell Cuban troops from Sino/Soviet ones.

Chapter 21: Bermuda Triangle

Late on October 27th, The *USS Cony* found a Soviet sub in the Bermuda Triangle. The Foxtrot/Korabl X sub had to surface to recharge its batteries. A Navy P2V from the *USS Randolph* dropped incendiaries around the sub to activate its cameras and made the sub think it was under attack. It came around to point nuclear armed torpedoes at the *Cony*. The signalman on the *Cony*, Gary Slaughter, apologized to the sub. The sub captain was Valentin Savitsky. The commander of the sub group it was leading was Vasilii Arkhipov. Arkhipov had previously commanded a Hotel class nuclear sub *K-19* that nearly had its reactor meltdown. Several of the crew died and there was nearly a mutiny. The movie *K-19: The Widowmaker* would be based on the event. The Foxtrot subs were originally part of a flotilla that would establish a naval base in Cuba. The USSR decided the move would be too aggressive and just sent the four Foxtrot subs.

The subs were not designed for long voyages nor tropical climates. They could submerge for up to ten days, but not move very fast if they stayed under. The sub captains did not know where they were headed until they passed through the Greenland-Iceland-United Kingdom Gap. The addition of nuclear

torpedoes was also news to the commanders. They were not told what they were for or when they would be needed. They left their base near Murmansk on October 1st. Valentin Savitsky was made commander of sub B-59 and the group. They found out the nuclear torpedoes were to be used if the sub was breached or on direct orders from Moscow. Arkhipov and Savitsky were supposed to travel undetected, but they could not maintain their speed without surfacing so they chose to run the diesel engines at night while recharging batteries. They were aided in avoiding detection by storms in the Sargasso Sea. On October 10th, the day before missiles were discovered in Cuba, the US Navy tanker *Yukon* saw a sub surface.

On October 15th, the subs were ordered to turn from Cuba and move back to the Sargasso. Mikoyan had convinced Khrushchev of the change to avoid a possible naval clash with the US in Cuban waters where the subs would be easily detected. His plan was voted down repeatedly by the Presidium until the head of the Soviet Navy backed the idea.

ExCom discussed the sub situation on October 24th. US ships inspecting Soviet cargo would be susceptible to sub attack so the US sent procedures for signaling the subs to surface. JFK was concerned about a confrontation with a sub rather than with the cargo ships the blockade was focused on. From October 22nd-26th, the US Navy tracked the subs and planned to harass them away from the area if an inspection needed to occur. On the 25th, *B-59* was spotted and for two days they tried to avoid the US. On the 27th, three US destroyers began tracking *B-59*. The practice depth charges were hard to distinguish from a real attack. The crew began passing out from the heat and dangerous CO₂ levels. Savitsky ordered the nuclear torpedoes be used, but calmed down after discussing it with Arkhipov. Arkhipov has been lauded as possibly avoiding a nuclear war. The sub readied the torpedoes before deciding to surface. This is when they were spotted by Gary Slaughter aboard the *Cony*.

Vice President Johnson had raised concerns with ExCom about flares being misinterpreted. The situation on *B-59* was defused when Arkhipov could not go below decks due to the Soviet signal officer getting his equipment stuck. That allowed him to see Slaughter's apology signal. The nuclear torpedoes in the *B-59* were designed to create massive shockwaves that would have destroyed or seriously damaged all the ships in the area. JFK had stated in his national address that a nuclear attack would require nuclear retaliation by the US against the USSR.

Part VI: Rising from the Dead

Chapter 22: Sunday Scare

"I respect and trust your statement, set forth in your message of October 27, 1962, that there will be no attack on Cuba; that there will be no invasion not only on the part of the United States but also on the part of other countries of the Western Hemisphere, as stated in your message,...In that case, the motives that prompted us to provide such assistance to Cuba become invalid. We have therefore instructed our officers (and those resources, as I have already informed you, are in the hands of Soviet officers) to take appropriate measures to stop building the aforementioned installations, to dismantle them, and return them to the Soviet Union."

-Khrushchev in his letter accepting JFK's proposal

October 28, 1962 was a Sunday. The day was named for resurrection in Russia and the Soviet Union had tried to rename it, but brought it back before WWII. It was the only rest day for Soviet workers at the time. *Pravda* was the only major paper that had a Sunday issue. Its issue led with Khrushchev's

offer of a missile swap to JFK. Bertrand Russell put the blame on JFK if he did not accept. These reports were already old as the downing of a U-2 in Cuba had already taken place.

Marshal Malinovsky reported the situation to Khrushchev and tried to hide blame from specific officers who had disobeyed the orders from Moscow to not attack. Khrushchev realized he was losing control of the situation on the ground and began to paint a picture of Castro being responsible.

Khrushchev was more focused on the opportunity of JFK's new letter promising not to invade Cuba in exchange for the Soviets removing their missiles. The removal was to be conducted under UN supervision. This had come from a meeting between ABC correspondent Jon Scali and the KGB chief in Washington, Aleksandr Feklisov. Feklisov had added the additional point without authorization, but it was now part of the deal.

Khrushchev met with the Presidium at a former Romanov estate in Novo-Ogarevo. It would later be the site of a meeting between President George Bush and Mikhail Gorbachev in 1991 and a home for Vladimir Putin. The meeting included Central Committee secretary Frol Kozlov; the head of the Soviet parliament, Leonid Brezhnev; Minister of Defense Malinovsky; secretary of the Defense Council, General Ivanov; Minister of Foreign Affairs Gromyko; chairman of the KGB, Aleksandr Shelepin; and Cuba specialist, Anastas Mikoyan.

This meeting was unlike ExCom since these members had the power to remove Khrushchev (which they did in 1964). However, he was not seeking their advice, but merely to inform them and get them to back his plans. He had to convince them to support his decision to retreat from demanding the US withdraw missiles from Turkey. He compared the tactic to Lenin's withdrawal from WWI. Gromyko and Mikoyan expressed approval and the rest stayed silent.

During the meeting, a message came in about RFK's meeting with Dobrynin. The missiles could be traded, but time was running out. Khrushchev would later frame the situation as him helping JFK out of the confrontation. At the time, it was seen as an ultimatum, but one that Khrushchev was glad to accept. They received word that JFK was going to make another address on television. They sent word to Dobrynin that the USSR would accept the RFK deal. They stated that a radio message would confirm the deal. Khrushchev's eventual letter was over 1,500 words despite RFK asking for a short and quick response. He included mentions of the US violating Cuban airspace with U-2s that were making the situation more dangerous. A secret message confirming the acceptance of the delayed Turkey missile swap was also sent. Khrushchev then communicated his actions to Pliev, U Thant, and Castro.

Castro had sent a message to Khrushchev that was received immediately after his letter to JFK was sent. Castro claimed that the US was going to attack within hours and wanted to use the missiles to strike the US first. Khrushchev sent a quick and short reply that told Castro not to provoke matters since an end was in sight that would keep him safe from invasion. U Thant was basically told he could inspect the dismantling process when he visited Cuba. Pliev was also told to let U Thant inspect the sites. Pliev was also informed of the displeasure over the downing of the U-2. He was ordered to dismantle the missiles and not to fire or scramble fighters to intercept any attempts by the US to fly-over Cuba.

Khrushchev's message to JFK was broadcast over radio to make sure it reached the US in time. Kennedy had never planned to make another speech to the US. The USSR spies had mistaken information about a rebroadcast of his original speech. They had not understood how improbable it would have been for the US president to schedule a national speech for 9AM on a Sunday.

Chapter 23: Winners and Losers

"...most of us should go to church and pray that we have not misunderstood and that we have correctly read what the Soviets are preparing to do, because there could be a very long tomorrow."

-JFK to John Scali

"I think that you and I, with our heavy responsibilities for the maintenance of peace, were aware that developments were approaching a point where events could have become unmanageable,"

-JFK to Khrushchev

"This clash (and we were truly on the verge of war) demonstrated that war today is not inevitably destined by fate, that it can be avoided. The Chinese claim was therefore once again refuted, as well as their assessments of the current era, the current balance of forces. Imperialism, as can be seen, is no paper tiger; it is a tiger that can give you a nice bite in the backside."

-Khrushchev to the Czech delegation to Moscow

John McCone was at Mass when Khrushchev's address was reported in the US. JFK was leaving Mass when Bundy found him and gave a summary of the message. McNamara was at the Pentagon meeting with the Joint Chiefs. LeMay still wanted to invade on Monday. Eventually the generals agreed an invasion was not needed.

At the White House, JFK downplayed his staff's congratulations. They claimed he had new clout that could be used to handle situations like the Sino-Indian War. ExCom met again to cancel overflights in Cuba to avoid possible problems. They discussed the US acting on the UN's behalf to monitor the missile dismantling. JFK decided to use his momentum against Khrushchev and call for the IL-28 Soviet bombers to be removed from Cuba as well. JFK sent a confirmation letter to Khrushchev and raised the issue of continuing disarmament talks in the future.

RFK met with Dobrynin at 11AM on Sunday. Dobrynin was behind in his intel from Moscow and was planning to share the news that Khrushchev would be receptive to RFK's offer from the day before. Dobrynin explained the situation to RFK, basically confirming what was already being said in the news. RFK reminded Dobrynin to keep the Turkey deal secret and told him that Pierre Salinger was not aware of the plan.

JFK called Eisenhower, Hoover, and Truman to tell them of the end of the crisis. He did not mention the Turkey deal to them. Khrushchev wanted JFK to confirm the deal with him in writing. RFK met with Dobrynin again to confirm the deal, but also stated that no letter would be written. Khrushchev agreed, but had to explain publicly why he had retreated. He claimed victory claiming to have protected Cuba, removed meaningless missiles, and saved the world from war. The next day Czech representatives visited Khrushchev and he stated that the Soviets had won the conflict by protecting Cuba from invasion. He claimed Castro had acted dangerously and that China's aggressive stance on attacking the West was not a safe proposition. He bragged of thank you letters from Bertrand Russell and how the world now saw him as a peacemaker. *Pravda* published such letters from other leaders like Jawaharlal Nehru.

Though some in the East and non-aligned countries believed Khrushchev's interpretation of events, most in the West saw him as the loser. Soviet reporters had to knock down assertions that Khrushchev had been overruled and forced into withdrawal. Some thought Khrushchev might temporarily be in power, but was showing signs of a lack of control over himself. Kennedy was advised by Arthur

Schelsinger Jr. to make a speech claiming victory, but JFK demurred. Khrushchev had learned from the crisis that he had to change his opinion and dealings with JFK. Castro did not feel he had any part in a victory. He felt robbed of the missiles and the prestige that came with them.

Chapter 24: Indignation

“The reaction of our nation was profound indignation, not relief,”

-Castro referring to the outcome of the missile crisis.

“He was highly nervous and lambasted us every which way, if one can put it like that. Castro’s ‘revolutionism,’ his extremism was intensely fired up by the Chinese. And we suffered moral detriment. Instead of our stock rising in Cuba, it fell. Castro considered that we had betrayed Cuba while the Chinese were supporting it.”

-Khrushchev remembering Castro’s reaction to his deal with JFK

Castro was extremely upset from learning of the US-Soviet deal from the news and not directly. He felt used. He was angered by the Soviets telling the UN they could inspect Cuban land without his permission. Castro compared the lack of sovereignty to the Platt Amendment. The bill from 1901 had given the US incredible access and control over Cuba at the end of the Spanish-American War. It gave them military bases (like Guantánamo), kept Cuba from going into debt, and controlled aspects of foreign affairs. JFK had sought to counsel NATO and Turkey about possibly swapping missiles, but Khrushchev acted unilaterally. Khrushchev believed he acted in Cuba’s best interest, but the revolution’s nationalist bent meant it was not likely to fall in line like other communist-controlled countries. “Fatherland or death” was the slogan of the movement and it focused on not being used by other powers. ExCom had considered trying to use other countries to influence Castro into thinking Khrushchev was using Cuba, but they never acted on the idea. It was happening naturally.

Alekseev had not been informed of the deal before Castro found out. He tried to deliver Khrushchev's eventual letter to Castro but was denied access. Khrushchev was focused on not letting Castro sour the deal. Alekseev delivered the letter to the Cuban president, Osvaldo Dorticós. He reported to Moscow that the agreement had caused “confusion and bewilderment” in the Cuban government. Castro issued demands in order to accept the agreement. He wanted an end to covert attacks, an end to the blockade, and the desertion of Guantánamo. He also said that US airplanes would be shot down over Cuba. If his demands were not met he would not allow inspections. The demands were of the US, but pointed at proving to the Soviets that “we exist,” according to the Cubans. He informed Khrushchev of his displeasure about inspections and he claimed that he had ordered the U-2 shot down. He told U Thant that it was shot by Cuban forces. He did not want to show that he did not control the Soviet troops in Cuba.

Castro met Alekseev the next day and received a new letter from Soviet leadership. They sent the transcript of the Feklisov-Scali meeting to show that it was the US’s idea to accept a bargain from Castro about the missiles. Castro again rejected inspections and claimed the Soviets had given in to the US. Khrushchev decided to bully Castro by reminding him how close they had come to nuclear war and that the point was to survive in order to win later. Castro was not impressed by Khrushchev's reasoning and responded with a letter saying as much. Khrushchev took Alekseev’s advice to not respond again. U Thant visited Cuba on October 30th. He had been the first to try to broker a deal over Cuba via a missile swap. He had been invited during the crisis by Castro who wanted him to shield Cuba against a

US invasion. Now, U Thant was visiting to convince Castro to accept the inspections. Castro said that the US had acted illegally with its blockade and the inspections would also illegally violate Cuban sovereignty and humiliate it. U Thant compared the situation to UN troops being allowed in the Congo and Castro retorted that the leader that had agreed to that, Patrice Lumumba, had been killed in 1961. The meeting ended with no agreement. The next day U Thant asked what Castro thought of Khrushchev's letter to JFK. Castro said the inspection referred to in it had to take place outside of Cuba since the USSR did not have the ability to approve anything else.

Castro prevented U Thant from visiting the missiles, but he was able to meet with Soviet officials. He met with Alekseev and General Statsenko. Deputy Foreign Minister for the USSR, Vasilii Kuznetsov, met with U Thant before he visited Cuba and warned Moscow that he had asked to verify the dismantling of the missiles. Kuznetsov recommended to Moscow that the missiles be dismantled quickly so that U Thant would not have the chance and could only verify they were already dismantled. Moscow agreed that it would be beneficial to show U Thant the already dismantled launchers while he was in Cuba. Since Castro refused to grant the UN access, Alekseev wanted Pliev to meet with him instead. He refused and so Statsenko was sent. Statsenko was forthcoming during the meeting and said the dismantling had begun and would be done by November 2nd if not sooner. The Cubans were not permitted to witness the dismantling process. Castro gave a speech on October 31st rejecting any inspections in Cuba. He claimed the US was trying to humiliate Cuba, but his speech was more of a challenge to the USSR.

Part VII: Settlement

Chapter 25: Mission Impossible

"Look, he doesn't understand that we saved them from invasion; we saved them, but he doesn't understand our policy,"

-Khrushchev to Mikoyan concerning Castro

Khrushchev sent Mikoyan to Cuba to try and reason with Castro. Mikoyan did not want to leave his dying wife, but felt he was needed in Cuba. Khrushchev was afraid he would lose Cuba to China after saving it from the US. The nuclear threat seemed to have returned. Mikoyan flew to New York and met with U Thant. He had dinner with Stevenson and John McCloy. Zorin, Dobrynin, and Kuznetsov attended. He demanded a lift to the quarantine, but was informed it would last until the Red Cross could inspect Soviet ships. Mikoyan claimed that the US stated they would not sign an agreement to not invade Cuba that Cuba also signed. Stevenson, instead, stated the US would not sign any documents that included statements issued by Cuba. He also stated the US position that there would be no discussion of anything related to Guantánamo. The US tried to be flexible on inspection options, but Mikoyan refused to allow overflights, discuss SAM sites, or give a list of weapons.

Before Mikoyan departed for Cuba the next day, he received a list of weapons the US wanted out of Cuba. It did not include SAM sites, but had added IL-28 bombers. Mikoyan felt the US was trying to slip in the details at the last minute. Mikoyan made a public statement about the USSR endorsing Cuba's five demands for inspections and left.

Castro met Mikoyan at the airport and they started negotiations the next day on November 3rd. Khrushchev had sent a note to Castro that Mikoyan was a "Cuban in the CC CPSU." Castro vented about not being informed of the missile removal previously and compared it again to the Platt Amendment. Mikoyan was informed that his wife had died and was offered the chance to return to Russia, but he

decided to stay. He sent back his son to attend the funeral. Khrushchev did not attend as he had promised. Mikoyan would never forgive Khrushchev.

Mikoyan told Castro that the point of the missiles was to stop a US invasion. Khrushchev wanted to protect Cuba and did not have time at the end to inform Castro when a deal was made. He hoped to convince Castro to allow UN inspectors to inspect Soviet ships with the weapons in Cuban ports as a compromise. He was stunned by Castro's absolute refusal of any inspections.

On November 7th, the Soviets celebrated the 45th anniversary of the Bolshevik Revolution. The "October Revolution" had occurred in the imperial capital of Petrograd. There was a celebration at the Soviet embassy in Havana and Raul attended rather than Castro. The Cuban military intelligence chief offended Soviet officials by offering a toast to Castro and Stalin. Khrushchev wanted an investigation into the matter. Stalin's legacy had been refuted since Khrushchev's ascendance. His body had been removed from the viewing mausoleum in 1961, and he was not mentioned in the history of progress mentioned at the anniversary celebration. Mikoyan had not known of the offensive toast and was angered by General Gribkov reporting it to Moscow instead of him. A Soviet soldier drunkenly fired at a Cuban patrol on the day of the celebration as well, but the incident was covered up.

The Soviet troops were angered and depressed by leaving after having just arrived and having to do so in secret. They had to wait at Cuban ports for weeks as Soviet ships were sent. They slept out in the open in a chaotic scene. No Cuban officials were present at their eventual send-off.

Statsenko had dismantled his missile site in three days, finishing on October 31st. The next day he was told to load the missiles on ships before anything else. From November 3rd-8th, they were loaded onto older ships that were ill-equipped for the task. The *Aleksandrovsk* received R-15 warheads in addition to the R-14 warheads it had brought just before the blockade began, but never unloaded. It joined the *Divnogorsk*, a cargo ship built in Poland that had also barely beat the blockade. It was ordered to carry the missiles and escort the warheads. They left on November 6th. The ships were followed by US planes and subs. On November 9th, the US destroyer *Blandy* demanded that the *Divnogorsk* open its decks for inspection. The commander was not aware of inspection agreements, but was told to comply after sending a message to the minister of the Soviet Merchant Fleet. The *Blandy* then ordered the *Divnogorsk* to show its cargo so they could film it, stating they knew the ship had just received instructions to comply. The political officer onboard still refused, but the captain and the KGB officer insisted.

The inspection of the ships was suggested by Gromyko and delivered to Stevenson by Kuznetsov. Initially Soviet ships were ordered to show their cargo to only UN-flagged ships, but then were told to do so to US ships. The Soviets made protests and the *Volgoles* refused to show its cargo on November 8th until it was informed the next day to do so. The Soviets shipped over 3,000 men and over 1,000 pieces of equipment from Cuba from November 1st-10th. The second stage took place from November 18th - December 12nd and included over 3,700 men and 985 pieces of equipment. Sidrov was amongst the last to leave and had been one of the first to arrive.

Chapter 26: Back at the Barricade

"We can imagine how difficult it would be to impress such an understanding on our friends,...But therein lies the art of politicians—when encountering difficulties, to show the ability to overcome such difficulties."

-Khrushchev to Mikoyan

The Democrats gained four senate seats and lost one House seat despite increasing their total number of votes. For an off-year election, it was a victory. JFK sent a letter to Khrushchev specifically including the IL-28 bombers as “offensive weapons.” Khrushchev informed Pliev that the bombers and the Luna missiles were to stay in Cuba. After meeting with the Presidium, Khrushchev decided to relent. He informed Mikoyan, who had thought the bombers would not come up, and now referred to Stevenson and the US representatives as “pilferers.” He informed Castro of the bomber's removal on November 12th. Castro believed the blockade would continue regardless because he wouldn't allow inspections. The next day, Castro replied to Khrushchev that he could not consent to remove the bombers without the US stopping their overflights and removing the blockade. The US was using the flights as a substitute for ground inspections so they refused Castro's demand. After no further discussions for two days, Mikoyan requested a dinner meeting with Cuban officials on November 16th. Castro was in a better mood because he had issued an order for SAM sites to resume firing at US overflights. The order was actually to begin on November 18th. He also sent a letter to U Thant eliminating any chance of inspections on Cuban soil and officially protesting the flights. Mikoyan was afraid that a new military threat was beginning.

Dobrynin met with RFK on November 12th to offer to remove the bombers in the future like the US would do with the missiles in Turkey. RFK insisted on an announced date which the US would respond to by lifting the blockade. RFK met Dobrynin again at a reception for the Bolshoi Theater troupe's US visit and confirmed that JFK would lift the blockade after an announcement by Khrushchev to remove the bombers within 30 days. Khrushchev responded for JFK to stop overflights in exchange for a bomber announcement. JFK was not pleased by the response. Dobrynin was told that the continued issues were making it possible for the entire crisis to restart. JFK had taken over the role of aggressor in the situation.

Stevenson protested to Kuznetsov about Cuban plans to shoot at US flights. The Presidium met to discuss the situation and all agreed that Castro's response was “unreasonable and screechy.” They considered a full withdrawal from Cuba if Castro continued to be intransigent. They informed Mikoyan that Castro's plans would lead to war and that if Cuba was not “helpful” then the Soviet presence there would be reconsidered. The threat was that Soviet troops would leave the island if Castro began shooting at US flights. They also mentioned that there were three alternatives to inspections: inspections could be conducted by the UN, Latin American ambassadors, or representatives from 10 neutral nations. Mikoyan had let Khrushchev know that Castro's decision to fire at US flights was an emotional reaction. He had mainly wanted to stop the low-level flights which the US ended on November 16th. Mikoyan believed this had relieved some of the pressure from the situation. Castro had informed U Thant that they would limit the flights through their own means which were not capable of attacking U-2 flights. Pliev had been ordered not to use Soviet sites to do so. Castro was angry at the U-2 flights, but had moved past his demand they stop in exchange for the removal of bombers. On November 19th, he agreed that ending the blockade in exchange for the bombers was worth it. Castro realized he was being seen by the rest of the world as the only reason the crisis had not been fully ended. He also feared JFK was about to attack Cuba as the reason for a possible war. Mikoyan asked Dobrynin to warn RFK of Castro's fears and convince JFK not to inflame the situation. Castro held out hope that JFK would attack the USSR in his upcoming address and force them to respond by not removing the bombers.

Chapter 27: Thanksgiving

“Permit me to express the hope that with receipt of this communication of mine you will issue instructions to the effect that the quarantine be lifted immediately with the withdrawal of your naval and other military units from the Caribbean area.”

-Khrushchev in a letter to Kennedy

“I have this afternoon instructed the Secretary of Defense to lift our naval quarantine...The evidence to date indicates that all known offensive missile sites in Cuba have been dismantled...The missiles and their associated equipment have been loaded on Soviet ships. And our inspection at sea of these departing ships has confirmed that the number of missiles reported by the Soviet Union as having been brought into Cuba, which closely corresponded to our information, has now been removed. In addition, the Soviet Government has stated that all nuclear weapons have been withdrawn from Cuba and no offensive weapons will be reintroduced.”

-JFK at his November 20 press conference

Our men fired two shots and brought down a U-2—those are our expenses, nothing more. Not bad...God grant that we concede in the future with such results.”

-Khrushchev to the Central Committee of the Communist Party

“Neither the Russian nor the Soviet army had ever suffered such humiliation as to allow the adversary to inspect weapons transports,”

-Rodion Malinovsky to his general staff in October 1964

The JFK press conference was to be held on November 20th. He hoped to state the crisis had ended. The CIA and military did not agree with the 30-day bomber deal. McCone was concerned with any Soviet troops remaining in Cuba, especially the SAM sites which could keep U-2 flights from detecting future missiles. The Joint Chiefs still recommended invasion and stated they were ready to defend Berlin if needed. The lack of overflights had left the US vulnerable to Cuban activity and Khrushchev had stopped communicating leading to more tension. JFK asked the military to resume low-level flights on November 24th. General Taylor restated the existing plans of striking any SAM sites that might shoot down US flights. A new showdown over the bombers was looming. Paul Nitze was in favor of an attack. George Ball called for a tighter blockade. He stated that NATO leaders were in agreement that the Soviet bases needed to go and would support US action to remove them. JFK doubted Khrushchev would back down again, but Bundy believed the Soviet logic dictated such a response in light of their weak position in the area. JFK asked for a statement to be ready if no news was forthcoming. He also had the OAS asked to back the US resumption of flights to inspect Cuba. RFK visited Bolshakov since Dobrynin had no news. He needed a reply from Khrushchev before the press event on the 20th. If the bombers were not removed the flights would resume.

Khrushchev decided to accept JFK's proposal on bomber removal despite not knowing that Castro had conceded. He did not demand the promise not to invade or an end to flights. A note to the letter was added on Mikoyan's request asking JFK not to inflame the situation via statements about Cuba. The letter falsely stated that all nuclear weapons had been removed. The bombers still were armed and tactical nukes remained. However, Khrushchev had already decided to remove them as well. Castro then

announced to Mikoyan that the UN would be told that Cuba had tactical nukes. Mikoyan suggested Khrushchev should state there was a Soviet law against nuclear weapons being transferred to other countries. He was afraid that news of the presence of tactical nuclear weapons in Cuba could cast doubt on all previous assurances made by the Soviets.

Castro asked that the tactical nuclear weapons be left with Soviet forces when he was told of the fake Soviet law about transferring such weapons. Mikoyan said it could not happen since Castro had refused to allow a permanent Soviet base.

JFK announced Khrushchev's agreement to remove the bombers at his press conference. He had originally not intended to mention the non-invasion promise, but in light of the upcoming Thanksgiving holiday, he decided to try and put a complete end to the situation. Khrushchev admitted the bomber removal was a concession, but put it as a positive step to assure the promise by the US not to invade Cuba. He also refuted attacks from the Chinese as hypocritical. His remarks brought applause, but there was a general concern amongst many that he had been dangerously reckless. He would be removed in October 1964 by the same audience. Cuba was one of the central justifications for the removal. They argued the crisis diminished the international standing of the USSR and humiliated the military. Khrushchev had kept Cuba in the Soviet camp and saved it from invasion, but he did not achieve missile parity with the US. He did receive the removal of missiles from Turkey, but at too high a price for most involved.

EPILOGUE

"As participants in democratic politics, we must relearn the forgotten lessons of the past in order to make politicians act upon them. Looking back is an essential prerequisite for moving forward."

-Serhii Plokhyy

Both Khrushchev and JFK did not remain long in power after the Cuban crisis. JFK was assassinated in Dallas on November 22, 1963. Khrushchev was removed from power exactly two years after the discovery of Cuban missiles (October 14, 1964). They had managed to sign the partial nuclear test-ban treaty in August 1963. The precipitous end of nuclear fallout in the atmosphere will be able to be detected even eons into the future. 1954 and the Castle Bravo test in the Marshall Islands was the highpoint of fallout or the "golden spike" period that marked the nuclear period of testing that started in the 1950s. It was 15 megatons or 2.5 more powerful than intended. The 1961 Tsar Bomba near the Arctic Ocean was 58 megatons though originally intended to be only 8. Nuclear arms were reduced by 80% between 1972 and 1993, but in 2019 the US and Russia both withdrew from the Intermediate Range Nuclear Forces Treaty created in 1987 by Ronald Reagan and Mikhail Gorbachev. Russia is not communist, but has stated its support of authoritarian regimes. Nuclear weapons and missile technology have proliferated to more countries such as North Korea, India, Pakistan, and Israel. Cyber-warfare adds more danger to the situation. Mutually Assured Destruction only works if people continue to fear nuclear war. Churchill described the deterrent as a "balance of terror." The risks exist as long as people believe nuclear weapons are "of the past" and not a present threat that needs to be addressed.

SECTION III

Supplemental Documents

Churchill-Stalin Secret “Percentages” Agreement

October 9, 1944

Summary: A discussion of a quote from Churchill’s work, *The Second World War* where he discusses his Moscow Summit with Stalin prior to the Yalta Conference. The two leaders laid out post-war plans for spheres of influence in the Balkans. Churchill suggested destroying the paper after it was agreed to, but Stalin told him to keep it.

Key Quotes:

“Let us settle about our affairs in the Balkans...Don’t let us get at cross purposes in small ways...how would it do for you to have ninety per cent predominance in Rumania, for us to have ninety per cent of the say in Greece, and go fifty-fifty about Yugoslavia?”

Yalta Conference (aka Crimea Conference)

February 4-11, 1945

Summary: A collection of the agreements between “The Big Three” (US President Franklin Roosevelt, UK Prime Minister Winston Churchill, and USSR Premier Josef Stalin). Major agreements included:

- I. Creation of the United Nations that would first meet in San Francisco on April 25, 1945. It created the concept of the UN Security Council and its 5 permanent seats.
- II. Former Axis and Axis-dominated countries in Europe should be allowed to create their own independent governments through democratic means. This reaffirmed the stance of the Atlantic Charter.
- III. Germany would be occupied by the Big Three with a French zone of occupation created from the US and UK sectors. Germany would pay reparations through goods and labor worth \$22 billion dollars with the USSR receiving 50%.
- IV. Poland was to be reestablished under the Polish Provisional Government of National Unity with elections to follow. Poland should receive territorial concessions from Germany.
- V. Yugoslavia would set up a new government under Marshal Tito and Dr. Ivan Subastitch. A parliament would be established with the Anti-Fascist Assembly of the National Liberation and former government members that did not collaborate with the Axis.
- VI. A continual joint effort of communication between the Big Three Foreign Secretaries would continue every 3-4 months.
- VII. The USSR agreed to enter the war against Japan a few months after the conclusion of hostilities with Germany. They would have their possessions lost in 1904 returned (Sakhalin Island, access to Dairen and Port Arthur, and control of the Manchurian Railroad). The Kuril(e) Islands would become a Soviet possession.

Key Quotes:

"The establishment of order in Europe and the rebuilding of national economic life must be achieved by processes which will enable the liberated peoples to destroy the last vestiges of nazism and fascism and to create democratic institutions of their own choice. This is a principle of the Atlantic Charter - the right of all people to choose the form of government under which they will live - the restoration of sovereign rights and self-government to those peoples who have been forcibly deprived of them by the aggressor nations."

President Roosevelt to the Chairman of the Council of People's Commissars of the Soviet Union

April 1, 1945

Summary: Roosevelt voiced his concerns over events since Yalta. He stated he was confused by Stalin's lack of action on Poland. He believed the lack of progress on setting up a government in Poland was due to Stalin not following through on the agreements at Yalta. He restated that Yalta called for the Polish Provisional Government of National Unity to be open and not only comprised of Stalin's favored Lublin Government which was already in power in Warsaw. He recommended that the Commission in Moscow should invite candidates for the government and the Lublin group could be the first invited, but candidates should not be vetoed by either side. To end the impasse of the Commission being stalled in its effort to form a government, FDR suggested 1) dissidents in Poland should cease activity and the US and USSR should foster that and 2) US and UK Commission members should be able to visit Poland. FDR felt success in Poland was essential for Allied cooperation to continue because otherwise public support would falter. He ended by stating the importance of public support on policy in the United States.

Key Quotes:

"I am frankly puzzled as to why this should be and must tell you that I do not fully understand in many respects the apparent indifferent attitude of your Government. Having understood each other so well at Yalta I am convinced that the three of us can and will clear away any obstacles which have developed since then."

Declaration of Independence of the Democratic Republic of Vietnam

September, 1945

Summary: Ho Chi Minh authored a declaration of Vietnamese independence directly after the end of WWII which ended Japanese control over the territory. He quotes from the US Declaration of Independence and the Rights of Man from the French Revolution. He then lists the infringements of the basic rights of the Vietnamese people by the colonial occupiers. The Japanese occupation led to the death of two million people due to starvation. The French could not protect the Viet Minh and colonists massacred them. He claims that the French ceased to control the area in 1940, and with the removal of the Japanese the Democratic Republic of Vietnam was established. Based on the declarations of the Tehran Conference and the United Nations Charter, Vietnam and its people should have the right to self-determination.

Key Quotes:

"'All men are created equal. They are endowed by their Creator with certain inalienable rights, among them are Life, Liberty, and the pursuit of Happiness.'

This immortal statement was made in the Declaration of Independence of the United States of America in 1776. In a broader sense, this means: All the peoples on the earth are equal from birth, all the peoples have a right to live, to be happy and free. The Declaration of the French Revolution made in 1791 on the Rights of Man and the Citizen also states: 'All men are born free and with equal rights, and must always remain free and have equal rights.' Those are undeniable truths. Nevertheless, for more than eighty years, the French imperialists, abusing the standard of Liberty, Equality, and Fraternity, have violated our Fatherland and oppressed our fellow-citizens. They have acted contrary to the ideals of humanity and justice."

Stalin's Speech before Meeting of Voters

February 9, 1946

Summary: Stalin addressed voters in Moscow about the future of the USSR and the events of the last eight years. He focused on the causes and results of WWII. He stated that capitalism creates a system that inherently results in conflict. The victory of the Soviet Union proved the success and durability of the socialist system. He laid out the focus of the next five year plan. It would seek to make the USSR independent in case of future wars. He wanted to recover from the war and significantly increase production in industry and agriculture. He closes by thanking the crowd for his nomination to the Supreme Soviet.

Key Quotes:

"It would be wrong to think that the Second World War broke out accidentally, or as a result of blunders committed by certain statesmen, although blunders were certainly committed. As a matter of fact, the war broke out as the inevitable result of the development of world economic and political forces on the basis of present-day monopolistic capitalism."

"Our victory signifies, first of all, that our Soviet social system was victorious, that the Soviet social system successfully passed the test of fire in the war and proved that it is fully viable."

"Long Telegram" by George Kennan

February 22, 1946

Summary: George Kennan was living in Moscow representing the State department and sent an interpretation of Stalin's recent speech. He decided to give a complete overview of Soviet communism, foreign policy, and the proper response to it. The response was composed of five main ideas.

1. Basic Features of the Soviet Outlook:

Stalin and the USSR believed that capitalist countries are inherently opposed to socialist ones and conflict is inevitable. Capitalists will also inevitably have conflicts between each other, especially the UK and the US. These conflicts are dangerous, but can be used to the advantage of the USSR. Some aspects of capitalist societies are seen as positive and useful to the USSR. The most dangerous are the "false friends" such as social democrats. Advancing the status and relative power of the USSR is a constant goal as is the reduction of capitalist power. The USSR and its allies want to deepen divisions between capitalist countries in order to stoke conflict that can be exploited.

2. Background of the Soviet Outlook:

The party outlook is not the natural outlook of the Russian people. Peaceful coexistence is possible. Moderate socialist policies have seen success in Scandinavia and are sincere efforts. All this shows that the party line is not based on reality, but goals that existed before WWII. There is an inherent sense of insecurity that has pervaded Russian thought. Russian rulers have feared invasion and influence from more advanced or powerful societies. Bolshevism amplified this feeling and worked it into its ideology. Because of this, dogma plays an important part in all Soviet actions. The outside world is hostile and is inevitably going to fail. This party line is not necessarily disingenuous. This is partly due to the lack of unbiased information from the outside world making it through. There is a basic distrust of facts as they are seen to be used for some other purpose. It is possible that even Stalin does not receive objective information. The influence of advisors is unknown and a dangerous factor that must be remembered.

3. Practical Policy based on the Soviet Outlook:

Soviet policy has official and unofficial actions. Official policy seeks to bolster the Soviet strength and reputation. Some policies are only put forward after unofficial activities have set the stage for their implementation. Its membership in the UN is for more transactional purposes, and it does not authentically believe in the mission of the UN as a stabilizing force. Soviets may try to insert themselves into trusteeship situations in developing nations mainly to weaken the chance of Western influence. The

USSR has a goal of autocracy. It may keep all trade within its sphere of influence to achieve self-sufficiency. They will try to increase relations with any powers that are not closely aligned with the West. Cultural contacts will be superficially supported, but not acted on. The Soviets will focus on proper protocols to bolster the image of the Union rather than for moral reasons.

4. Unofficial Policies (Subterranean Plane):

An internal core of Communist Parties in other countries will work on orders from Moscow. Regular party members are kept outside of the control structure. This was not the previous situation. These members can still be used, but for dominating other institutions not connected to the party. Examples are international unions, civic organizations, the Russian and Eastern Orthodox Church, Pan-Slav movement and other racial movements, and governments of friendly nations. This influence will be used to weaken Western power and influence. Groups that suffer repression will be pushed to seek violent means for reform rather than compromise. Groups will be purposefully set against each other. This policy will be used with the most aggressiveness in colonial areas. Soviet backed/controlled regimes will be created to take control after conflict or independence. They will work to eliminate the influence of individuals such as clergy, business people, or others that may gain individual popularity. The USSR even moves its own local officials to limit their influence. Groups and factions within Western powers will be set against each other (US vs UK etc.). International organizations and cooperation will be undercut. All unofficial policies focus on diminishing the influence of any power or group that the USSR cannot directly control. Police influence in other countries is a key priority and the focus on police powers dates back to Tsarist times.

5. Practical Deductions (for US Policy Based on Soviet Outlook)

The Soviets are not naturally adventuristic like the Nazi regime. It does not respond to logic of reason, but to force. It will quickly withdraw from situations where power is likely to be applied against it. The Soviet system has not yet been proven durable. The succession after Stalin will be the real test. Communist beliefs are not widely held in great esteem by the Russian people. Soviet propaganda is essentially negative and can be easily refuted.

To properly respond to the USSR, it must be studied objectively and without emotion. The public should be educated about the truth of the situation. This is a vitally important task for the government. Anti-Soviet hysteria has been bred by ignorance. If the public is aware of the truth of the situation, there is a better chance for positive relations to be formed. The success of US society and the commitment to improve it and solve internal issues is the most effective counter to the spread of communism. Guidance to other countries is key and if it is not given the Soviets will fill in the vacuum. While doing all these things, the US must stay committed to its values and not fall into the trap of using the methods of our adversaries when confronting them.

Key Quotes:

"Problem of how to cope with this force in [is] undoubtedly greatest task our diplomacy has ever faced and probably greatest it will ever have to face. It should be point of departure from which our political general staff work at present juncture should proceed. It should be approached with same thoroughness and care as solution of major strategic problem in war, and if necessary, with no smaller outlay in planning effort. I cannot attempt to suggest all answers here. But I would like to record my conviction that problem is within our power to solve--and that without recourse to any general military conflict."

"I am convinced that there would be far less hysterical anti-Sovietism in our country today if realities of this situation were better understood by our people. There is nothing as dangerous or as terrifying as the unknown."

"Finally we must have courage and self-confidence to cling to our own methods and conceptions of human society. After Al(sic), the greatest danger that can befall us in coping with this problem of Soviet communism, is that we shall allow ourselves to become like those with whom we are coping."

“Iron Curtain Speech” by Winston Churchill

March 5, 1946

Summary: Churchill was the guest of President Truman in Fulton, Missouri at Westminster College when he addressed the domination of Eastern Europe by the Soviets following the end of WWII. The US public still largely considered Stalin and the Soviets an ally and his speech was fairly controversial at the time.

He stated that the US was the major power in the world. With that power came the responsibility of using it and not considering their job already completed. A greater task was now facing English-speaking peoples. Despite being allies with Stalin and respecting the contributions of the Russian people, the situation in Europe had changed. An iron curtain of Soviet control existed blocking the Eastern half of Europe from the West. A united Europe was needed to avoid future wars. The UN and its Charter should be used as a guide to settle disputes.

“Communist fifth columns” are spreading across the world under the control of Moscow. Yalta was favorable to the Soviets due to the need to end the war and it has allowed Soviet influence to spread in the Far East. A new war is not inevitable, which is why Churchill wanted to speak about the realities on the ground while a chance for peace still existed. Russia didn’t want war, but did want to expand its power.

Russia respects strength above all things. Churchill saw the same situation with Germany before the war and no one listened. It could have been prevented. The same could happen if action is taken to keep Russia contained by the UN. If the Commonwealth countries and US combined their resources, security could be achieved.

Key Quotes:

“From Stettin in the Baltic to Trieste in the Adriatic an iron curtain has descended across the Continent. Behind that line lie all the capitals of the ancient states of Central and Eastern Europe. Warsaw, Berlin, Prague, Vienna, Budapest, Belgrade, Bucharest and Sofia; all these famous cities and the populations around them lie in what I must call the Soviet sphere, and all are subject, in one form or another, not only to Soviet influence but to a very high and in some cases increasing measure of control from Moscow.”

“Last time I saw it all coming and I cried aloud to my own fellow countrymen and to the world, but no one paid any attention. Up till the year 1933 or even 1935, Germany might have been saved from the awful fate which has overtaken her and we might all have been spared the miseries Hitler let loose upon mankind.”

“Novikov Telegram”

September 1946

Summary: Nikolai Novikov was the Soviet ambassador to the United States and he outlined what he saw as the outlook of the US for the world. This was a response to the “Long Telegram” by Kennan, but was an internal document for the Politburo.

He stated that the US was seeking world supremacy based on the natural tendencies of its capitalist system. The US feels it has a right to lead and the military, industry, and scientific resources of the nation are put towards that end. A web of bases was being created across the world and new weapons were being developed to create control.

The US outlook changed greatly due to WWII. It is able to influence world economies like never before because of the devastation caused by the war. The assumption that the USSR would be weakened like other nations was wrong. Because it is not weak, it can prevent the unhindered spread of US power throughout Europe and Asia. The USSR is now stronger than before the war. It no longer faces threats from bordering countries. It has increased influence through its economic support with former adversaries and its allies. This influence in Eastern Europe and the Balkans is seen as an obstacle by the US. Truman being President and James Byrnes being Secretary of State made the US more reactionary.

The US Congress passed the first ever creation of a peacetime army of one million people. The navy decreased only slightly after the war and still far surpassed the size of any other country. The budget for the armed forces was 40% of the total budget and over ten times larger than before the war. 228 bases and support stations were planned for the Atlantic and 258 in the Pacific for the next few years. These included bases well beyond the US. The bases that are over 10,000 km away show they are offensive in nature. This was also shown by the expansion of the navy's activities. All of these activities show a plan for world dominance.

Key Quotes:

"The foreign policy of the United States, which reflects the imperialist tendencies of American monopolistic capital, is characterized in the postwar period by a striving for world supremacy. This is the real meaning of the many statements by President Truman and other representatives of American ruling circles; that the United States has the right to lead the world. All the forces of American diplomacy -- the army, the air force, the navy, industry, and science -- are enlisted in the service of this foreign policy."

"Truman Doctrine"

March 12, 1947

Summary: President Truman addressed a joint session of the US Congress after he had been informed the UK could no longer afford to financially and militarily support the Greek government in their efforts to end their civil war against communist forces.

He stated to Congress that the Greek government had asked for economic assistance in order to "survive as a free nation." They suffered during WWII from invasion and from internal conflict. The Germans had destroyed the infrastructure as they retreated, and the result was economic collapse and widespread disease (85% of the children had tuberculosis). The communist insurgency stepped into the chaos left by the Germans.

Greece required assistance as well as expert advisors and guidance. Northern Greece was suffering from terrorist activities due to the communist insurgency. It bordered the communist countries of Yugoslavia, Bulgaria, and Albania. Greece also required military assistance. Their army was poorly equipped and no other country was able to provide this assistance.

The British can no longer provide assistance. Any assistance to Greece must be with the goal of making it stable and self-sufficient. The UN might help, but could not act quickly enough. The Greek government was not perfect, but it was still a democracy. It made mistakes in trying to deal with the chaos, and the US would continue to condemn any extreme actions.

Turkey was also in need of support. It had received UK and US support, but required more in order to modernize and maintain stability. It was a key to stability in the Middle East as a whole. The UK could no longer help.

The war with Germany and Japan was a fight for freedom. The US takes part in the UN to continue that mission. Success is not possible without the US stepping in to help countries maintain their freedom. Totalitarian regimes undermine peace for the world. Those regimes were spreading. Poland, Romania, and Bulgaria fell into that category in violation of the Yalta agreement.

The totalitarian governments suppress personal freedoms and democracy. The US must support people in their resistance to these governments and forces. The assistance should be primarily economic in nature. The world changes and could continue to change, but the US should not allow violations of the UN Charter. The fall of Greece could lead to disorder in Turkey and the rest of the Middle East. That would also discourage people in other nations trying to keep free governments in place.

He asked for \$400 million in aid as well as civilian and military advisors to be sent to Greece and Turkey. If future aid was needed he would bring it to Congress and wanted the two branches of government to work together. The US spent \$341 billion to win WWII and invest in world peace. He was asking for 1 tenth of 1 percent of that amount to continue with this investment. Totalitarianism spreads in impoverished places with little hope. The US must provide that hope.

Key Quotes:

"The second way of life is based upon the will of a minority forcibly imposed upon the majority. It relies upon terror and oppression, a controlled press and radio; fixed elections, and the suppression of personal freedoms. I believe that it must be the policy of the United States to support free peoples who are resisting attempted subjugation by armed minorities or by outside pressures. I believe that we must assist free peoples to work out their own destinies in their own way."

"The seeds of totalitarian regimes are nurtured by misery and want. They spread and grow in the evil soil of poverty and strife. They reach their full growth when the hope of a people for a better life has died. We must keep that hope alive. The free peoples of the world look to us for support in maintaining their freedoms. If we falter in our leadership, we may endanger the peace of the world -- and we shall surely endanger the welfare of our own nation."

"Marshall Plan Speech" by George Marshall**June 5, 1947**

Summary: The Secretary of State in the Truman administration, George Marshall, announced his ideas for shoring up struggling European economies at the Harvard commencement ceremonies. He had previously declined the invitation, but after learning the specifics of the dire situation in Europe, he accepted the opportunity to speak and used it to unveil his proposal.

He believed the situation in Europe was serious, but so complicated that most people couldn't grasp it based on just news reports. The visible destruction of Europe was obvious, but the economic destruction was less obvious, but even more significant. The war effort of Germany destroyed long held ties and economic processes. The lack of a proper peace treaty in Germany and Austria after two years has made the rehabilitation of economies even more difficult. Even with a resolution, the economies had even more basic problems.

The exchange between agriculture and industry had been disrupted with the destruction of most cities. Farmers switched to livestock instead of foodstuffs to feed themselves and trade with the cities has been halted. City populations were starving and governments were using funds to buy food and had none left for reconstruction. Confidence in the economic system had broken down and needed to be restored for reconstruction to take place. The US had to step in to create stability if it wanted peace to continue.

The enemies were poverty and chaos. If countries tried to limit reconstruction of others, they would not receive aid. Europe must be responsible for its own recovery, but the US would support it and help it create such programs. Politics would not be a part of this program or its response in the US. Marshall apologized for speaking about specifics, but informing the public was necessary to avoid vague and emotional responses. The distance of the US from Europe made the situation seem remote and hard to grasp, but the people needed to understand its significance to understand what must be done.

Key Quotes:

"In considering the requirements for the rehabilitation of Europe, the physical loss of life, the visible destruction of cities, factories, mines, and railroads was correctly estimated, but it has become obvious during recent months that this visible destruction was probably less serious than the dislocation of the entire fabric of European economy."

"The truth of the matter is that Europe's requirements for the next three or four years of foreign food and other essential products -- principally from America -- are so much greater than her present ability to pay that she must have substantial additional help or face economic, social and political deterioration of a very grave character."

“The initiative, I think, must come from Europe. The role of this country should consist of friendly aid in the drafting of a European program and of later support of such a program so far as it may be practical for us to do so. The program should be a joint one, agreed to by a number, if not all, European nations.”

Effects of Soviet Restriction on the US Position in Berlin, Intelligence Report

June 1, 1948

Summary: This memo highlights the difficulty in continuing US counterintelligence missions in Berlin due to the Soviets trying to limit access and movement across the occupied sectors of Berlin. The specific impairments were listed as a lack of access and support to deserters and anti-Communist informers, the limitation of US propaganda, the inability to ship products between zones, and the diminishing hopes of German reunification.

The continuation of western forces in Berlin required a constant influx of supplies. Fuel was still coming in, but subject to more restrictions. Civilian supply traffic was not impacted, but military transports had stopped because the US did not allow USSR inspections. The logistical situation had not yet been hampered, but strategic efforts were being greatly impacted.

Moving intelligence assets in and out of Berlin was very difficult due to new Soviet security protocols. This also limited propaganda efforts except through radio. The trade of goods between Berlin and the West was basically stopped.

By walking out of the Allied Control Council on March 20th, the Soviets made it ineffectual. This removed a mechanism for reunification and a clear way to reduce tensions between US and USSR administrators.

The situation could deteriorate further if the Soviets were to block aircraft and all other traffic by incorporating all of Berlin into the Soviet sector. The US could increase secret operations, but that would not improve the situation facing the Berlin city government.

Key Quotes:

“The USSR still has at its disposal further means of harassing the US and making the latter’s position in Berlin more difficult. These means include: imposition of unilateral traffic regulations of inbound food and freight shipments...”

CIA Weekly Summaries regarding the Soviet Blockade

October 29, 1948

Summary: The CIA created briefings of the main events surrounding the Berlin Blockade in late 1948. The first briefing was from the last week in October and interprets the Soviet veto statement keeping the UN Security Council from mediating the situation. The statement was seen as mild and is explained by the fact that the blockade seems to have had the opposite effect from what the Soviets seem to have intended, i.e. the isolation of West Berlin and the weakening of Western allied resolve. It also discusses how the USSR was trying to set up a separate East German government as a puppet once Soviet troops ended their occupation. Part of this effort was a purge in the leftist Socialist Unity Party (SED) of all non-communists. The Ministry of Interior was being controlled via the SED to monitor and control police at all levels of government.

The summary from the beginning of December discussed the difficulty in ending the crisis since the Soviets established a separate government for East Berlin. It stated that the USSR used UN discussions to gain time to create a separate government. The currency issue that precipitated the crisis had become secondary to the fallout from the new government administration. The brief discussed possible plans by the Soviets to force the two city administrations together later as a compromise that would push communist leaders into the Western sphere of the city. West Berlin was set to hold elections and it was feared the Soviets would respond by removing the ability of people to work in different sectors of the city, limit utilities to sectors, or stop transportation, communication, and mass transit options

between sectors. If the Soviets did put a physical barrier between the sectors, the economic trade would be immediately and dramatically curtailed, resulting in a need to increase the airlift capacity.

In January, the CIA reported that the formation of East Germany was growing more likely. With plans for a West Germany in place, the Soviets might have tried to preempt that effort and claim legitimacy of the East as the “true” Germany. The USSR could have withdrawn some troops to put pressure on Western countries to withdraw as well and use the new government to justify the extension of the blockade.

The final summary was from March and focused on the impacts of the new “B” mark, or Berlin specific Deutschmark. The response was predicted to be a tightening of the blockade which would necessitate an increase in airlift efforts. The possible specifics were listed as ending rail traffic, like the S-Bahn mass transit system, cutting off mail, water, phone lines, or other utilities. The response would be limited by repercussions that would be suffered in the East as a result. The Soviets were also presented as possibly creating a new Eastern currency to keep the Western currency from flowing into their zone.

NATO Treaty

April 4, 1949

Summary: The document was signed at Washington DC and stated its purpose as being the defense of the Charter of the United Nations and a desire for peace. It was meant to defend democracy, individual liberty, and the rule of law to promote stability through the collective defense and security of the members. There are fourteen total articles. The first article commits the members to the treaty to settle disputes peacefully as instructed by the UN Charter. The second article asserts that the promotion of free institutions within the nations will promote their furtherance across the globe. The third, commits the parties to mutual aid to help achieve the treaty's goals and help build defenses. The fourth article calls for group consultation about possible threats. Article five is the key part of the agreement and states that an attack on one member is an attack on all. Any actions would be reported to the UN Security Council. Article six specifies what territories are included as part of the previous article including forces in other areas. Article seven states that NATO does not usurp the Security Council. The next article asserts that all current and future agreements will be in line with the NATO Treaty. Article ten allows for future members to join. The agreement was to be deposited with the US government. The joining members would be Belgium, Canada, France, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, the UK, and the US and would ratify the agreement according to their constitutions. Article twelve states that the treaty would be in effect for ten years before being reviewed for change. After twenty years, Article thirteen states that nations could leave the agreement with a year's notice to the US government. Article 14 states that the English and French versions of the treaty will be kept in the US Archives.

Key Quotes:

“The Parties agree that an armed attack against one or more of them in Europe or North America shall be considered an attack against them all, and consequently they agree that, if such an armed attack occurs, each of them, in exercise of the right of individual or collective self defence recognised by Article 51 of the Charter of the United Nations, will assist the Party or Parties so attacked by taking forthwith, individually, and in concert with the other Parties, such action as it deems necessary, including the use of armed force, to restore and maintain the security of the North Atlantic area.”

National Security Council Paper-68

April 14, 1950

Summary: The suggestions of NSC-68 had significant weight for the US outlook concerning Cold War activities through the 1950s and 60s. The outbreak of the Korean Conflict within months of it being published helped cement its importance. The excerpts included in this document cover the main points of its analysis of US and Soviet abilities.

-Background of the Present World Crisis

The paper states that history was mainly marked by cycles of violence as competing powers sought to gain leverage over each other without any one power establishing dominance. The recent collapse of empires (Ottoman, Austro-Hungarian, German, Italian, Japanese, the weakening of the British and French empires, and the revolutions in Russia and China) completely changed the world power dynamic. It asserted that the USSR had a desire to spread its beliefs across the world and the beliefs are antithetical to that of the US. The addition of nuclear weapons makes for the possibility of total annihilation. There was a desire for peace, but there was also a need for maintaining a deterrent to Soviet power and limiting its growth to maintain the possibility of a deterrent. Decisions needed to be made to avoid the destruction of western civilization.

-Fundamental Design of the Kremlin

The goal of Soviet leadership was to maintain their control in the USSR and in areas they controlled. That required an increase in their control and an elimination of dissent. They sought to destroy competing governments and sources of dissent in non-communist areas so they could be controlled by the Kremlin. They sought to control Eurasia and saw the US as their main alternate source of power, and therefore main enemy that needed to be undermined.

Military

The USSR had the military capacity to defend its territory and far beyond, but not enough in its own estimation to confront the US. Its strength and atomic weapons gave it the power to leverage its position to further its influence during peacetime and deter others from stopping it due to the risk of war. In 1950, the USSR and its allies would be able to overrun the rest of Europe, except perhaps the furthest extension of the Iberian and Scandinavian Peninsulas. It would be able to pull together communist areas in the Far East. It could threaten Britain with airstrikes and attack Western communications. The Soviets could use atomic weapons against US positions or keep them to threaten the UK and keep it from being the base of operations for the West. It could then lead a secondary attack on the rest of Europe and into the Middle East while attacking North America via air.

The Economic Cooperation Act of 1948 and the Defense Assistance Act of 1949 would not be able to significantly increase European defenses until 1952. An effective defense was predicted to not be likely until 1960. Atomic capabilities of the Soviet Union were predicted to be 10-20 weapons by mid-1950 and 25-45 a year later. By mid-1952, the number would be 45-90 and 70-135 the next year before reaching 200 in 1954. It was a rough estimation that could change, but there was evidence that the USSR was developing a thermonuclear weapon. They had enough bombers to deliver their current stockpile, but they did not have the US's level of accuracy. They would be able to accurately deliver 100 of their bombs when they reached 200 in total. That would be enough to seriously damage the US.

The Soviets could launch a surprise atomic attack once they had a large enough capacity. That could result in the destruction of the British Isles, destruction of Western communications, and devastate parts of the US and Canada. If they achieved thermonuclear capabilities the damage would increase significantly.

-US Intentions and Capabilities - Actual and Potential Military

The US had the strongest military of any country. It still could not match the number of Soviet forces and did not have attack positions for its forces and weapons that would be needed in a direct conflict with the USSR. The US had a larger military than at any other time of peace, but it was not currently large enough to react to the commitments of defense it had made if conflict were to begin. In 1950, the US and allies could defend the Western Hemisphere as well as strategic points in the Middle East and the British Isles. Air attacks against the USSR would also be possible. If military strength was increased then deterrence would be possible. It would allow the US to counter any Soviet-led attack. The increase would require a building up of forces, weapons, and development of future weapons. Such an increase would require 2-3 years in peacetime and less during war. The increase would be capable of deterring any Soviet attack and defending it if it was needed.

-Atomic Armaments - Military Evaluation of US and USSR Atomic Capabilities

The US stockpile could have dramatically reduced Soviet war-making abilities, but would not have likely caused a surrender or stopped them from occupying Western Europe. It would have still given the US a position of strength for the rest of the war. The Soviet stockpile would carry more of a threat as it increased and could have kept the UK from being used as an advanced base for the US and its allies. Within four years, the USSR would have an arsenal that could take away the economic advantage the US had if a surprise attack was launched. A system to defend against a Soviet attack would be needed including a civilian defense program. If their capabilities continued to grow, a surprise attack could be powerful enough to defeat the US. The advantage of a surprise attack might convince the USSR of such a strategy. The US needed the ability to retaliate to keep eventual victory possible for the West after the Soviets reached the 1954 levels of expected weapons. A further build up by the US would have also delayed when the USSR would have enough weapons to calculate a high probability of a successful surprise attack. It would also have given time for political and economic influence to be used against the Soviet sphere. The dangers increased significantly if the USSR developed a thermonuclear weapon. The US could have used its own development of such a device to pressure the Soviet Union.

-Stockpiling and Use of Atomic Weapons

Eliminating atomic weapons would bring the greatest benefit, but if that could not be achieved there was a great need to rapidly increase the atomic stockpile. A conventional weapon build up was also necessary.

-Conclusions

The increase in Soviet atomic weapons required the US to dramatically increase its military strength to deter and counter the growing threat to the country and its allies. The current status of growth would not attain such levels. Current levels of growth would lead to isolation by the realities of power and abilities rather than by aims and designs of the government. The US was central to any defense of the West and that created a growing responsibility to build up strength. There needed to be a strong enough build up to help the West counter Soviet aims during peace and in times of war.

The US needed to seek to use its leadership of the free world to frustrate Soviet goals and build up its own strength. It had to be willing to negotiate with the USSR, but only from a position of power. Only through such action would the USSR abandon the ideal of expansion and power to influence the world at large. The success of that initiative required a belief throughout the allied "free world" that the cold war was a real military, political, and social struggle that had to be immediately faced and responded to.

Key Quotes:

"In time, the atomic capability of the U.S.S.R. can be expected to grow to a point where, given surprise and no more effective opposition than we now have programmed, the possibility of a decisive initial attack cannot be excluded."

"In the initial phases of an atomic war, the advantages of initiative and surprise would be very great. A police state living behind an iron curtain has an enormous advantage in maintaining the necessary security and centralization of decisions required to capitalize on this advantage."

"The only sure victory lies in the frustration of the Kremlin design by the steady development of the moral and material strength by the free world and its projection into the Soviet world in such a way as to bring about an internal change in the Soviet system. Such a positive program -- harmonious with our fundamental national purpose and our objectives -- is necessary if we are to regain and retain the initiative and to win and hold the necessary popular support and cooperation in the United States and the rest of the free world."

“The whole success of the proposed program hangs ultimately on recognition by this Government, the American people, and all free peoples, that the cold war is in fact a real war in which the survival of the free world is at stake. Essential prerequisites to success are consultations with Congressional leaders designed to make the program the object of non-partisan legislative support, and a presentation to the public of a full explanation of the facts and implications of the present international situation. The prosecution of the program will require of us all the ingenuity of the issue and the tenacity to persevere until our national objectives have been attained.”

CIA Summaries on the Korean Conflict

1950

Summary: As the US began its involvement in the Korean Conflict the CIA gave summaries of possible outcomes for the US and actions by the USSR, China, and the DPRK.

July 8, 1950: The document discussed possible Soviet reasons for supporting the DPRK's invasion of the South. The analysis was that the USSR did not believe the UN or the US would or could respond in the time needed to avoid the collapse of the South.

It outlined possible Soviet strategies in Korea:

- A. They could limit fighting in Korea and not become heavily involved while painting the US as outside aggressors. This was seen as unlikely since any upside for the USSR would be limited and slow.
- B. The USSR could limit the conflict, but supply the DPRK and involve PRC troops. That alternative would prolong the conflict and could lead to a weakening of resolve amongst US allies. It would also increase Soviet prestige while tarnishing that of the United States. This was seen as the likely alternative.
- C. The Soviets could create similar conflicts in other areas such as Formosa (Taiwan), Iran, Greece, or increase pressure on the jointly held areas of Berlin or Vienna. That alternative was seen as aggressive, but would also be something the US was unprepared to respond to. It would require the US to either reconsider its containment response or prepare for continual or total military activity. The report believed that the USSR would adopt such a policy if a total world war did not seem likely, but would not do so if the US mobilized to respond.
- D. The Soviets would use Korea as an onramp to a global war with the United States and its allies. This was seen as unlikely since other alternatives provided positives without the severe risks involved in such a policy.

The document continued by looking at the possible outcome of the US failing to stabilize South Korea. It was believed that the loss of prestige might lead to further Soviet aggression or the need for the US to invade another location to regain its perception of strength.

July 10, 1950: This memo focused on the repercussions of the US voluntarily withdrawing its forces from Korea. Such action was seen as the most dangerous alternative for the United States. It was predicted to undermine all its foreign policy agreements and relations. Such an action would have undercut NATO and other commitments by causing doubts amongst allies concerning the US ability to aid in stopping Soviet aggression. It could have led areas such as Iran and Indochina to preemptively seek positive relations with the Soviet Union. The USSR would also have been more likely to initiate similar actions to Korea since the fear of general war would have been significantly lessened. The US would likely have needed to heavily mobilize or totally mobilize to prepare for future aggression after a withdrawal. Such actions may then have been perceived as preparations for a general war by the USSR. It would have been more logical to mobilize to support efforts in Korea than to do so after a withdrawal. Mobilization after the fact would not have reduced the damage to the alliances and relationships of the North Atlantic community.

July 12, 1950: The memo discussed an Army report that the PRC was preparing to attack Taiwan imminently. Military movements, preparations, comments by Foreign Minister Chou En-Lai (Zhou Enlai), a trip by Mao to Moscow, and events in Taiwan were given as evidence. The CIA did not have evidence to suggest an attack, but believed PRC troops were capable.

July 7, 1950: This document breaks down the possible Soviet reactions to US involvement of troops. The document stated that US involvement made the Soviets more cautious about being aggressive, but they could still reap the benefits of the North's advances if they continued. The Soviets could have prolonged the war by supplying the North without fully involving itself. The PRC was not expected to involve its troops unless the North suffered losses. The PRC was thought to be looking at other opportunities for aggression in the Far East. US support of Taiwan was seen as a strong factor in discouraging PRC aggression there. It was also not believed the PRC would move into Korea under the current circumstances. China was believed to be interested in using the conflict to increase its support of other groups in Southeast Asia such as Ho Chi Minh's forces and those in Malaya. There was fear of possible action by the PRC into Burma to contain the Chinese Nationalist troops living there.

“Declaration of Conscience” by Margaret Chase Smith

June 1, 1950

Summary: Smith was a senator from Maine that chose to attack the continued prosecutions led by fellow Republican senator, Joseph McCarthy, of Wisconsin. Her statement opened with an invocation of the constitutional rights to free speech and trial by jury. She believed that lives were being ruined by the committee attacks and being done in the name of “Americanism” that was ignoring the founding principles of the country e.g. the right to criticize, hold different beliefs, protest, and think differently. Those rights should not be used against people to destroy their lives. The country does not want thought control. People were tired of being called communists or fascists just for expressing themselves or seeing innocent people attacked. There had been some real cases, but the methods had created distrust.

As a Republican, Smith felt the challenge they were facing was akin to the Civil War. The Senate was spreading dangerous suspicion. The Democratic administration was ineffective, but replacing it with a dangerous Republican one was no better. She stated that Republicans could not be that desperate and probably couldn't win with such an attitude anyway. It could destroy the entire two-party system. She wondered how other women felt about how family members had been vilified by the Senate. She attacked both parties in the Senate for recklessly throwing accusations around. Because of those concerns, she drafted the Declaration with six other Republican Senators. The statement declared that the country came first before the party and therefore a statement about the proceedings and their threat needed to be made. The Truman administration had not provided the necessary leadership and had not accepted the needed criticism about its response to communist threats. Some Republicans had added to the problem with smear campaigns. Those members and Democrats had unwittingly helped the communist efforts to attack US stability. She believed that we had to think of the US first instead of party loyalties when dealing with national security otherwise “totalitarian” techniques would end our system of government.

Key Quotes:

“Those of us who shout the loudest about Americanism in making character assassinations are all too frequently those who, by our own words and acts, ignore some of the basic principles of Americanism—The right to criticize; The right to hold unpopular beliefs; The right to protest; The right of independent thought.”

“Today our country is being psychologically divided by the confusion and the suspicions that are bred in the United States Senate to spread like cancerous tentacles of “know nothing, suspect everything” attitudes...”

“The Nation sorely needs a Republican victory. But I don't want to see the Republican Party ride to political victory on the four horsemen of calumny—fear, ignorance, bigotry and smear.”

“It is high time that we all stopped being tools and victims of totalitarian techniques—techniques that, if continued here unchecked, will surely end what we have come to cherish as the American way of life.”

Warsaw Security Pact

May 14, 1955

Summary: The treaty was also known as the “Treaty of Friendship, Cooperation and Mutual Assistance Between the People's Republic of Albania, the People's Republic of Bulgaria, the Hungarian People's Republic, the German Democratic Republic, the Polish People's Republic, the Rumanian People's Republic, the Union of Soviet Socialist Republics, and the Czechoslovak Republic.” It was a collective security agreement, but specifically stated it was not based on political systems. It stated that it was a reaction to the military alignment of Western Europe and the fact that West Germany was rebuilding its military capacity and joining NATO. That was seen as increasing the risk of war and showing a need for the existence of the Warsaw Pact. It claimed to have been guided by the principles of the UN Charter and has 11 Articles of agreement. The first article claimed to renounce the use of force to settle disputes. The second committed the members to support peaceful initiatives and reduce arms and nuclear weapons by agreement. The third stated the parties will consult each other over threats and the next article, like the fifth for NATO, committed the group to defending all others if any are attacked in Europe. It also claimed that the Security Council will be followed to settle disputes. Article five established a Joint Command and a commitment to build up defenses capabilities. Article six created a Political Consultative Committee to manage concerns and the seventh precluded any other agreements that ran counter to the Warsaw Pact agreements. Article eight promised economic cooperation and respect for internal sovereignty of each member. Article nine opened the agreement to add other nations and the next article stated that ratification of the agreement would be kept by the Polish government. The Poles would announce when each party ratified and when the treaty was in full effect. The final article stated that the pact would last for 20 years and if no member sought to withdraw at least a year prior to that, it would extend 10 more years. The pact would cease to exist if a General European Treaty of Collective Security is created.

Key Quotes:

“(Article IV) In the event of armed attack in Europe on one or more of the Parties to the Treaty by any state or group of states, each of the Parties to the Treaty, in the exercise of its right to individual or collective self-defence in accordance with Article 51 of the Charter of the United Nations Organization, shall immediately, either individually or in agreement with other Parties to the Treaty, come to the assistance of the state or states attacked with all such means as it deems necessary, including armed force.”

“(Article XI) Should a system of collective security be established in Europe, and a General European Treaty of Collective Security concluded for this purpose, for which the Contracting Parties will unswervingly strive, the present Treaty shall cease to be operative from the day the General European Treaty enters into force.”

Khrushchev's Address to the 20th Party Congress

February 25, 1956

Summary: Also known as the “Secret Speech” this address by Nikita Khrushchev was the beginning of the official de-Stalinization effort in the Soviet bloc. The speech was several hours long, led to gasps amongst the audience, and purportedly caused heart attacks due to its surprisingly inflammatory nature. Khrushchev denounced the “cult of personality” around Stalin and the “perversions” it caused to the party. His use of arbitrary terror was emulated and spread by others. Arrests, deportations, and executions were numerous and many who suffered were not enemies, but loyal party members that broke down and eventually admitted to false charges. After true enemies were eliminated, Stalin continued to purge

workers and party members through mass terror and the NKVD. He had become paranoid and his suspicions were not based on any evidence, but were immediately accepted on faith.

Key Quotes:

“Quite a lot has been said about the cult of the individual and about its harmful consequences. ... The cult of the person of Stalin ... became at a certain specific stage the source of a whole series of exceedingly serious and grave perversions of party principles, of party democracy, of revolutionary legality.”

Zhou Enlai Discussion with Nehru Concerning Hungary

December 3, 1956

Summary: This conversation between the premier of the PRC and the Prime Minister of India came after the Soviet-led invasion of Hungary to suppress the revolution that began in late October. Zhou reported back to Beijing about Nehru’s impressions. Nehru heard from his ambassadors in Hungary and Yugoslavia that the people of Hungary were still unhappy and were taking part in slow-downs at work. Zhou informed him that he believed the situation there was improving and that the new government led by János Kádár was fixing problems. The Soviet invasion had worsened the situation and according to Zhou, Kádár had sought to work with Imre Nagy, but the USSR sent him to Romania. The UN wanted to investigate the situation in Hungary. Nehru believed that Hungary would lose sympathy amongst countries if the Secretary General, Dag Hammarskjöld, was not allowed in. The UN may not recognize the Kádár government. Zhou gave Nehru his version of the revolution stating that it was led by “reactionary forces” aided by Western countries. He compared Nagy to Wang Jingwei in 1927 China which justified Kádár and the Soviet’s response. The “reactionaries” massacred socialists and without USSR intervention, Hungary would have been lost. Nehru agreed that there was Western influence, but the invasion and the removal of Nagy was not looked upon favorably by the rest of the world. Zhou responded that if the Soviets didn’t invade then Hungary would have been lost to the West. Yugoslavia helped shield Nagy and disapproved of the invasion, but supported Kádár’s government which was a contradiction in terms and secretly China did not support Yugoslavia’s government in general. China would have arrested Nagy or let him go to the West. Zhou believed socialist countries could work to improve themselves, but they had to stand together in the face of Western interference. Nehru ended the conversation by reiterating that Hungary should respond to the UN requests and Zhou agreed to share his thoughts with Kádár. Zhou also believed the conversation should be shared with the USSR.

Soviet Foreign Ministry Analysis of Third World Reaction to Hungary and Suez

December 28, 1956

Summary:

I. Reactions to UK in Egypt

This analysis was made for the Foreign Ministry in the USSR on the reactions by the governments of India, Pakistan, Burma (Myanmar), Ceylon (Sri Lanka), and Indonesia (collectively referred to as Colombo countries) towards the superpowers and their relative involvement in Hungary and Egypt. Anti-English feelings increased significantly as a result of the invasion of the Suez Canal area by the English and French troops.

India's Chakravarti Rajagopalachari suggested the country leave the Commonwealth if the UK rejected the UN decision to withdraw troops. Pakistan and Ceylon had similar motions. Nehru said that India would not withdraw and was not considering sanctions. Ceylon’s PM, Bandaranaike, agreed.

President Iskander Mirza of Pakistan was also cautious about his country’s reaction. These reactions were regarded as not surprising considering their strong economic ties to the UK (30% of all money in the Indian economy came from the UK). There were still many English in government offices and the armed forces in those countries. This was explained by the belief that the “bourgeois and land-owning circles” wanted to stay connected with the UK. As such, when the UK began to withdraw

from Egypt, most criticism stopped. The overall prestige of the UK had still been damaged as a result of the crisis.

II. Reaction to USSR in Hungary

Hostility towards the USSR had increased in the Colombo Countries, especially in Pakistan and Burma. The invasion was compared to the Western activities in Egypt. The PMs of India, Burma, Ceylon, and Indonesia declared their united stance against aggression by strong countries against weaker ones in violation of the UN Charter and the Bandung Conference. They called for a withdrawal of troops from Hungary and self-determination for the people. Pakistan co-authored a UN resolution to intervene in Hungary and Burma considered sanctions against the USSR. These stances mirrored those of Yugoslavia on the Hungary situation. Nehru had previously stated his belief in Tito's assessment of European affairs. Nehru's displeasure was relayed to Chou (Zhou) Enlai, specifically about how Nagy was treated.

The press in those countries had become more hostile to Soviet foreign policy and Burma's PM went so far as to say it was undermining the UN. Nehru stated that the five principles of peaceful international relations were being ignored by powerful countries. Those feelings were believed to be connected to the USSR not fulfilling trade promises and contracts. Those tensions had not stopped relations with the PRC from growing amongst these countries.

III. Reaction to the US response

The US response had increased its prestige in Asia. It was seen as a peacemaker in Egypt. Eisenhower's reelection was reported favorably and as a safeguard for peace.

There was discussion about warmer relations with the US. The US previously agreed to resume aid to India and provide steel for railroad reconstruction. There were also agreements made for loans and grants of agricultural supplies. Those efforts had been made to try and foster an Indo-American treaty. Nehru agreed to visit the US in December after previously avoiding such a visit. Nehru spoke warmly of the US while there, though no agreements were made. He specifically mentioned the "morally leading" role of the US in the recent crises.

Those changes in perception were seen as possibly leading to stronger ties and warmer relations between the US and India. The US also discussed increasing aid to Pakistan and Burma. Burma had rejected previous offers, but it appeared that their attitude was changing.

Key Quotes:

"In the memorandum of the Indian Government handed to Comrade GROMYKO on 17 December 1956, the current position of the Soviet Union is judged in its essentials, and it is asserted that 'the events in Hungary shatter the belief of millions of people, who had begun to view the USSR as the defender of peace and rights of the weakest people.'"

Speech at the Moscow Conference of Communist and Workers' Parties by Mao

Zedong

November 18, 1957

Summary: This speech was made near the apex of Sino-Soviet relations. It was known as the "East Wind Over West," and described how Mao believed socialist countries were beginning to overtake capitalist ones. It dealt with the turning point in history that was the result of the previous turning point of the October Revolution in 1917. Another turning point had been when the Nazis were defeated at Stalingrad and the tide of WWII changed in favor of the USSR. The West tried to insult the socialist bloc based on the Hungarian Revolution, but the USSR was strong enough to stop the Suez Crisis with a single telegram threatening intervention.

Mao stated that the current year of 1957, was a turning point due to the launch of sputniks. He joked that US Secretary of State, Dulles, had to take a sleep aid due to the success of the current international party meeting in Moscow. Some still stated that the US was powerful and had more steel and weapons. He believed that Radio Free Europe and Voice of America lied about the US strength. Mao believed the fraud needed to be revealed and he had a plan to show the East's dominance over the West.

His first point of evidence was that despite US and British dominance over the USSR in steel during WWII they had to ask for Soviet help. The Soviets helped and the region of Europe they liberated joined them in socialism. This proved that it was not the quantity of material, but the quality of people and their system that made the difference. The West asked for help with Japan as well and gave the Soviets large amounts of territory in Asia for their effort.

The second point for Mao was that Chinese communists were so strong that Truman would not support his “son” Chiang Kai-shek. He next focused on Korea. He stated that despite overwhelming artillery advantages the Chinese forces helped Kim Il Sung’s troops push the US forces back to the 38th parallel from the Yalu. The US also had air superiority, but asked for peace. They agreed to come under white flags to negotiate for three years. First, they came to Kaesong and then to Panmunjom. He stated that after delaying, a breakthrough by communist forces caused the US to sign a peace agreement in 1953. It was only three armies (China, North Korea, and the USSR sending supplies) versus sixteen.

His fourth proof was the Vietnam War. The French were routed by Ho Chi Minh’s troops and despite the US wanting the French to continue to fight, they could not. This caused them both to agree to give Ho Chi Minh over half of the country at the Geneva Conference. Mao next moved on to the Suez Crisis. The UK and France had a lot of steel, but stopped fighting after a few days after just “a word” from the USSR. The entire world also spoke against them. He claimed the same was happening in Syria.

The seventh proof was the launch of the two sputniks. The US has twice as much steel as the USSR, but could not launch “a single potato.” All these points showed the West was far behind and was forever going to be. The US may launch a satellite, but they will remain behind.

China produced 5200 thousand tons of steel in a year and would have twelve million in five years and twenty-five million in another five, according to Mao. They planned to reach 45 million tons. Khrushchev has committed the USSR to overtake the US in production in fifteen years. Mao committed China to surpass the UK in the same timeframe. Mao sought a period of peace so that once they achieved his goals no one could threaten them.

Mao stated that there could be a nuclear attack during that time. Chinese leaders feared starting a war without having their own nuclear weapons, but Mao rebutted that the “elder brother” (USSR) had them. He then relayed his thoughts about war with atomic bombs. He said it was not so terrifying. He believed 900 million people ($\frac{1}{3}$ of the current population) may perish, but even if half died the other half would carry on, but imperialism would be destroyed. He had a similar discussion with Nehru of India. Mao believed socialism would win over the world and after a century or so the world would start to recover. In that situation, China would end construction to go to war and then begin construction again.

His final three points were that England had been forced to retreat from its Asian colonies, Holland left Indonesia, and France was leaving Africa. He compared imperialism to the setting sun and communism to a rising one. The East would prevail and not because of material such as steel, but because of the power and beliefs of its people.

Key Quotes:

“Can one estimate how many people would be lost in a future war? Possibly, it would be one third of the whole world’s population of 2700 million, or just 900 million people. I think this is even too few if the atomic bombs are really dropped. Of course, this is very scary. But it would not be that bad even if it were a half. Why? Because we did not want it, and they are imposing a war on us. If we go to war, atomic and hydrogen weapons will be used. I personally think that the entire world will suffer, if a half of the human kind, or more than a half, die. I argued this question with Nehru. He is more pessimistic than I in this respect. I told him: if half of the human kind is destroyed, the other half will still remain, but imperialism will be destroyed completely, and there will just be socialism in the entire world, and in half-a-century or a whole century the population will grow again, even by more than a half.”

“Inevitably, the East Wind will prevail over the West Wind, because we are stronger. That is, the question is being decided not by the amount of steel. The question is being decided by the attitude of the people.”

The U-2 Incident

May 6-11, 1960

Summary: This is a collection of statements from the US State Department after a U-2 spy plane was shot down over Soviet airspace. The US, at first, assumed the pilot, Gary Powers, had died during the event and had to change its response as evidence came to light that not only the pilot, but the plane had been recovered by the Soviets.

May 6th: The US acknowledged that Khrushchev had correctly claimed a US aircraft was shot down over Soviet-airspace. The US stated it was a NASA aircraft doing weather research and based in Turkey. The pilot was a civilian, Francis Gary Powers, and the US requested information on the fate of the pilot.

May 7th: The US acknowledged that there was a U-2 plane missing and, based on Khrushchev's recent statement, that was the aircraft that had been shot down. No U-2 flights over the USSR had been authorized. The civilian flight appeared to have been trying to gather information based on the lack of available information from behind the Iron Curtain. Flights were caused by the abnormal levels of Soviet secrecy. It stated that the US had offered an "open skies" policy to eliminate the threat of surprise attacks that keep the world so tense. The USSR rejected that offer.

May 9th (Statement by Secretary of State, Christian A. Herter): The world had feared a Soviet attack since Stalin stopped being an ally to the West based on actions such as the Berlin Blockade, the takeover of Czechoslovakia, and the communist actions in Korea and Vietnam. The Soviets had access to the West via spies and its innate openness, whereas the East kept their weapons of mass destruction secret and they made constant threats.

The West has proposed elimination of those threats such as through open-skies and an observer exchange program. Disarmament had also been proposed at the Geneva Convention. The USSR may have feared the West, but they had done nothing to help lessen that fear. The US would not allow the USSR to operate freely without any knowledge available for the West to protect itself. The National Security Act mandated that the president gather such intelligence. Flights to gather information had not been subject to presidential authorization and the Soviets were aware of those flights by unarmed civilian aircraft.

The US hoped discussions about openness would continue at the planned Paris Conference with the USSR. The incident could be an inflection point rather than stopping cooperation. The head of the CIA was going to brief Congress on the event that same day.

May 10th (Soviet response): The USSR shot down a military aircraft as punishment for violating its airspace on May 1st. There was proof that it was a US plane stationed in Turkey that came via Pakistan. It was equipped with espionage equipment to gather data on Soviet radar capabilities.

The pilot was alive and would be tried under Soviet law. His documents showed that he had traveled from Turkey to Pakistan across Russia to Norway. That information proved the State Department's initial report that he lost his way while making weather observations was an obvious cover.

The State Department then admitted the truth and based the flight on the rejection of the open-skies initiative. The USSR rejected such invasions as any nation would. The May 7th statement showed that the US had a policy of such intrusions and had never tried to stop such flights.

Allowing those flights is what increased tensions. The US could not claim to be seeking an end to tensions by taking such a position. The Soviet military would continue to defend against such invasions. When Khrushchev visited the US, the Soviet people believed better relations were possible, but those flights showed the US wanted to return relations to the "worst times."

If such aggressive actions continued the USSR would be forced to retaliate and the responsibility would rest on the aggressors. The USSR hoped the US government would seek peace instead and cease "dangerous provocative activities."

May 11th (Statement by President Eisenhower): Eisenhower had four main points to add to the Secretary of State's statement. First, intelligence gathering was needed because no one wanted another

Pearl Harbor. The safety of the world was in jeopardy because of the abnormal secrecy of the USSR. He had approved gathering intelligence to prevent a sneak attack.

Secondly, those types of activities were secret and had to be in order to be successful. They were approved in general and not specifically and did not involve the military. That was in order to avoid any chance of force being used.

Thirdly, the activities were “distasteful,” but necessary if there were not open societies. That was the reasoning behind the open-skies plan which was to be proposed again in Paris.

Finally, the situation was not meant to distract from the larger more important issues such as disarmament, dealing with Berlin, and greater East-West relations.

May 11th (US note to USSR): The US had a “calculated policy” of flights for “defensive purposes.” It did not deny that, but denied that the policy and flights were aggressive in any way. The US was still prepared to take part in the Paris Conference on the 16th to discuss issues that would make those flights to protect against attack unnecessary

Key Quotes:

“One must ask, how is it possible to reconcile this with declarations on the part of leading figures of the United States of America, that the Government of the United States of America, like the Soviet Government, also strives for improvement of relations between the Union of Soviet Socialist Republics and the United States of America, for relaxation of international tension, and strengthening of trust between states. Military intelligence activities of one nation by means of intrusion of its aircraft into the area of another country can hardly be called a method for improving relations and strengthening trust.”

“No one wants another Pearl Harbor. This means that we must have knowledge of military forces and preparations around the world, especially those capable of massive surprise attack. Secrecy in the Soviet Union makes this essential. In most of the world no large-scale attack could be prepared in secret. But in the Soviet Union there is a fetish of secrecy and concealment. This is a major cause of international tension and uneasiness today. Our deterrent must never be placed in jeopardy. The safety of the whole free world demands this.”

Farewell Address by Dwight Eisenhower

January 17, 1961

Summary: The President spoke on television three days before the end of his second term. He gave a frank warning about the continued commitment by the US to increased spending for the military and related areas. He wished his successor, JFK, success and hoped that his own long relationship with Congress, that grew over time, was successful on the major issues.

The US had gained a position of preeminence after all the wars the century had seen, but it must use that position for peace and the betterment of humankind. The US government's purpose had always been to keep the peace, and push for liberty and progress. The cold war threatened those goals. It colored all aspects of life and needed to be met for as long as it lasted. To meet that threat, and the constant crises that come with it, some might push for a “miraculous solution” that involves an unrealistic military or domestic program. Such ideas needed to be met with a commitment to a balance in government being maintained. The US had done this, but with new threats an imbalance could easily occur. Two main threats were worth mentioning.

Military strength is essential to deter attacks, but the growth of the US military was beyond anything even seen during WWII and Korea. There was an arms industry that previously did not exist. At the time, millions worked in the defense industry and the US government spent more on the military than all the profits of all US businesses. The influence of those factors had grown and was felt across the country. The influence of this military-industrial complex had to be limited.

Technology and research of new technology had also grown exceptionally influential. The government had supported that growth. That relationship was important, but could cause influence by the “scientific-technological” elite on public policy.

The US must also keep an eye to the future and not just focus on current problems and recklessly use up resources. The future world would hopefully be one of trust and not hate, but that could only be accomplished by inviting all parts of the world as equals. That could be obtained by not focusing on military solutions, but on peaceful ones. Disarmament needed to be a continued goal. Not achieving more in that field was disappointing. War was avoided, but peace was not in sight because nuclear weapons posed such a danger. The US continued to hope that all people of the world could have peace and have all their “human needs satisfied.”

Key Quotes:

“In the councils of government, we must guard against the acquisition of unwarranted influence, whether sought or unsought, by the military-industrial complex. The potential for the disastrous rise of misplaced power exists and will persist. We must never let the weight of this combination endanger our liberties or democratic processes. We should take nothing for granted. Only an alert and knowledgeable citizenry can compel the proper meshing of the huge industrial and military machinery of defense with our peaceful methods and goals, so that security and liberty may prosper together.”

“As we peer into society's future, we -- you and I, and our government -- must avoid the impulse to live only for today, plundering, for our own ease and convenience, the precious resources of tomorrow. We cannot mortgage the material assets of our grandchildren without risking the loss also of their political and spiritual heritage. We want democracy to survive for all generations to come, not to become the insolvent phantom of tomorrow.”

Arguments against the Bay of Pigs Invasion by Chester Bowles

March 31, 1961

Summary: The Bay of Pigs invasion was launched on April 17, 1961. It had been planned under the Eisenhower administration and continued under the new Kennedy administration via their shared CIA director, Allen Dulles. Kennedy decided to continue the plan, but limited the US involvement. Around 1,300 Cuban exiles were trained by the CIA for the invasion, and they hoped that their fellow Cubans would join them. The plan was a disaster due to poor execution and a lack of air support from the US and popular support from Cubans. The Undersecretary of State, Chester Bowles, sent his misgivings about the plan to Secretary Rusk prior to the operation.

He believed the US interests and goals were stated by JFK to be based on principles which run counter to using covert operations. The Cold War required some extreme measures, but the planned invasion blurred the line between US decency and acts attributed to the Soviets.

The plan blatantly violated the Organization of American States Charter by intervening in another country's affairs. Going against that central tenet would endanger the other agreements based on the OAS. The chances of success were one out of three and failure would be a great boon to Castro and his prestige. The military felt that a much larger commitment by the US was needed to make the plan successful. Such a plan would lead to riots against the US across Latin America. The rest of the world would also have a negative reaction and it would hurt the prospects of the new administration achieving cooperation.

The other issue to consider was what would happen to Castro if the plan did not take place. Castro's communist efforts could fail on their own. If the USSR stepped in the US could blockade the country. A blockade was an act of war, but the technicalities could be dealt with as a defense against a possible Soviet base. If Castro did succeed, he might invade another nation and the US would be free to step in.

The reputation of the US had grown due to the new administration, especially in Africa and Latin America, and it could have continued to grow in Asia, if cultivated. That opportunity could be lost by an invasion of Cuba. Despite the intense preparation for the invasion, preparation alone did not justify going through with a mission. If Rusk were to talk about the operation with people of varying perspectives, they might have believed the plan was too dangerous and his advice to JFK could have caused it to be scuttled.

Key Quotes:

“Those most familiar with the Cuban operation seem to agree that as the venture is now planned, the chances of success are not greater than one out of three. This makes it a highly risky operation. If it fails, Castro's prestige and strength will be greatly enhanced.”

“I realize that this operation has been put together over a period of months. A great deal of time and money has been put into it, and many able and dedicated people have become emotionally involved in its success. We should not, however, proceed with this adventure simply because we are wound up and cannot stop.”

Letter from Chairman Khrushchev to President Kennedy

October 27, 1962

Summary: Chairman Khrushchev sent a second letter to President Kennedy concerning the crisis occurring in Cuba over the presence of Soviet nuclear missiles. The previous day he had asked only for a promise by the US not to invade Cuba in exchange for removing the missiles. This new letter required that missiles in Turkey also be removed. It significantly ratcheted up the tension since a blockade was already in place and an agreement that seemed likely was suddenly very much in doubt.

Khrushchev wrote that Kennedy's proposal to use the UN General Secretary U Thant as an intermediary was a strong step towards deescalation. The USSR was only focused on improving peace and quality of life in the world. Khrushchev believed that making sure the US and USSR ships had an agreed upon method of interaction was important for peace, but the greater goal was to end the crisis. The Soviet Union wanted to help Cuba and there needed to be no doubt in that. Just as the US sought security, Cuba deserved security. The USSR needed to be secure and the US had surrounded it with bases and missiles (Britain, Italy, Turkey). Cuba was only 90 miles from the US and Kennedy stated he was disturbed by missiles being there, but the US had missiles in Turkey which shared a border with the USSR. The situation would be easy to resolve if everyone was truly seeking peace.

Khrushchev's proposal was that the USSR would remove all weapons the US had deemed “offensive” if the US would remove the same from Turkey. The UN Security Council could appoint inspectors to confirm the removal after agreements by Cuba and Turkey. The Soviet Union would then issue a statement through the Security Council that it recognized Turkey's territory as sovereign and its borders as inviolable. The US would need to do the same for Cuba and pledge to not interfere in its internal affairs. That could all take place within a month.

Khrushchev asserted that the missiles in Cuba were controlled by Soviets and for defense only so there was no threat of them in the meantime unless the US invaded. Representatives needed to be sent to the UN to make the agreement and end the crisis.

Khrushchev stated he was making this agreement for the sake of the world. It could be used as a beginning for more discussions such as nuclear testing limits. Other issues could also be solved with such discussions and help the tensions in the world.

Key Quotes:

"You are disturbed over Cuba. You say that this disturbs you because it is 90 miles by sea from the coast of the United States of America. But Turkey adjoins us; our sentries patrol back and forth and see each other. Do you consider, then, that you have the right to demand security for your own country and the removal of the weapons you call offensive, but do not accord the same right to us? You have placed destructive missile weapons, which you call offensive, in Turkey, literally next to us. How then can recognition of our equal military capacities be reconciled with such unequal relations between our great states? This is irreconcilable."

"Ich Bin Ein Berliner" Speech**June 26, 1963**

Summary: President Kennedy arrived in Berlin to show direct US support for the Western enclave in communist territory after the Berlin Wall had existed for almost two years. The people, including Mayor Willy Brandt, had harsh words for the lack of a US response when the wall was first erected. Kennedy sought to show a firm commitment to the city. He attended with General Clay from the US who had served there during the height of tensions after the wall was built in late 1961.

Kennedy stated repeatedly that Berlin was the center of the Cold War. He used the phrase "Let them come to Berlin." This was to show that from all perspectives about the Cold War, it was impossible to understand without understanding Berlin. He referred to the wall as showing that communism had to trap its people inside. The wall was a sign of the system's failures. He claimed that the US was proud of its commitment to such a vibrant city that had survived so much for so long (18 years/since 1945).

Kennedy said Berlin was like Germany and must be made whole for there to be lasting peace. He asked Berliners to look to the future and that they were helping advance freedom around the world. They were going to be remembered as being in the "front lines" in the march for freedom for everyone in the world.

Key Quotes:

"Two thousand years ago the proudest boast was 'civis Romanus sum.' Today, in the world of freedom, the proudest boast is 'Ich bin ein Berliner.'"

"While the wall is the most obvious and vivid demonstration of the failures of the Communist system, for all the world to see, we take no satisfaction in it, for it is, as your Mayor has said, an offense not only against history but an offense against humanity, separating families, dividing husbands and wives and brothers and sisters, and dividing a people who wish to be joined together."

"All free men, wherever they may live, are citizens of Berlin, and, therefore, as a free man, I take pride in the words 'Ich bin ein Berliner.'"

Gulf of Tonkin Incident**August 1964**

Summary: This contains a message from President Lyndon Johnson to Congress about the purported attack by North Vietnamese forces against the US Navy which would later come under scrutiny. It asked for power to execute military activities beyond what was traditionally the purview of the executive branch. It also included the congressional response in the form of the Gulf of Tonkin Resolution.

August 5th (President Johnson's Message to Congress): Johnson addressed Congress by stating the particulars of the response to the attack against the US Navy by the North Vietnamese. He also asked for additional action from Congress to authorize further actions against North Vietnam. He covered the background of US involvement in the area. SEATO was established in 1955 which obligated the US to help "meet Communist aggression." He believed the US needed to meet its obligations and threats in that

region or the situation would threaten all the countries in Asia and the US. He believed the US was focused on peace and the Vietnam conflict was critical to maintaining freedom in Laos and South Vietnam. North Vietnam had supported subversive activities in the South and had violated the Geneva Agreements of 1962, in numerous ways via its activities in Laos and South Vietnam.

This information was used to justify Congress in allowing Johnson and the military to expand their activities in executing their plan to defend against Communist activities. He wanted to make it clear that the US was there to defend freedom and sought no territory and only wanted to uphold the Geneva Agreements.

August 7th (Joint Resolution of Congress 1145):

Section 1. Congress supports the President's efforts to defend US forces from attack.

Section 2. The US is committed to upholding the Constitution, the UN Charter, and its commitments to the Southeast Asia Collective Defense Treaty through "all necessary steps" as determined by the President.

Section 3. The resolution will last until the President believes peace has been achieved or by Congressional resolution.

Key Quotes:

"...the United States is, therefore, prepared, as the President determines, to take all necessary steps, including the use of armed force..."

"This resolution shall expire when the President shall determine that the peace and security of the area is reasonably assured by international conditions created by action of the United Nations or otherwise, except that it may be terminated earlier by concurrent resolution of the Congress."

US State Department Paper on Support for South Vietnam

February 27, 1965

Summary: This is a policy paper produced by the State Department for US leaders. It included justifications for continuing support of the South Vietnamese government and attacks against Communist elements.

The paper stated that the conflict in Vietnam is different than any in the past. It had distinct differences from Communist efforts in Greece, Malaya, and the Philippines. It had similarities, but was distinct in that a separate state was seeking its downfall. North Vietnam was similar to North Korea in its desire for all of the country to the south. The North had tried to hide its involvement, but it was obvious.

Evidence shows that Communist in the South were trained in the North. Vietcong (VC) troops are supplied by the North. The Lao Dong (Workers Party) in the North was directing the VC. The operation was run through the Central Office for South Vietnam and the Liberation Front for South Vietnam was used to create a false impression that the forces in the South were from the South. The State Department issued "A Threat to the Peace" in 1961, where it declared that it had evidence corroborated by the International Control Commission that North Vietnam was sending troops and supplies into the South in violation of the Geneva Accords of 1954. More evidence had been gathered and it needed to be shown to US citizens and the world. The evidence showed the effort was growing and proved that the Hanoi government was attacking the South. The US was helping the South resist the attack and would "not abandon friends who want to remain free." Only Hanoi could make the choice for peace.

Telegram from Ambassador Bohlen to the State Department

May 20, 1965

Summary: Ambassador to France Charles Bohlen wrote to the US State Department after French President Charles De Gaulle had made remarks surrounding the 20th anniversary of the Yalta Conference at La Roche-Sur Yon. He related his discussions with the French Minister of Foreign Affairs, Jacques-Maurice Couve de Murville.

Bohlen told Cove de Murville that he was displeased with De Gaulle's comments about Yalta being the cause of Cold War divisions. He stated that the US position at Yalta in the "Declaration on Liberated Europe" showed Yalta was meant to prevent such divisions. Bohlen further voiced his displeasure with the French policies concerning alliances and that the opinion of the US public could sour on France in the event of a military confrontation in Europe. Nothing was agreed to, but Bohlen believed he made an impact on the Foreign Minister.

Letter from Ho Chi Minh to President Johnson

February 1967

Summary: The North Vietnamese leader, Ho Chi Minh, responded to President Johnson's request for negotiations by stating his position that the US must stop its bombing campaigns in the North for talks to begin.

He stated that Vietnam had never been a threat to the US and was far away. The US had involved itself in the Vietnam conflict and perpetuated two states in a region that should have been united. That, and the last two years of US attacks on the North violated the Geneva Agreement. That was an attack against socialism in the world and the people of Asia. Vietnam was fighting for independence and peace and was supported by much of the world and even people in the US.

The aggression via bombing against the North had to end for peace. The US needed to withdraw its troops and recognize the South Vietnam National Front for Liberation. The Geneva agreement created a situation where the Vietnamese people could settle their own affairs. If there were to be talks the US had to stop all bombing and attacks against the North. Force could not be the reason for talks.

Key Quotes:

"It is only after the unconditional cessation of US bombing raids and all other acts of war against the Democratic Republic of Vietnam that the Democratic Republic of Vietnam and the US could enter into talks and discuss questions concerning the two sides. The Vietnamese people will never submit to force, they will never accept talks under threat of bombs."

Brezhnev Doctrine

November 12, 1968

Summary: Secretary Leonid Brezhnev spoke to the Communist Party of Poland (the Polish United Workers Party) less than three months after the Warsaw Pact invaded Czechoslovakia to end the Prague Spring. It had been deemed "deviationist" and a threat to the socialist world. He stated that a move by a country towards capitalism that threatened other socialist countries justified intervention by the Soviet Union and its allies.

Brezhnev remarked that the situation in Czechoslovakia required focus from the socialist world. It made sense that some would argue the response was not in line with Marxist principles concerning self determination. He believed people should have rights, but not the ability to damage socialism which would harm all working classes. Each communist party was responsible to its people and the overall movement, but he claimed that Marxism was about the entire movement and that Lenin had stated every socialist had a responsibility to all others.

Brezhnev believed socialists should refrain from “exporting revolution” and fight imperialist efforts to violate the sovereignty of nations. Each socialist country also had a right to develop its own form of Marxism-Leninism, but must remain communist. He saw his view as similar to what Lenin believed; there were only two sides in the world struggle. A person had to support the class struggle or by default, they supported imperialism through action or inaction.

A socialist country could only become “non-affiliated” with communism on the strength of the other socialist countries' protection, but it would weaken those same countries. Czechoslovakia's departure from the socialist bloc would have weakened its people and those of the entire bloc. The Warsaw nations had to intervene to defend themselves and the Czech people.

Key Quotes:

“However, the implementation of such ‘self-determination,’ in other words, Czechoslovakia's detachment from the socialist community, would have come into conflict with its own vital interests and would have been detrimental to the other socialist states.”

“Discharging their internationalist duty toward the fraternal peoples of Czechoslovakia and defending their own socialist gains, the U.S.S.R. and the other socialist states had to act decisively and they did act against the antisocialist forces in Czechoslovakia.”

“Letter of Invitation” from Czechoslovakian Communists

August 3, 1968

Summary: The hard-liners in the Czech Communist Party passed a letter to Chairman Brezhnev at a meeting in Bratislava asking for military intervention against the government that had headed the Prague Spring movement. The letter would be used as a justification for the Warsaw Pact intervention.

The five authors wrote directly to Brezhnev. Reforms in the country proceeded out of control of the party. The press had been controlled by the right wing and fostered opposition to the party and created instability in the country. The leadership of the party made mistakes that deviated from Marxist-Leninist beliefs and was unable to survive against reactionary forces. A coup by right-wing forces seemed likely.

The situation, according to the letter, necessitated Soviet intervention. Without assistance it seemed the Czech state would be lost to counterrevolution. They realized the response would not be easy, but after all other efforts were used by the Party in Czechoslovakia, it was the only remaining chance. They then asked that their request be kept secret, and the document be read quickly (which is why it was written in Russian).

Key Quotes:

“The press, radio, and television, which are effectively in the hands of right-wing forces, have influenced popular opinion to such an extent that elements hostile to the Party have begun to take part in the political life of our country, without any opposition from the public. These elements are fomenting a wave of nationalism and chauvinism, and are provoking an anti-Communist and anti-Soviet psychosis.”

Memorandum on US Actions in Chile

September 1970

Summary: The document collects the actions that were being undertaken and planned by the CIA against the government of Chile at the request of President Nixon. It involved propaganda efforts, coordination with the military-led Argentinian government, and efforts to support a coup in Chile to keep Salvador Allende from becoming president.

Two units were created under the 40 Committee (Executive committee on secret activities) and given chiefs. Additional officers were added to the groups already in place. The newspaper, *El Mercurio*, was supported to spread anti-Allende stories. A military coup was being planned and required outgoing-President Frei Montalva's support. A leader of the coup was being looked for. Propaganda efforts were being made in surrounding countries to make it appear that Allende may not become president. There was an attempt to expose communist efforts to control the media in Chile. Possible economic pressure strategies were being analyzed. A coup was being supported and attempts were being made to contact Frei and have him keep Allende from assuming the presidency.

War Powers Act

1973

Summary: The end of the US involvement in Southeast Asia led to recriminations about why, what was seen as adventurism by some, was left unchecked. The War Powers Act was an answer to the nearly unlimited ability of the president to use military forces around the world without the consent of Congress, which constitutionally held the power to declare war. As the Watergate controversy continued to spread, it seemed even more unwise to have a president that operated too far outside of a rigid system of checks and balances. President Nixon vetoed the War Powers Act, but it was overridden and became law. It has yet to be used to limit a military operation.

Public Law 93-148 concerning the war powers of the Congress and the President was known as the War Powers Resolution. Its purpose was to reassert the congressional authority to lend its judgement to military activities. Constitutionally, the President can use US forces after a declaration of war, when given authorization by Congress, and if the US is attacked. The President should consult Congress whenever possible about military involvement.

If there is not a situation that constitutionally authorizes the President to use US troops, they may be deployed, but the Speaker of the House and President pro tempore must be informed within 48 hours. The notice must give the reasons why the forces are being used and how they plan to be used. Congress may ask for additional information. The President must report updates to Congress on a regular basis (no longer than six months).

If Congress is not in session when notice is given, Congress may request the President to convene both houses. Within sixty days after the notice, the use of force must be ended unless Congress declares war, gives specific authorization, extends the sixty-day period, or cannot meet due to attack. Only thirty more days may be added to the period. Congress may direct the President to remove forces before the sixty days if war is not declared or authorization given.

An extension of the time through a joint resolution will begin in the Committee on Foreign Affairs in the House or Foreign Relations in the Senate. The resolution must be proposed no later than twenty-four days before the sixty day period ends. It will be voted on within three days after debate. The other house of Congress will receive the resolution no later than four days before the end of the original period. Differences between the houses will be dealt with before the end of the sixty day period. Concurrent resolutions will follow a similar pattern.

No previous law or subsequent treaty can change the procedure to introduce US Armed forces into hostilities. The law still allows joint coordination with allied armed forces. This law would not alter Presidential or Congressional authority under the Constitution. It does not give the President additional authority to use forces. Any part of the law that is held to be invalid would not cause the remainder of the law to be invalid.

Report on Seizure of US Embassy in Tehran

November 4, 1979

Summary: This is a news report from Reuters after students in Iran stormed the US Embassy and took the Americans inside hostage. The students were reacting to President Carter's announcement that the recently deposed Shah, Mohammed Riza Pahlevi, would be admitted into the US for cancer treatment. The students wanted him returned for trial. The Shah had been heavily supported by the US since a coup in 1953. Carter attempted a military rescue of the fifty-two remaining hostages on April 24, 1980, but complications led to a crash and the mission was aborted.

Reuters reported that about ninety Americans were captured in the Embassy in Tehran. The Ayatollah Khomeini issued a statement of support for the seizure. Iranian students in New York protested for the return of the Shah at the Statue of Liberty. Iranian Revolutionary Guards did not stop the students when they crashed the embassy gate. The attack was on the anniversary of protesting students being shot by security forces under the Shah.

Iran's government stated that the attack came from the US's "indifference" to the requests for the Shah. Staff in the embassy had been burning documents when the attack took place and students showed confiscated files to the press. They wore badges with a picture of the Ayatollah.

The Ayatollah gave anti-US speeches before the attack and stated that he hoped the Shah was dying of cancer. He was being treated in New York. In February, students also attacked the embassy and took 101 hostages for a short time, including the Ambassador and nineteen Marines.

The Shah said the US would be confronted for hosting the Shah and Britain would suffer for allowing the former Prime Minister, Shapur Bakhtiar, to enter their country.

The current PM, Mehdi Bazargan, was attacked in the press for his meeting with the US National Security Advisor, Zbigniew Brzezinski.

Soviet Message on the Invasion of Afghanistan

December 27, 1979

Summary: The statement by the Soviet government was meant to be used by diplomats in friendly nations (East Germany, Poland, Hungary, Czechoslovakia, Bulgaria, Cuba, Mongolia, and Vietnam) to explain the reasoning behind the recent invasion of Afghanistan by USSR troops.

From the Soviet perspective the situation in Afghanistan was deteriorating and the socialist government set up by the April Revolution of 1978, was under attack by outside forces supplying the counterrevolutionaries. Hafizullah Amin had overthrown Nur Mohammad Taraki as president and suppressed the socialist Parchamites and Khalqis.

The Afghan armed forces were trying to defeat Amin's forces to save the Revolution and the USSR decided to support this effort with military forces. Those forces were to be withdrawn when the threat ceased. The new government in Afghanistan that the USSR recognized requested intervention. The USSR viewed that as following the tenets of the 1978 Treaty of Friendship, Good Neighborliness, and Cooperation. The Soviets believed their actions were in line with the UN Charter and were limited to defense.

They believed some countries would attack their reasoning, but that was not a sufficient reason to refuse aid to Afghanistan or other socialist countries. The USSR hoped that friendly nations would support their actions and realize that the immediacy of the situation required action without consulting others.

Key Quotes:

"Considering all this and the request of the new Afghan leadership for aid and assistance in repelling foreign aggression, the Soviet Union, guided by its international duty, has decided to send limited Soviet military contingents to Afghanistan which will be withdrawn from there after the reasons which occasioned the necessity of this action disappear."

KGB Report on Indicators for a Surprise Nuclear Attack

November 26, 1984

Summary: This document was a list of signs, especially outside of normal intelligence gathering areas, sent to the KGB head in Berlin, that would indicate the possible preparation for a surprise nuclear attack by NATO against Warsaw Pact countries. KGB heads were to watch for such activities to report back to Moscow. This was used during the height of the Second Cold War tensions and dramatically increased chances of a nuclear exchange. The areas were divided into political, military, intelligence, civil defense, and economic.

Civil Defense: Main tasks that would show preparation for a nuclear strike: increased mobilization of civil defense agencies; shelter preparations; medical care procedures for a nuclear attack; evacuation of specialists; securing of cultural treasures.

Main indicators: activation of FEMA; activation of Western allies civil defense agencies; civil defense exercises; testing of communication system amongst allies; increasing protection and camouflage of civil defense installations; increased water and food reserves; expanding medical capacity; increasing blood donations; increasing medication stocks; plans for moving leaders of important businesses and services; preparing roads for evacuations; securing art and monuments.

Special indicators: Changes in FEMA especially transfers to regional operations; creation of 24-hour communications; clearing out of shelters; removal of radiation observation areas; checking functionality of ventilation and power of shelters; adding space to military hospitals; creating mobile military hospitals; increasing medical trainings; adding medical sites on evacuation routes; releasing sick people from hospitals; blood donation campaigns and publicity across the country; stocking up of blood supplies and spreading them out; recruitment of workers for blood donation; conducting vaccinations of workers; distributing personal protective equipment; evacuation families of military; dispersal of transportation equipment from target areas; preparation of mass evacuations; closing of museums and sites under pretext of construction or testing.

Mikhail Gorbachev speech to the UN

December 7, 1988

Summary: The first speech by General Secretary Gorbachev to the UN General Assembly in 1988 announced in large part an end to the Cold War from a Soviet perspective. He presented his plans for a reduction in Soviet forces, and the ending of attempts to directly control members of the Eastern Bloc.

He began by invoking the dramatic changes birthed by the French Revolution and the Russian Revolution and their continued impact on the world. He believed the modern world required a new path be created that takes the view of making progress for the entire world. The world had become more integrated and therefore “co-development” was now required for progress. Differences needed no longer push nations apart, but draw them together to provide mutual benefits from their unique qualities. In order to create a new world, old ideas had to be discarded. The threat of force could no longer be used for foreign policy goals.

Freedom of choice was stated by Gorbachev to be a universal principle for all. It was necessary to learn to live with differences and respect them without agreeing with them. It was necessary for the USSR to open up to other cultures to learn and have them learn. The Soviet Union was going through its own revolution. It was reassessing the past and moving forward with the knowledge from that reassessment to create a more democratic system. There would be risks from the restructuring and it could lead to separations, but it was necessary to move forward and gain strength. The USSR had begun and would continue giving its republics more autonomy.

Gorbachev remarked on recent laws and future ones that were allowing for more discussion and freedom to create organizations in the USSR. Freedom of travel was also to be reviewed and the “refusenik” situation was to be resolved. The jamming of foreign broadcasts would be reviewed through the Helsinki process and other issues would be addressed humanely.

He then announced that Soviet forces would be reduced by 500,000 and tank divisions would be withdrawn from the GDR, Czechoslovakia, and Hungary and the divisions would be disbanded by 1991. 50,000 troops would also be removed. The process of demilitarization would be used to spark the economy, and the USSR was willing to share its results with the world.

Next, Gorbachev addressed US/USSR relations. There were still disagreements, but the long era of hostility had ended. Both countries created the nuclear situation and both realized they must fix it. President Reagan and Secretary of State Shultz had improved relations and Gorbachev believed George Bush would continue that in his administrations without the “pauses and backward movements” of the past. The goal was a 50% reduction of offensive weapons and the elimination of chemical weapons in 1989. There was a movement toward disarmament, but it needed to be fostered so that it could reach its goal. The actions of the past were pushing the current governments and populations in ways that were dangerous and no longer needed. He concluded by discussing how momentous the year had been and that the future would see an end to this “era of wars,” by acting together.

Key Quotes:

“it is necessary to seek -- and then seek jointly -- an approach toward improving the international situation and building a new world. If that is so, then it is also worth agreeing on the fundamental and truly universal prerequisites and principles for such activities. It is evident, for example, that force and the threat of force can no longer be, and should not be, instruments of foreign policy.”

“The de-ideologization of interstate relations has become a demand of the new stage. We are not giving up our convictions, philosophy, or traditions. Neither are we calling on anyone else to give up theirs. Yet we are not going to shut ourselves up within the range of our values.”

The CIA and Guatemala

1994

Summary: The excerpts included in this document contain the outlines of operations conducted by the CIA in 1953-54 to overthrow the democratically-elected government of Guatemala. The umbrella operation was termed PBSUCCESS and was strongly supported by the Eisenhower administration and Secretary of State, John Foster Dulles, who had strong ties to the United Fruit Company and its extensive land holdings in Guatemala. The documents were released in 1994, giving details about the \$2.7 million dollar operation of “psychological warfare and political action.”

Chapter 1. America’s Backyard: PBSUCCESS was based on the positive outcomes for the US after it toppled Iran’s government in 1953, but was even more successful. A popular leader was replaced with a relative nobody. The rewards of this operation and the relative ease with which it was executed led to underestimations in the difficulty of similar operations that would lead to the Bay of Pigs failure.

The United Fruit Company had underreported and underpaid its tax values for previous Guatemalan governments and was not forced to respect the rights of its workers. In 1947, the government under Juan Arevalo allowed workers to unionize. United Fruit went to the State Department for help. They also employed Edward Bernays to push a narrative about a communist uprising in Guatemala in the US press. They began to support army officer Castillo Armas to plan a rebellion. UFC had a monopoly on communications and transportation in Central America that the Justice Department was seeking to end until 1951, when the Truman administration stopped the effort to support UFC’s anti-communist activities.

Chapter 2. Reversing the Trend: In 1951, Truman tripled the budget for propaganda due to the belief that advertising and psychological strategies or “psywar” could be used to solve problems across the globe. They would use rumors, pamphlets, posters, and subversive action. Radio had also been very influential for operations in Iran.

Business interests in the US would be convinced to cut imports and stop selling supplies to Guatemala and the OAS would be used to possibly add sanctions to coffee exports. All of these actions relied on the media buying the concept that Arbenz was actually a communist without question or hard evidence. The press, including the prominent editorialist, Walter Winchell, were so enthralled by the narrative that they pushed on the Eisenhower administration to do even more about the “threat.” When Arbenz gave evidence of a coup to topple him, it was dismissed by the media.

There were plans to finance Armas after the coup as well. Iran’s Shah had needed massive aid and the World Bank was ready to extend the same to Guatemala. There were also plans for bribes to make sure officials in the new authoritarian regime stayed loyal. The Arbenz government reacted to the propaganda operations against it with repression which made the previous myths of repressions become true.

Chapter 3: Sufficient Means: The main push of PBSUCCESS was the psychological pressure on the Arbenz government. The military aspect was secondary. Radio from Miami was used to influence the populace. The recordings were shipped to Panama and then to a secret location “SHERWOOD” after the Panama location was discovered.

When Arbenz bought arms from the Communist bloc, the press ramped up the “red scare” story and the coverage was influenced by meetings the CIA had with reporters. The French and British foreign offices also influenced their press to show the US in a positive light. Reporters that would not be influenced were removed from the country.

Opposition to the eventual Armas regime started to grow by 1956. On June 25th, government forces killed six protestors that were part of a student march. The US sent military advisors in 1966, to fight a growing rebellion effort in the eastern part of Guatemala. Violence and killings continued through the 70s as the Army clung to power.

UFC sold its land in Guatemala to Del Monte in 1972 and in 1975 was investigated for bribing the Honduran government. The president of the renamed United Brands, committed suicide by jumping from his office window. The fruit division is now Chiquita brand, and its Tropical Radio division is the major player in most Latin American mobile phone markets.

In the 1970s, review of government operations became an increasing focus of the public. The Pike and Church committees did not release information on operations in Guatemala, but former CIA operatives made several statements and even wrote books about their activities. Lewis Gulick requested declassified documents on PBSUCCESS in 1972, under the new Executive Order 11652, but was denied due to feared fallout of the revelations. More information continued to come out through leaks and other research.

Key Quotes:

“Following closely on the successful operations that installed the Shah as ruler of Iran, the Guatemala operation, known as PBSUCCESS, was both more ambitious and more thoroughly successful than either precedent.... In method, scale, and conception it had no antecedent, and its triumph confirmed the belief of many in the Eisenhower administration that covert operations offered a safe, inexpensive substitute for armed forces in resisting Communist inroads in the Third World. This and other ‘lessons’ of PBSUCCESS lulled Agency and administration officials into a complacency that proved fatal at the Bay of Pigs seven years later.”

“The New York Times warned that Communist arms would soon make their way along ‘secret jungle paths’ to guerrilla armies throughout the Hemisphere. ‘If Paul Revere were living today,’ Representative Paul Lantaff imagined, ‘he would view the landing of Red arms in Guatemala as a signal to ride.’ House Speaker John McCormack spluttered that ‘this cargo of arms is like an atom bomb planted in the rear of our backyard.’ These fulminations intensified the fears of many Guatemalans that the incident would provide convenient pretext for US intervention.”

Cold War Confrontations

Many of the major conflagrations that existed during the Cold War era were referred to as “proxy wars” based on the belief that despite the direct belligerents being of a largely local nature they were in reality acting as global representatives of the super powers. In reality, each confrontation was much more complex, but they all shared the trait of being shaped by the greater context of the Cold War. To understand the importance of each it is essential to recognize their unique origins, timeframes, key players, and how and why they were supported by varying countries or blocs within the global power structure of the Cold War.

Angolan Civil War

Background and Overview: Portugal’s right-wing authoritarian regime held onto its colonies longer than any other Western nation. As Africa saw independence movements spread, groups in Angolan began to agitate for their own freedom in the 1950s. The main war for independence began after strikes and revolution took place in the northern regions that shared a border with newly independent Belgian Congo. Three main groups fought against the Portuguese and each other for dominance: the People’s Movement for the Liberation of Angola (MPLA) which was founded in 1956; the National Front for Liberation of Angola (FNLA) founded in 1957; and the National Union for the Total Independence of Angola (UNITA) which came along in 1966. The MPLA was aligned with the Communist Party, while the others had some support from the US. Portugal was able to mainly contain them until the dictatorship of António de Oliveira Salazar was ended via a coup. The MPLA leveraged military support from Cuba and the USSR to hold the capital of Angola and with the Portuguese quickly departing, they declared independence on November 11, 1975. South Africa began supporting UNITA and FNLA and a civil war, which involved mercenaries committing war crimes, continued with various sides receiving aid from the US, USSR, and other Cold War powers.

Key Individuals/Groups:

Estado Novo, FNLA, MPLA, UNITA, Agostinho Neto, Holden Roberto, Jonas Savimbi, mercenaries, Costas Georgiou, José Eduardo dos Santos

Timeline of Key Events:

April 25, 1974 - Carnation Revolution in Portugal, colonial empire collapsed

October 14, 1975 - South African forces entered Angola to support UNITA as part of Operation Savannah

November 11, 1975- Independence of Angola was declared and Neto became the first president - FNLA retreated to Zaire

1976 - Cuban troops assisted in driving back UNITA, FNLA, and South African troops

May 1977 - Failed coup within the MPLA, group officially becomes Marxist-Leninist

September 10, 1979 - Agostinho Neto died and Jose Eduardo dos Santos took over as president

1982 - Talks between MPLA and South Africa began to discuss withdrawal

1986 - Supplies from the US for UNITA and from the USSR and Cuba for the MPLA reached new highs

1988 - South Africa agreed to Namibian independence in exchange for removal of Cuban troops from Angola

1989 - UNITA agreed to a short-lived cease-fire

April 1991 - MPLA dropped Marxism-Leninism - Dos Santos, Savimbi signed peace deal in Lisbon which resulted in a new multiparty constitution

May 31, 1991 - Lisbon peace accords were signed allowing for a multiparty government

September 29, 1992 - Open elections were held and Dos Santo won the presidency

September 26, 1993 - UN imposed sanctions against UNITA - US acknowledged the MPLA

November 20, 1994 - Government, UNITA signed Lusaka Protocol peace accord

Berlin

Background and Overview: The Potsdam Conference finalized the occupation lines of Germany and its capital. The Cold War realities quickly made decisions from the previously Allied countries politically and logistically awkward as the French, British, and US zones of occupation in Berlin were encircled by the Soviet occupied area of what would become East Germany. At first, people and troops were able to move freely between the zones, but the blockade of 1948-49 changed the situation in Berlin, and the world, forever. It was sparked by the combining of Western zones and the introduction of the deutsche mark as a new currency. In 1953, East Berlin would see riots that endangered the government until the USSR intervened, and Berlin would remain a source of Cold War tension due to the constant siphoning of people from East to West. The advent of the Berlin Wall dramatically changed the political and military dynamic which came to a head with the crisis of 1961. After the initial controversy of the Wall, it actually provided a much needed sense of stability to the situation. The status quo would last until 1989, when the military and political situation began changing faster than even the leaders of Berlin and the Germans could keep up with. This led to the chaos of November 1989, that would bring about not only the destruction of the hated Wall, but ultimately spark the reunification of not just Berlin, but the country.

Key Individuals/Groups:

Konrad Adenauer, Willy Brandt, Lucius Clay, Walter Ulbricht, Erich Honecker, Stasi, FRG, GDR

Timeline of Key Events:

1945 - Germany divided into occupation zones

November 1948 - Separate city governments were created between East and West Berlin

June 24, 1948-May 12, 1949 - Blockade of ground and water routes into East Germany cut off West Berlin and led to Allied airlift

May 23, 1949 - Federal Republic of Germany was founded

October 7, 1949 - German Democratic Republic was founded

June 16-17, 1953 - East Berlin uprising

August 12-13, 1961 - The Berlin Wall began construction

August-November 1961- Berlin Crisis culminated in the Checkpoint Charlie stand-off that saw US and USSR face-off

November 9, 1989 - An accidental announcement led to the massing of people seeking to cross into West Berlin - When the border troops finally allowed people through, the destruction of the wall began spontaneously.

May 18, 1990 - Treaty between FRG and the GDR agreed to monetary, economic, and social union.

Cuba

Background and Overview: US/Cuban relations had begun to deteriorate near the end of the Batista regime, but Castro's takeover made them far worse. After nationalizing US interests on the island, Eisenhower responded with an embargo that pushed Castro further into the Soviet fold. After the Bay of Pigs attempt at an invasion, Castro looked to his communist benefactors for protection from future attempts. He first sought anti-aircraft sites and when they were not immediately forthcoming his regime began developing their relations with China. Castro also removed some of the pro-USSR leaders within his government and Khrushchev responded with military aid to bring Cuba back within his sphere. At the same time, Khrushchev was dealing with the imbalance between the growing US ICBM arsenal and the USSR's struggles to fully develop its own program. He decided he could tie Cuba to the USSR, protect it from invasion, and balance the nuclear situation with the introduction of IRBMs on the island just 90 miles off the US coast. Khrushchev did not properly appreciate JFK's resistance to any change in the strategic situation and once U-2 flights discovered the missiles, the USSR was immediately on the defensive. Neither Khrushchev nor Kennedy wanted a military conflict, let alone a nuclear one, but Kennedy refused to allow the missiles. Both Castro and US military representatives favored a full-blown conflict, but Kennedy hoped for a deal. Using his brother, Attorney General Robert Kennedy, he was able to appear firm to the public and avoid political attacks while making a missile swap deal with the Soviets. Khrushchev would gain the missile swap, but lose international prestige and support within his party.

Key Individuals/Groups:

Fidel Castro, Robert Kennedy, John Kennedy, Khrushchev, Anatoly Dobrynin, Anastas Mikoyan, Curtis LeMay, Dean Rusk, Robert McNamara, John McCone, Allen Dulles

Timeline of Key Events:

January 1, 1959 - Batista fled Cuba paving the way for Castro's revolutionary government to take over

July 1960 - Castro began nationalizing US-owned industries

September 1960 - Eisenhower responded with a full embargo of sales to Cuba

January 1961 - Eisenhower ended diplomatic relations with Cuba

April 17-20, 1961 - Failed Bay of Pigs invasion

February 1962 - Kennedy expanded the embargo to all imports from Cuba

May 1962- Khrushchev decided to deploy nuclear missiles in Cuba while visiting Bulgaria

September 8, 1962 - First load of Soviet missiles arrived in Cuba

October 14, 1962 - A U-2 spy plane took photos of Soviet nuclear missile installations in Cuba

October 16, 1962 - Kennedy convened his Executive Committee (ExCom)

October 22, 1962 - Kennedy announced the discovery of missiles and the naval blockade to the US public

October 24, 1962 - Soviet ships turned back from the US quarantine line

October 26, 1962 - Khrushchev sent Kennedy a letter proposing to remove missiles if the US promised not to invade Cuba.

October 27, 1962 - A second letter from Khrushchev arrived, including a demand to remove US missiles from Turkey - Major Rudolf Anderson's was killed when his U-2 was shot down over Cuba

October 28, 1962 - Khrushchev agreed to remove missiles from Cuba in exchange for a later, undisclosed, removal of NATO Jupiter missiles from Turkey

December 1, 1962 - Last of the nuclear warheads left Cuba to return to the Soviet Union

Hungarian Revolution

Background and Overview: The Secret Speech of Nikita Khrushchev opened the door for de-Stalinization and through that opening some of the long-repressed societies of the Eastern Bloc saw resistance movements charge through. Poland was one of the first countries to see large scale demonstrations and that emboldened Hungarian students to follow suit. The students issued "Sixteen Points" of demands for reform. Soon, a nation-wide effort to topple the single-rule of the Communist Party was taking place and a moderate communist, Imre Nagy, was drafted to be the leader of the transition government. Numerous skirmishes took place against Soviet troops stationed in the country who were supported by the AVH state police. Soviet icons were torn down and the Hungarian flag, with the Soviet hammer and sickle torn out, were seen across Budapest. The government in Moscow was unsure of how to respond, but the Suez Crisis beginning on October 29th and the lynching of AVH members strengthened Khrushchev's resolve. He had the Red Army begin to prepare for a full invasion. The Army dispatched with the revolutionaries and Nagy was removed. The Hungarian Socialists Workers' Party took over from the ruling Hungarian Working People's Party under János Kádár. Hundreds of thousands would flee the country following the failed revolt and some 22,000 who remained, were imprisoned.

Key Individuals/Groups:

Imre Nagy, AVH, Nikita Khrushchev, Yuri Andropov, János Kádár, Zoltán Tildy, Pál Maléter

Timeline of Key Events:

October 23, 1956 - Students in Budapest organized a demonstration in solidarity with Poland's reform movement

October 23-24, 1956 - Protests spread throughout Budapest, with clashes occurring between protesters and the AVH

October 25, 1956 - Soviet tanks attacked protesters in Budapest

October 26, 1956 - Nagy was reinstated as Prime Minister.

October 30, 1956 - Soviet troops temporarily withdrew from Budapest - AVH troops were lynched by Hungarian revolutionaries

November 1, 1956 - Nagy announced Hungary's withdrawal from the Warsaw Pact

November 3, 1956 - Interim Defense Minister Maléter was arrested with his delegation while meeting with the Soviet military

November 4, 1956 - Soviet forces invaded Hungary

November 10, 1956 - A ceasefire was agreed upon, but the uprising was already largely over and the last fighting ended the next day in smaller cities

November 22, 1956 - Nagy was lured out of the Yugoslavian Embassy and arrested

Korean Conflict

Background and Overview: The end of fighting in the Pacific saw the division of the Korean peninsula along the 38th parallel in 1945. By 1948, the former Japanese colony had a Communist regime under Kim Il Sung in the North (DPRK) and a more capitalist, but also authoritarian system in the South under Syngman Rhee (ROK). Kim sought backing from Stalin in Moscow for an invasion, but Stalin demurred not wanting to risk a conflict with the US. The UN had mandated an election to unify the country, but both sides opposed any chance of losing control. Sensing the US was not committed to Asia, Stalin allowed Kim to proceed with his invasion on June 25, 1950, knowing that he now had a communist China under Mao to aid in the endeavor if needed. The US was taken by surprise, but was able to rally support through the UN Security Council due to the Soviet Union's boycott concerning the control of China's seat on the council. Twenty-one countries supplied forces, with the vast majority coming from the US, to the conflict and they were able to avoid a complete rout of South Korean forces by digging into the Pusan perimeter. US commander, Douglas MacArthur led a daring landing at Inchon to push the DPRK back across the 38th parallel and quickly moved towards the Chinese border at the Yalu River. The PRC had warned against such movements and MacArthur's rhetoric about using nuclear bombs did not help to calm the situation. The US was again taken by surprise as over a million Chinese soldiers entered the fray in October. Fighting would turn into a stalemate near the 38th parallel over the next two years and involve nearly 3 million total troops. Stalin saw the benefit of a protracted war, but after his death the Soviet and Chinese leadership pushed for peace. Rhee was against an armistice and refused to sign the agreement supported by President Eisenhower that stopped the fighting on July 27, 1953. A formal peace agreement has never been signed and the de facto borders of the two countries are based on territory held at the time of the ceasefire. The Korean War was the first large scale proxy war in the Cold War, a show of US commitment to containment and belief in the domino theory, and the only time US and Soviet (air) forces directly faced off for an extended period.

Key Individuals/Groups:

Kim Il Sung, Syngman Rhee, Douglas MacArthur, Harry Truman, Josef Stalin, Dwight Eisenhower, Mao Zedong, POWs, UN forces

Timeline of Key Events:

June 25, 1950 - North Korean forces crossed the 38th Parallel and invaded South Korea - UN Security Council Resolution 82 was passed calling for an end to the fighting

June 27, 1950 - UNSCR 83 recommended UN members provide assistance to South Korea to defend its sovereignty

June 28, 1950 - Seoul was captured by North Korean forces

August 4-September 16, 1950 - US and ROK troops established the "Pusan (Busan) Perimeter"

September 15-16, 1950 - US forces conducted the Incheon Landing

September 16-22, 1950 - UN forces recaptured Seoul, and advanced into North Korea

November 25, 1950 - Chinese Army crossed the Yalu river into North Korea

January-April 1951 - Chinese forces pushed UN forces back across the 38th Parallel and recaptured Seoul

May 1951 - UN counterattack freed Seoul - Fighting stalled around the 38th Parallel

July 10, 1951 - Peace talks began at Kaesong and eventually continued at Panmunjom

July 27, 1953 - Armistice Agreement was signed at Panmunjom

Prague Spring

Background and Overview: In the mid-sixties, economists in Czechoslovakia pushed for some market reforms to improve the failing economy. The government under Antonín Novotný instituted only meager measures. The economic woes exacerbated growing discontent amongst college age citizens disaffected by the stifling political and economic systems. Protests occurred in 1966 and 1967. Writers also began to challenge the system and the government responded with further censorship. Novotný resigned at the end of 1967, as opposition from Slovaks demanding more representation grew. Alexander Dubček was elected first secretary in January 1968. By April, momentum was building and more reformers were put into office including Gustav Husák and Ludvík Svoboda. Dubček announced his Action Program to add market elements to the economy and democratic elements to the political system as part of his "socialism with a human face." The Communist Party would remain the only party, but it would no longer operate outside of government controls. Political prisoners were freed and formed K 231 to be a political agitation organization and other non-communist groups began to sprout up. The "Two Thousand Words" manifesto was published calling for full democracy, which showed Dubček his transformation was happening faster than he anticipated and showed Brezhnev that Czechoslovakia may need to be reigned in. Dubček was informed by the Warsaw Pact on July 15th that member countries would intervene to protect socialism. Dubček met with Brezhnev and others at Bratislava and believed the situation was resolved in his favor, but others had asked for intervention. On August 20th, the invasion of Warsaw Pact troops began and Dubček was taken to Moscow. The Moscow Protocol was agreed to and Dubček was allowed to return in exchange for an end to much of the Action Program. Slovakia did gain rights as part of a new federation government, but Dubček and most of his reformers were replaced. Husák led the new government and would remain in power until the Velvet Revolution of 1989.

Key Individuals/Groups:

Alexander Dubček, Antonín Novotný, Leonid Brezhnev, Warsaw Pact, Gustáv Husák. Ludvík Svoboda, K 231, Ludvík Vaculík

Timeline of Key Events:

January 5, 1968 - Alexander Dubček was elected First Secretary

April 1968- Dubček's government introduced an "Action Program" for "socialism with a human face"

June 17, 1968 - "Two Thousand Words" was published, calling for further democratization and reforms

July 15, 1968 - The Soviet leadership communicated concern about the reforms

August 3, 1968 - Bratislava Declaration was released by Warsaw Pact that expressed commitment to guard against counterrevolutionary actions

August 20, 1968 - Warsaw Pact troops invaded Czechoslovakia and deposed the government

August 27, 1968 - Moscow Protocol was agreed to ending the Prague Spring reforms

August 28, 1968 - Gustáv Husák begins "normalization" as new general secretary

Soviet Invasion of Afghanistan

Background and Overview: The Soviet invasion was part of a larger conflict in Afghanistan that saw a series of regime changes and insurgencies from 1978-1992. Nur Mohammad Taraki led a coup against the government under Mohammad Daud Khan in 1978, killing Khan. Khan had established a republic by leading his own coup against the Shah in 1973, and becoming president. Taraki sought to move the country back within the Soviet orbit. Under the new communist regime, the Khalq and Pracham factions vied for dominance. When Khalq leader, Hafizullah Amin assassinated Taraki to take control, the USSR decided to invade on December 24, 1979. They supported the new Pracham leader, Babrak Karmal. Resistance to the governments was widespread and mujahideen fighters began efforts to oppose the government starting from 1978 on. The Soviets became entrenched in trying to subjugate a foreign population for an unpopular government. The US began to supply resistance fighters through Pakistan under Operation Cyclone (championed by Rep. Charlie Wilson) and the Russians were trapped in a Vietnam-style quagmire. Millions of civilians became refugees in neighboring countries fleeing the fighting, and the Soviet bombing campaigns trying to eliminate the support system of the mujahideen. By February 15, 1989, the USSR had fully withdrawn after a loss of around 15,000 soldiers and with no government to show for it.

Key Individuals/Groups:

Babrak Karmal, mujahideen, Hafizullah Amin, People's Democratic Party, Mohammad Taraki, Mohammad Daud Khan, Mikhail Gorbachev, Ronald Reagan, Charlie Wilson

Timeline of Key Events:

April 28, 1978 - Communist coup overthrew the Afghan government under Mohammad Daud Khan

1979 - CIA began Operation Cyclone to help destabilize Communist control

December 24, 1979 - Soviet forces invaded Afghanistan, at the request of the parts of the Communist government

April 14, 1988 - Geneva Accords agreed to by Pakistan, Afghanistan, the US, and the USSR created schedule for Soviet withdrawal

May 15, 1988 - First wave of Soviet troop withdrawal began

February 15, 1989 - Last Soviet troops left Afghanistan

1992 - Soviet-backed government collapsed, and a civil war erupted among mujahideen groups

Suez Crisis

Background and Overview: After Gamal Abdel Nasser nationalized the Suez Canal on July 26, 1956, the gears were set in motion for what would become the Suez Crisis in October. Nasser was trying to assert independence from Western control and after Egypt received arms from the Eastern bloc, the US went back on a loan offer to construct the Aswan Dam. Nasser decided to finance the project through canal tolls. The UK and France were eager to rid themselves of Nasser and his pan-Arab threat in the Middle East. They partnered with Israel to seize control of the canal and topple Nasser. On October 29th, Israel invaded the Sinai Peninsula. The UK and France dropped troops near the canal on November 6th, ostensibly to protect it and any foreign assets near it. President Eisenhower had been in the dark about the machinations of his allies and the US pushed through a Security Council resolution for a cease fire and for the evacuation of foreign troops. The French and British aggression was seen as an attempt to reassert colonial ambitions, and they had to quickly retreat. By December 22nd, they had left Egypt completely. Israel would stay in the Sinai until March. France and Britain suffered a loss of prestige worldwide and a loss of their remaining influence in the Middle East. The USSR, and worldwide communists, believed they had moved ahead of the European powers in global influence since the threat of Soviet intervention had helped force France and the UK out of the region.

Key Individuals/Groups:

David Ben-Gurion, Gamal Abdel Nasser, Anthony Eden, René Coty, John Foster Dulles, Dwight Eisenhower, Dag Hammarskjöld

Timeline of Key Events:

July 26, 1956 - Nasser nationalized the Suez Canal Company

October 29, 1956 - Israel invaded the Sinai Peninsula, and moved towards the Suez Canal

October 30, 1956 - Britain and France demanded that Israel and Egypt cease fire and withdraw from the canal zone, and they began bombing Egyptian installations

November 2, 1956 - The UN General Assembly called for a ceasefire

November 6, 1956 - Britain and France landed troops near the canal

December 22, 1956 - British and French troops began withdrawing

March 1957 - Israeli forces withdrew from the Sinai Peninsula and Gaza Strip, with the UN taking over administration of the Gaza Strip

April 24, 1957 - Suez Canal reopened

Vietnam Conflict

Background and Overview: The Vietnam conflict lasted for nearly two decades and encapsulated many, if not all, of the major elements of the larger Cold War era; decolonization, self-determination, proxy wars, authoritarianism, intra-party conflict, protest politics, government overreach, coups, ideological overcommitment, misconceptions, the domino theory, and containment. The forces of the Viet Minh had been successful in removing the Japanese from Vietnam before the end of WWII. The French tried to reassert their colonial dominion over the area of Indochina, but were met with intense opposition and abandoned the field after the disaster at Dien Bien Phu in 1954. The Geneva Accords that same year divided the country along the 17th parallel and called for elections. The North wanted to unify the nation under Ho Chi Minh and the Communist Party. The Saigon government in the South was the ward of the US, and Eisenhower immediately began covert activities to support Ngo Dinh Diem, who declared himself president in 1955. Diem was repressive to opponents, Buddhists, and the growing contingent of Viet Cong. By 1959, the North had officially begun a military effort to topple the South. They played the Chinese and the Soviets off of each other, using their feud to gain increases in supplies and logistical support. By 1960, the US realized their own support of the South needed to grow exponentially to counter the threat of the NVA and the Viet Cong. The corruption and poor administration of the South's government paired with the poor training of the ARVN undercut the benefits of the increase in US supplies and advisors. Buddhist protests, including immolation, against the abuse of Madame Nhu and the regime caused the Kennedy administration to question if it should continue its support. A coup was implicitly supported, and Ngo and his brother were executed in November 1963. The North sensed an opening and increased pressure on the South. In 1964, the Gulf of Tonkin situation afforded the Johnson administration the ability to respond to the North with significantly increased force. Operation Rolling Thunder began in 1965, and took the attack to the North with extensive bombing. Despite the commitment, some in the administration began to question the effectiveness of the increases. Newly appointed General Westmoreland thought the ARVN would break apart without US troops and by 1966, 200,000 had been authorized. The North was suffering heavy losses in its engagements with the US, but the seemingly unsustainable losses were not changing the realities in the field. In 1968, the North sensed another opportunity and launched the Tet Offensive. It was not successful, but showed the US administration and the public that the standard government line that the war was being won seemed less and less credible. Westmoreland asked for over 200,000 additional troops to "finish the job," but with the election nearing, LBJ decided to focus on seeking peace rather than reelection. LBJ finally halted bombing to get the North to negotiate, but Richard Nixon had been elected when talks actually began. Nixon took the approach of expanding the war into Cambodia and Laos, while simultaneously planning for a gradual US withdrawal and the Vietnamization of the war. The increase in military operations combined with the discussion of the US leaving added to the disillusionment amongst troops and reports of the My Lai Massacre and other incidents lowered public support. Peace negotiations were led by Henry Kissinger in Paris while Nixon supported a coup in Cambodia to cut off the North Vietnamese supply route, the Ho Chi Minh Trail. The North was able to counter the US and ARVN campaigns in both Cambodia and Laos. Nixon used Operation Linebacker and the mining of Haiphong Harbor to push back. The stalemate led to some traction in the negotiations in 1972. The South balked at the negotiations and as they broke down Nixon responded with the Christmas bombing of Hanoi. By the beginning of 1973, the US had convinced the South to go along with a ceasefire. The agreement called for a peaceful reunification, but with the US withdrawal in March and Congress banning further activities after August before passing the War Powers Act for good measure, the South was only holding on due to massive US supply shipments. In 1974, the supplies started to diminish and Northern aggression increased. The North planned a final two-year offensive that resulted in the fall of Saigon within two months and a complete surrender on April 30, 1975. Vietnam would finally be unified, but the Communist government continued to have external struggles with its former allies in Cambodia and then China.

Key Individuals/Groups:

ARVN, NLF, Viet Cong, NVA, Ho Chi Minh, Ngo Dinh Diem, Madame Nhu, Dwight Eisenhower, John Kennedy, Lyndon Johnson, Richard Nixon, Henry Kissenger, William Westmoreland, Le Duc Tho, Vo Nguyen Giap, Viet Minh

Timeline of Key Events:

May 7, 1954 - The French were defeated at Dien Bien Phu

July 21, 1954 - Geneva Accords divided Vietnam at the 17th parallel

1959 - North Vietnam began sending support to the Viet Cong

November 2, 1963 - President of South Vietnam, Ngo Dinh Diem, was assassinated during a military-backed coup

August 5, 1964 - Gulf of Tonkin incident took place

March 2, 1965 - US began large-scale bombing of North Vietnam in Operation Rolling Thunder

January 30, 1968 - Tet Offensive was launched

March 16, 1968 - My Lai massacre took place

1970 - Nixon administration implemented the Vietnamization policy to hand-off fighting responsibilities to the ARVN

April 29, 1970 - US and ARVN troops invaded Cambodia

January 27, 1973 - Paris Peace Accords are signed, leading to the final withdrawal of US troops

April 29, 1975 - Saigon fell to the North Vietnamese Troops

July 2, 1976 - Reunification Day in Vietnam occurred when the National Assembly approved a final merger